Rota-OC user manual

Getting started, Officer guide and Admin guide

3 November 2026

Contents

1.1 Sign in

1.2 First sign-in: choose your own password

1.3 Forgot your password

1.4 Finding your way around

1.5 Notifications

1.6 Send feedback

1.7 Using a phone

2.1 My leave: mark your leave

2.2 What leave costs: points and limits

2.3 Preferred on-call days

2.4 Confirmed leave (approved by the department)

2.5 Overview: who is available

2.6 Rota: see who is on call

2.7 My on-call: your shifts and swaps

2.8 Swap a date (during review)

2.9 Rules

2.10 Tips

3.1 Set up clinics and districts (once)

3.2 Add officers

3.3 Manage officers

3.4 Accounts

3.5 Periods, public holidays and peak days

3.6 Confirmed leave (approved absences)

3.7 Enter or fix an officer’s leave

3.8 Lock leave and generate the rota

3.9 Adjust days by hand

3.10 Send for review, then publish

3.11 Tally

3.12 Feedback

3.13 Audit log

3.14 Email and temporary passwords

FRONT MATTER

About this manual

Who the manual is for, the three roles, and how a rota period works.

Rota-OC is a web app that builds a fair on-call rota for the dental officers of Perlis: officers enter their leave, an admin generates and publishes the rota. This manual has three chapters: **Getting started** (everyone), the **Officer guide** and the **Admin guide**. All screenshots use mock officers and mock data (not real people), taken on a desktop browser unless marked as phone. A **red box** marks the part of the screen the text is talking about; when there are several, the numbers tell them apart.

There are three roles:

Role	What they can do
Officer	Mark their own leave and preferred on-call days, see the rota and their own shifts, swap dates, read the rules
Admin	Everything an officer does, plus the Admin pages (officers, periods, rota, tally, accounts, feedback, audit log). An admin is also an officer on the rota
Supervisor	Admin pages only. Not on the rota. The first account created is a supervisor

Every rota period moves through the same stages, and most of the manual follows them:

1. **Open.** Officers mark leave and preferred days until the leave deadline.
2. **Locked.** The admin freezes leave and generates a draft rota.
3. **In review.** Officers see the draft and can swap dates with each other.
4. **Published.** The final rota is out and its shifts count towards each officer's tally.

The full rules (leave points, daily limits, how shifts are shared) are on the **Rules** page inside the app; the Officer guide summarises them.

Version note: this manual was written from the latest master, which includes the Rules page, the phone layout and confirmed leave.

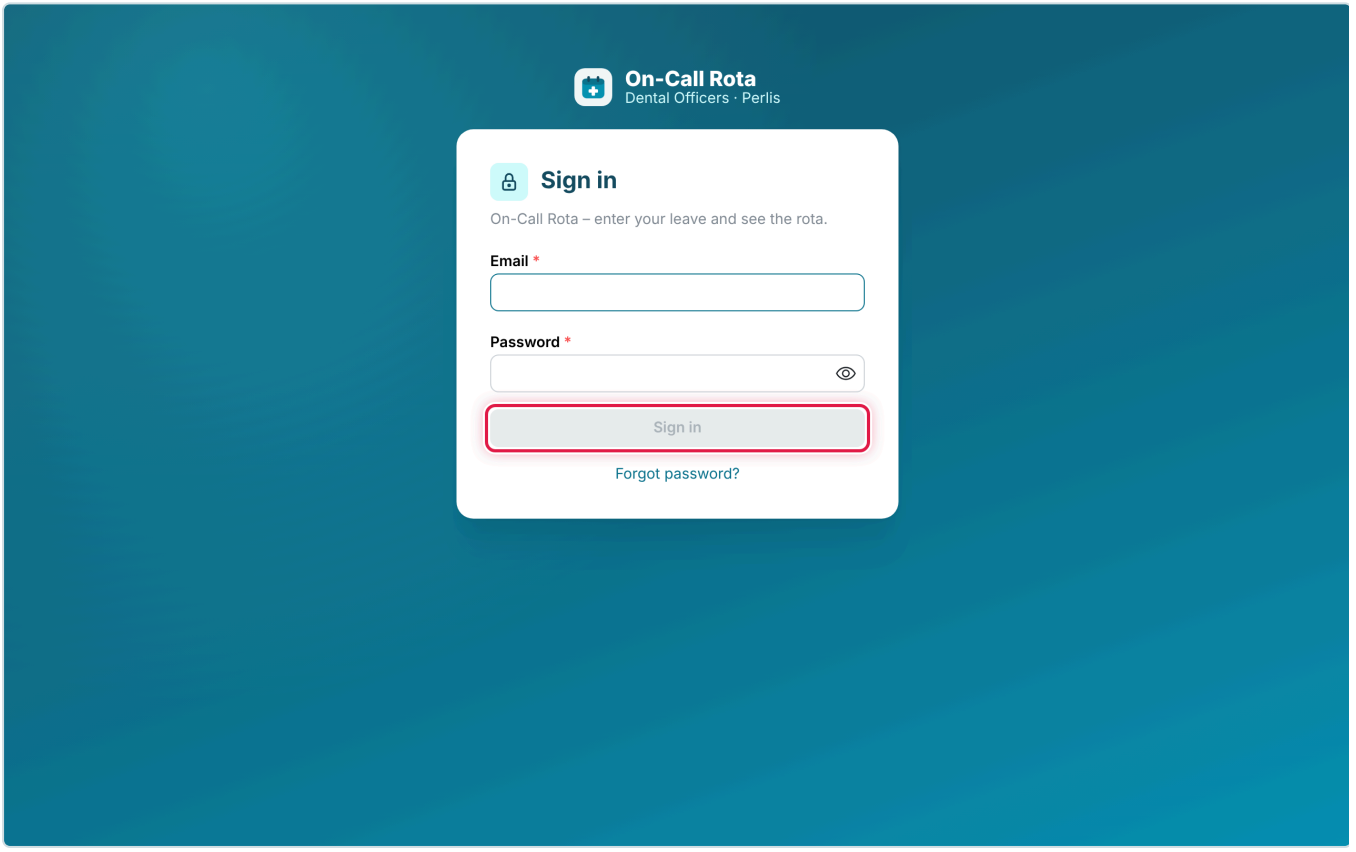
CHAPTER 1

Chapter 1: Getting started (everyone)

Signing in, passwords, the menu, notifications, feedback and using a phone. For everyone.

1.1 Sign in

1. Open the app address your admin gave you.
2. Type your **Email** and **Password**, then press **Sign in**.

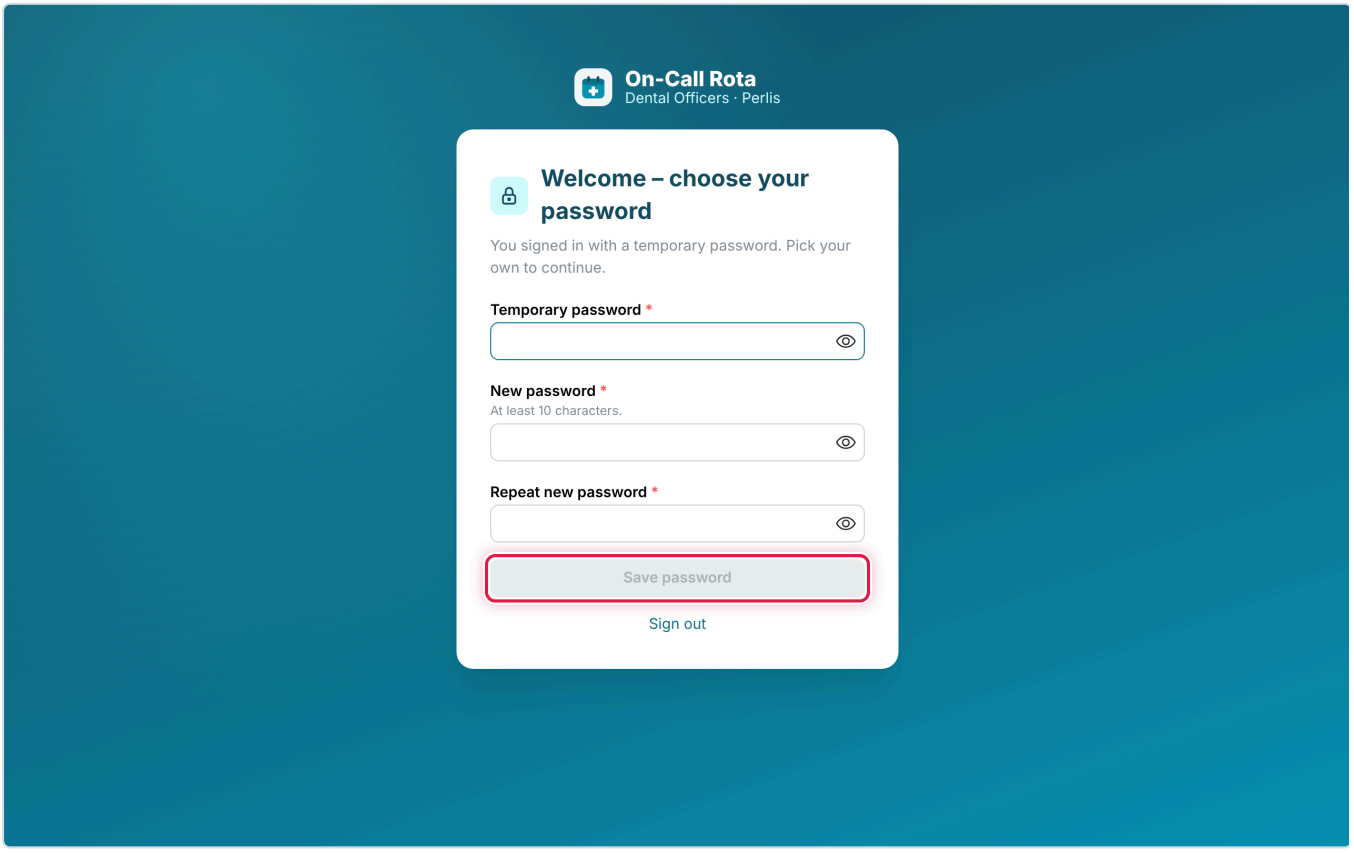


Everything in the app needs a sign-in. If you have no account yet, ask an admin to invite you.

1.2 First sign-in: choose your own password

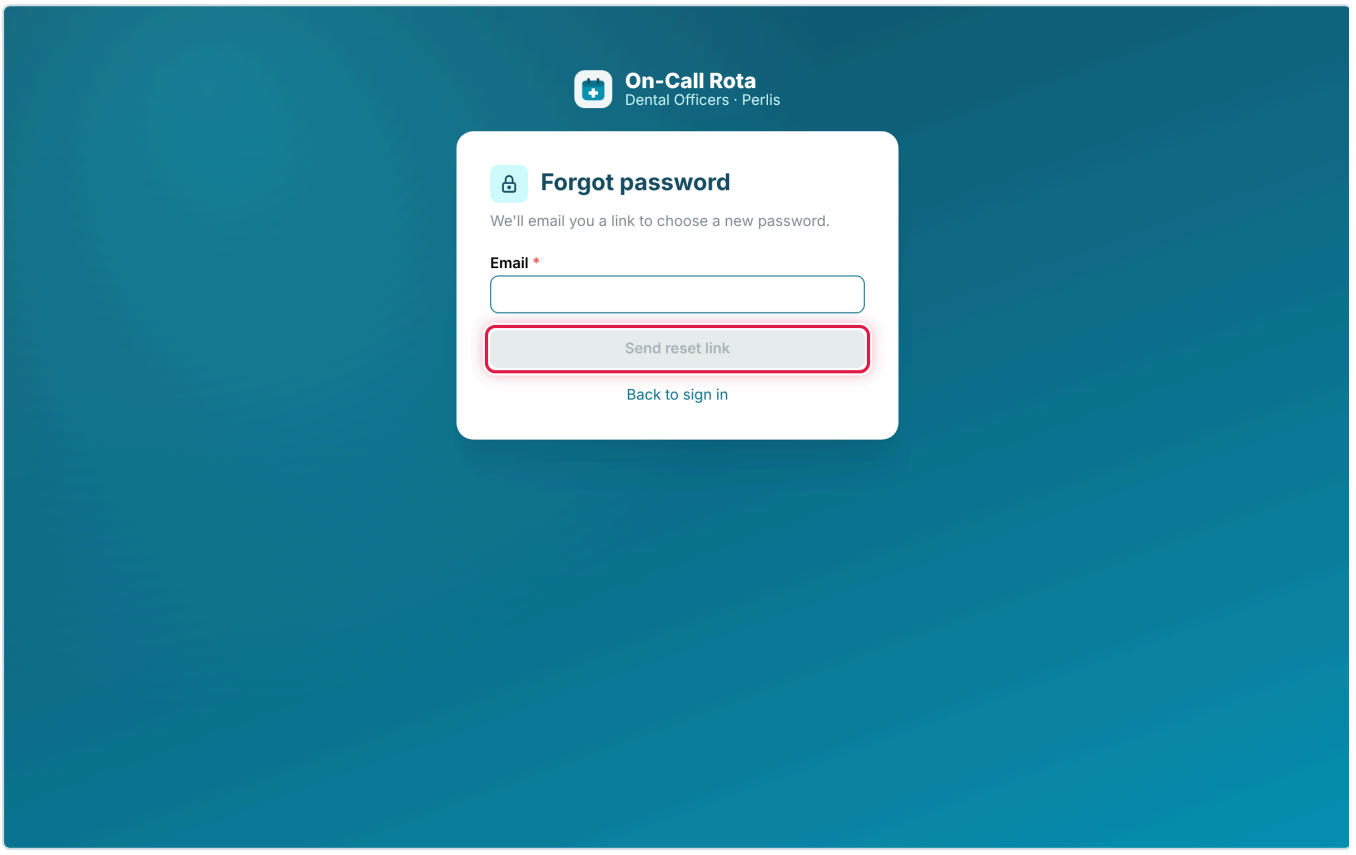
New accounts get a temporary password by email (or from the admin directly when email is not set up). It expires after a few days.

1. Sign in with the temporary password.
2. On the **Welcome – choose your password** page, enter the temporary password, then your new password twice. It needs at least 10 characters.
3. Press **Save password**. You go straight into the app.



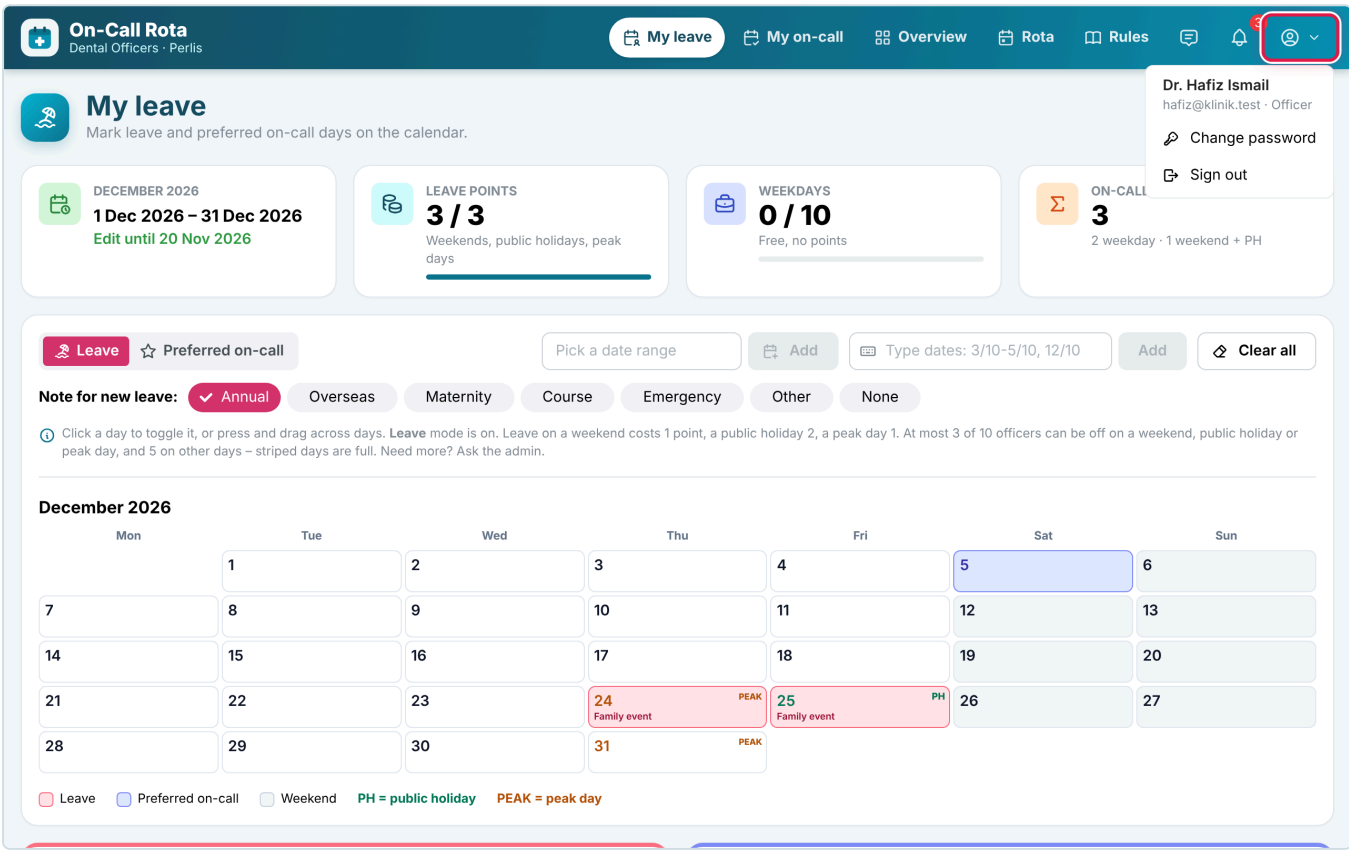
1.3 Forgot your password

1. On the sign-in page, press **Forgot password?** and enter your email.
2. Open the email and follow its link to set a new password. If no email arrives, ask an admin to send a new temporary password (Admin > Accounts).



1.4 Finding your way around

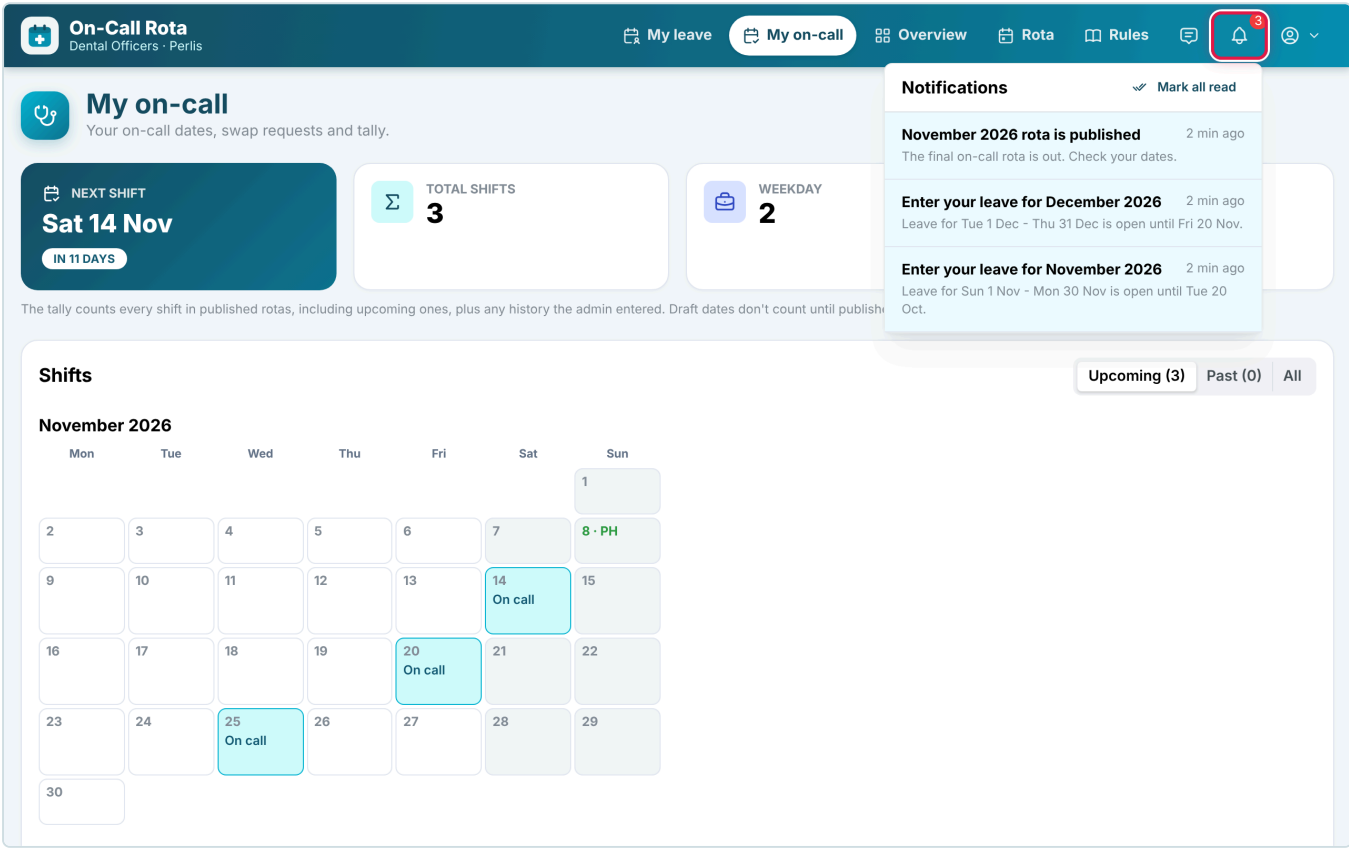
The header has the pages you can use. Officers see **My leave**, **My on-call**, **Overview**, **Rota** and **Rules**. Admins see **Leave**, **Overview**, **Rota**, **Rules** and **Admin** (an admin who is also an officer sees the officer pages too). On the right are **Feedback**, **Notifications** and your **Account** menu.



Open the **Account** menu to change your password or sign out.

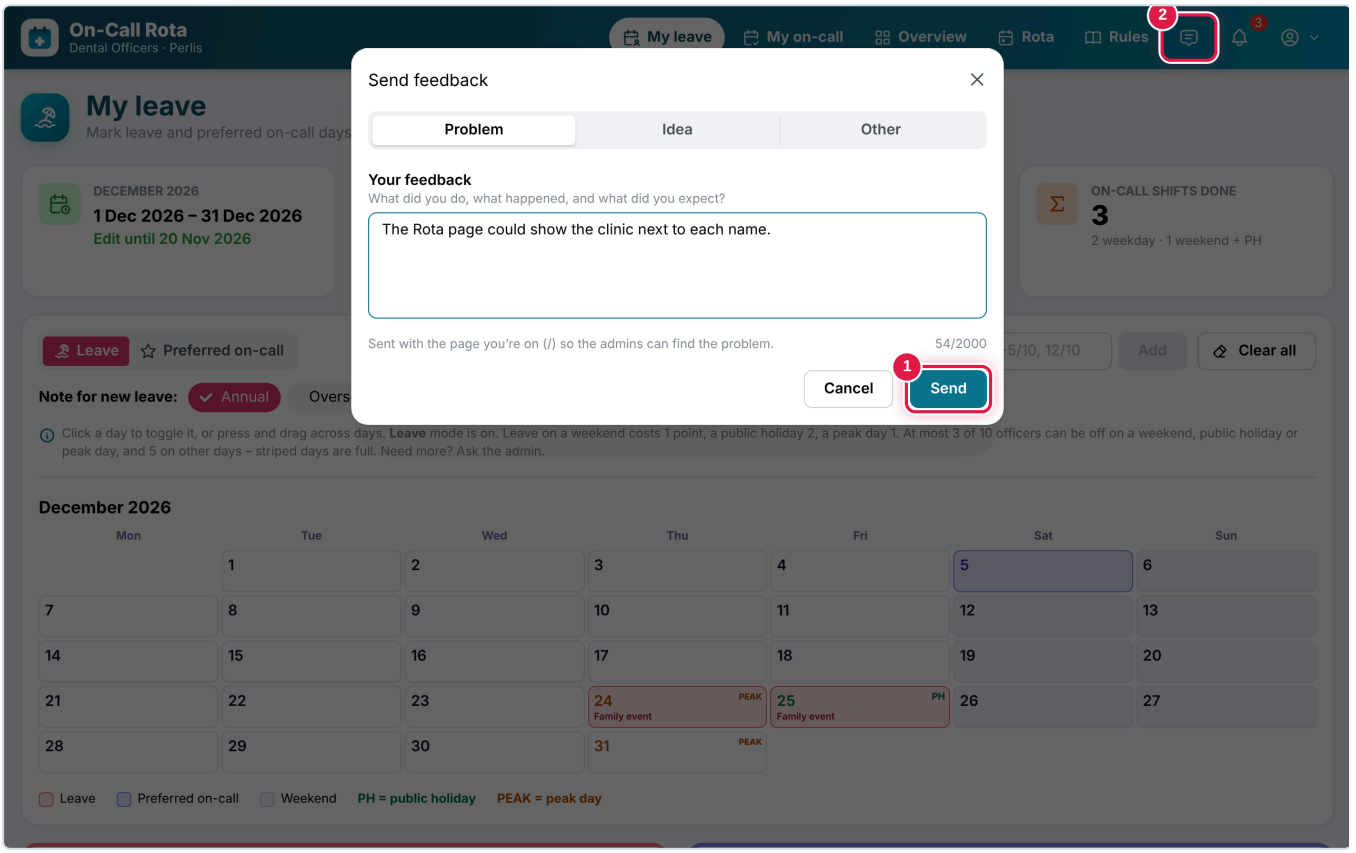
1.5 Notifications

The bell shows a red number when something needs your attention: a leave period opening, a rota going into review or being published, a swap request, or leave an admin entered for you. Press it to read them, or **Mark all read**. Important ones also arrive by email.



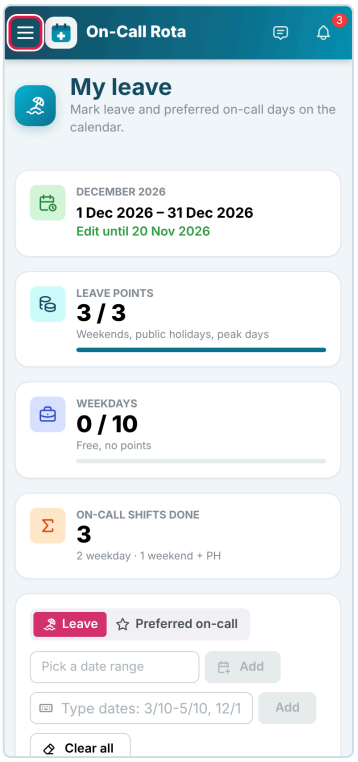
1.6 Send feedback

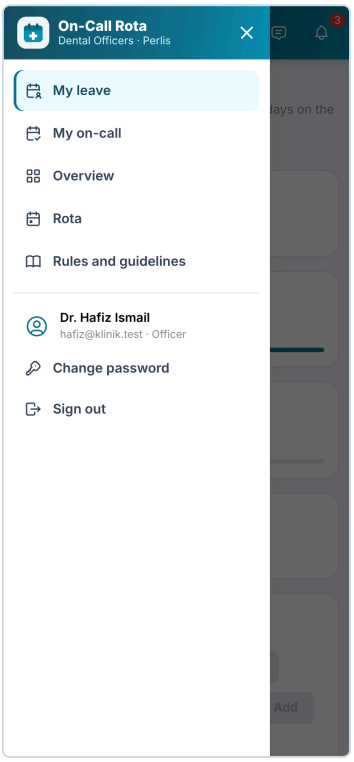
Found a problem or have an idea? Press the speech-bubble icon in the header, choose a category (Problem, Idea or Other), type your message and press **Send**. It records the page you were on, and admins are notified.

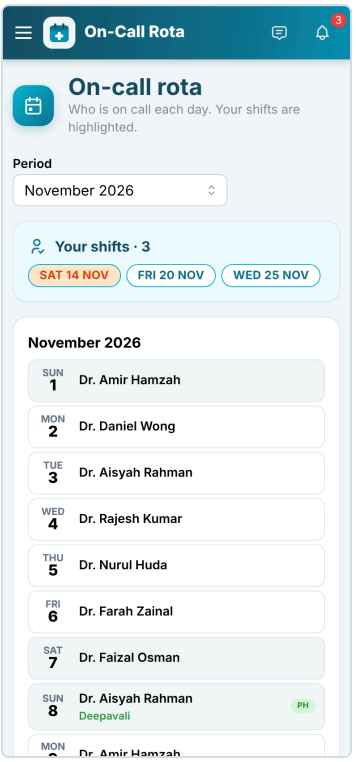


1.7 Using a phone

On a phone the header links move into a side menu. Press the **three-line menu** at the top left to open it. The rota shows as a list of days instead of a calendar, so nothing is wider than the screen.







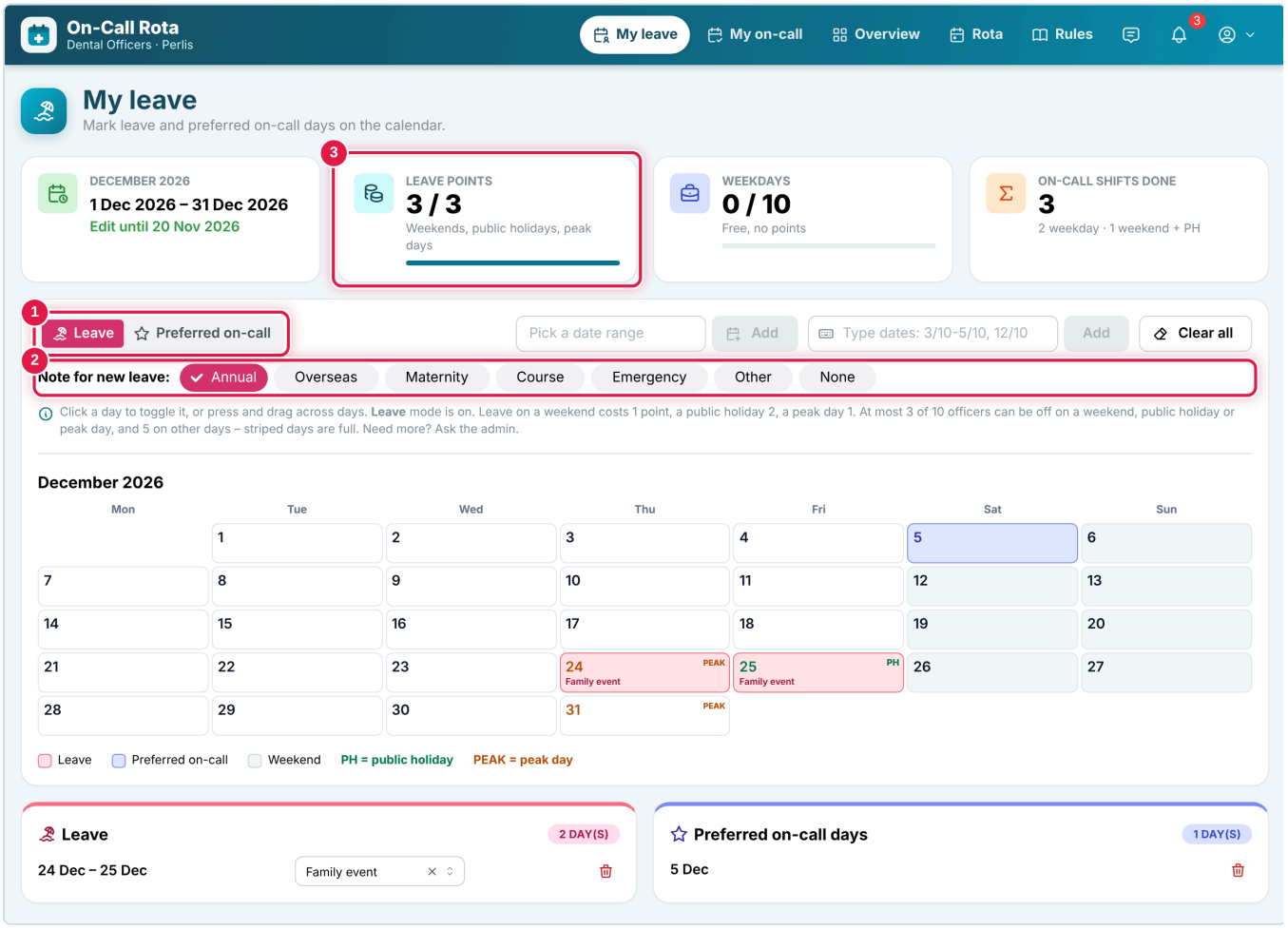
CHAPTER 2

Chapter 2: Officer guide

Marking leave, preferred days, confirmed leave, the overview, the rota and swapping dates. For officers.

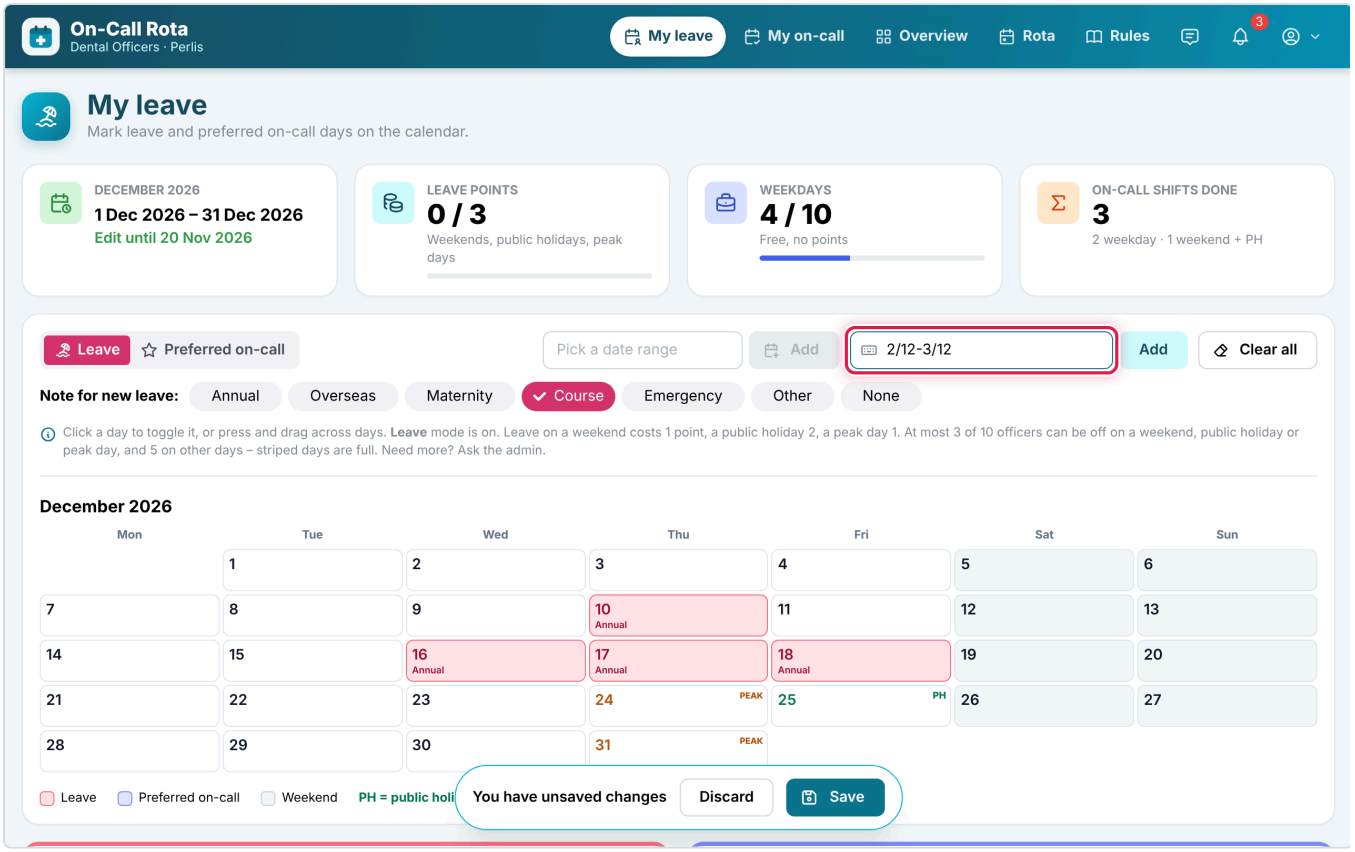
2.1 My leave: mark your leave

My leave is your home page. Do this before the leave deadline shown on the first card.

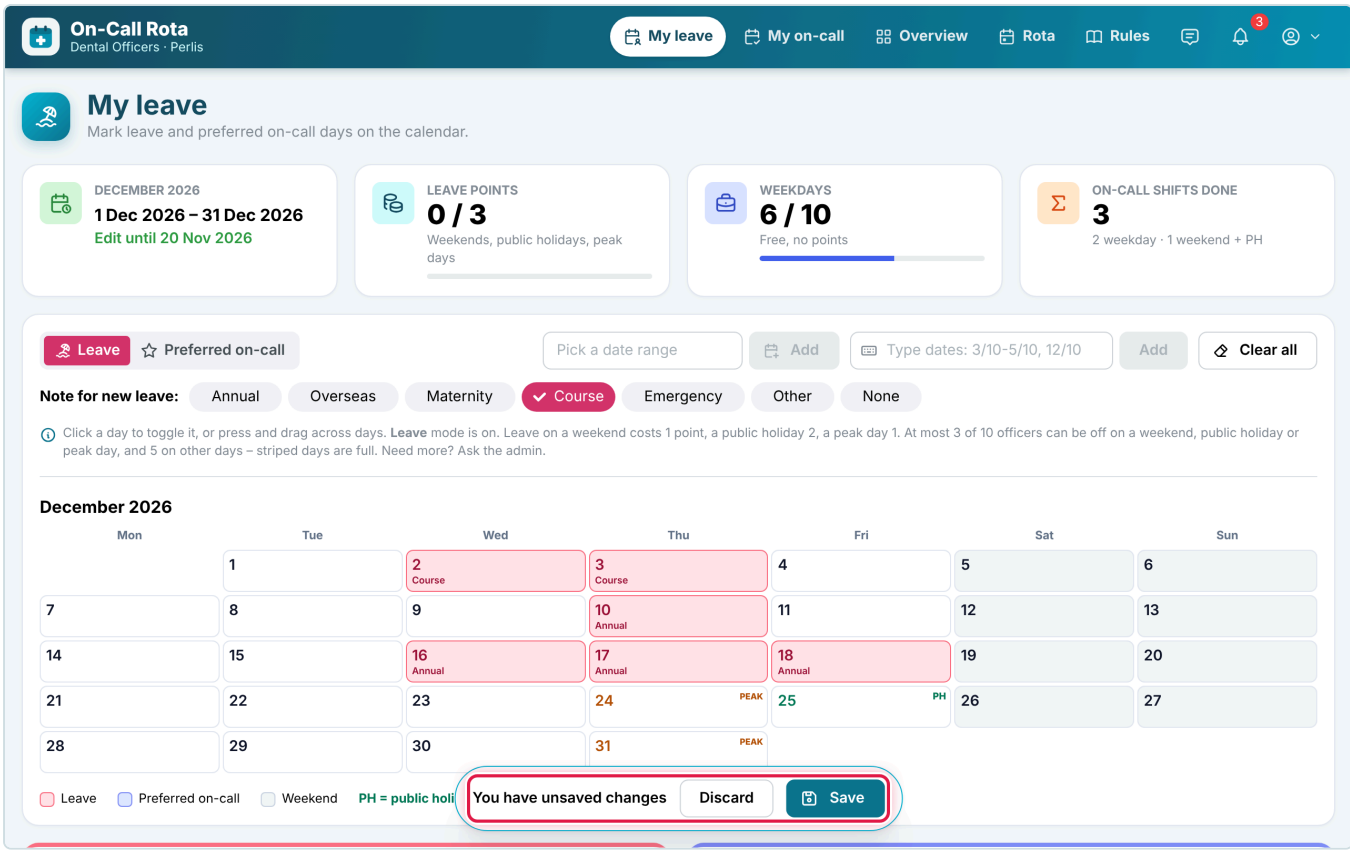


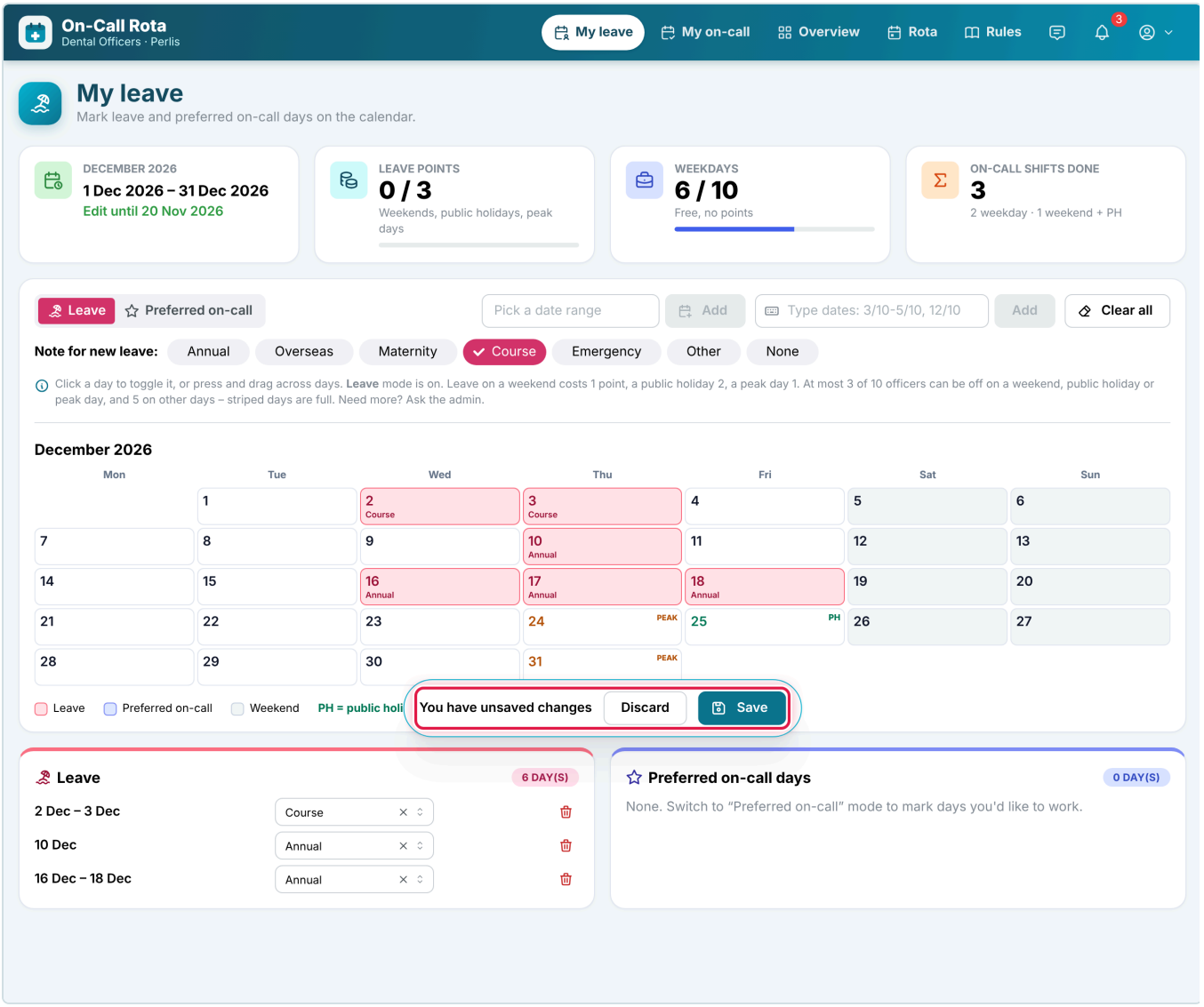
The four cards at the top show: the **period** and your deadline (“Edit until 20 Nov 2026”), your **leave points** used out of your budget, your **weekdays** used out of your free allowance, and your **on-call shifts done** so far.

1. Check the **Leave** mode is selected (top left of the calendar). The other mode is **Preferred on-call**.
2. Under **Note for new leave**, pick why you are away: Annual, Overseas, Maternity, Course, Emergency, Other, or None. Choose **Other** to type your own words. Keep notes short, since other officers can see them on the Overview page.
3. Mark the days. You can click a single day to toggle it, press and drag across several days, pick a range with **Pick a date range** and press **Add**, or type dates in the box (for example `3/10-5/10, 12/10`) and press **Add**.



4. Marked days turn red with their note. The list under the calendar groups them by range, where you can change a note or press the bin icon to remove a range.
5. Press **Save** in the bar that appears at the bottom ("You have unsaved changes"). **Discard** throws your changes away.





Until you press Save nothing is stored. After you save, the cards update (for example “3 / 3” points) and you see a green **Saved** message.

2.2 What leave costs: points and limits

Busy days cost **points**; ordinary weekdays do not.

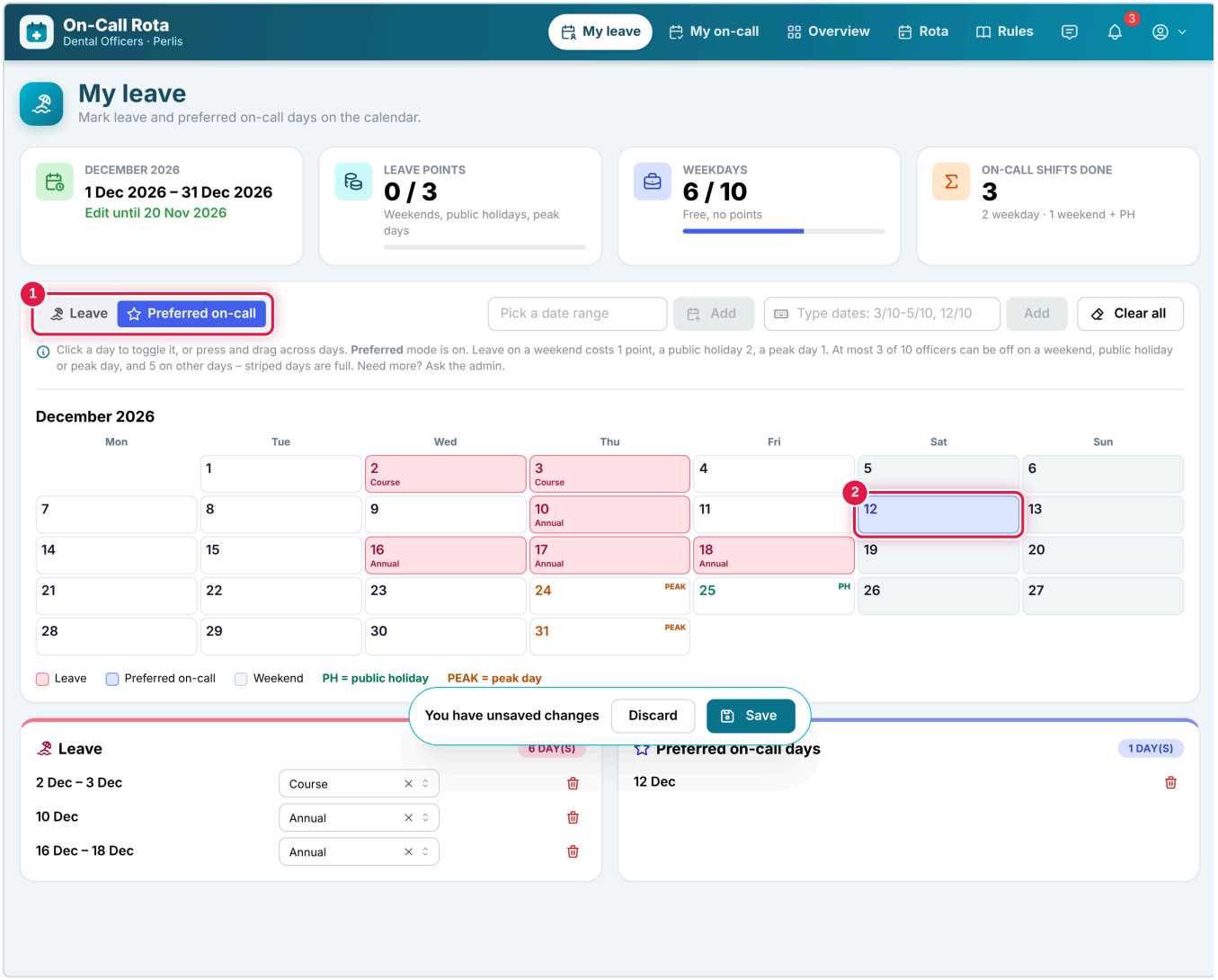
Day	Cost
Normal weekday	Free, up to your weekday allowance (about half the normal weekdays in the period)
Saturday or Sunday	1 point
Public holiday (**PH**)	2 points
Peak day (**PEAK**, a busy weekday)	1 point

Your points budget is about 30% of the weekend and public holiday days in the period (the admin can change it). Only a share of officers can be off on the same day: at most 30% on weekends, public holidays and peak days, and 50% on other days. A **striped** day is full, so you cannot add it. Book early, because busy days fill up first come, first served. Lowering a limit never removes leave you already have.

If you will be away on a busy day and have no points left, **ask the admin for extra points before the deadline**. Do not leave the day unmarked, or you may be put on call while you are away.

2.3 Preferred on-call days

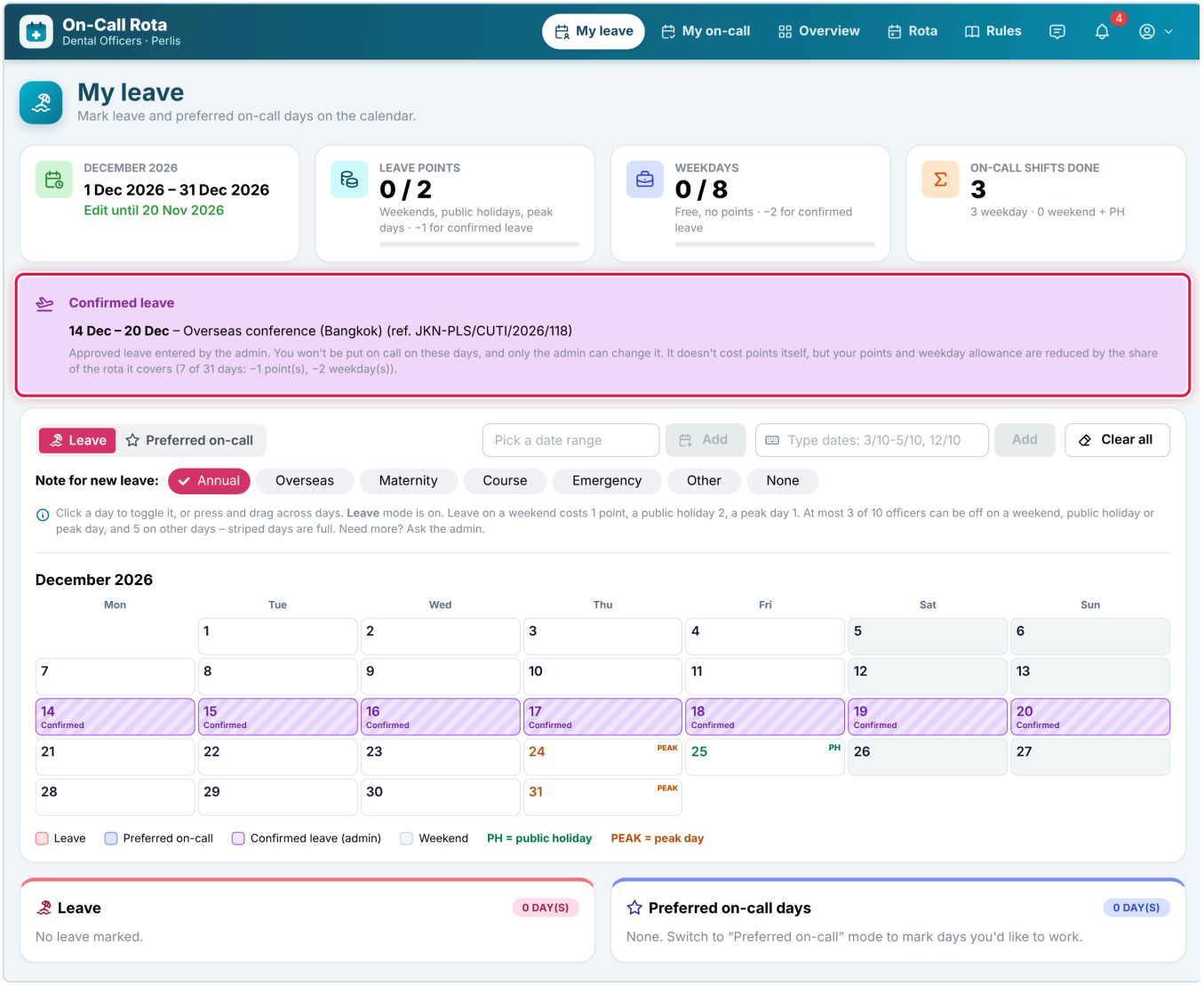
Switch to **Preferred on-call** (top left of the calendar) and click the days you would like to work. They turn blue.



Press **Save**. Preferred days are filled first and are not moved afterwards, but they are not guaranteed: another officer may want the same day, it may give you back-to-back shifts, or you may already have your equal share. You cannot mark a day as both leave and preferred. Marking more preferred days does not give you more shifts.

2.4 Confirmed leave (approved by the department)

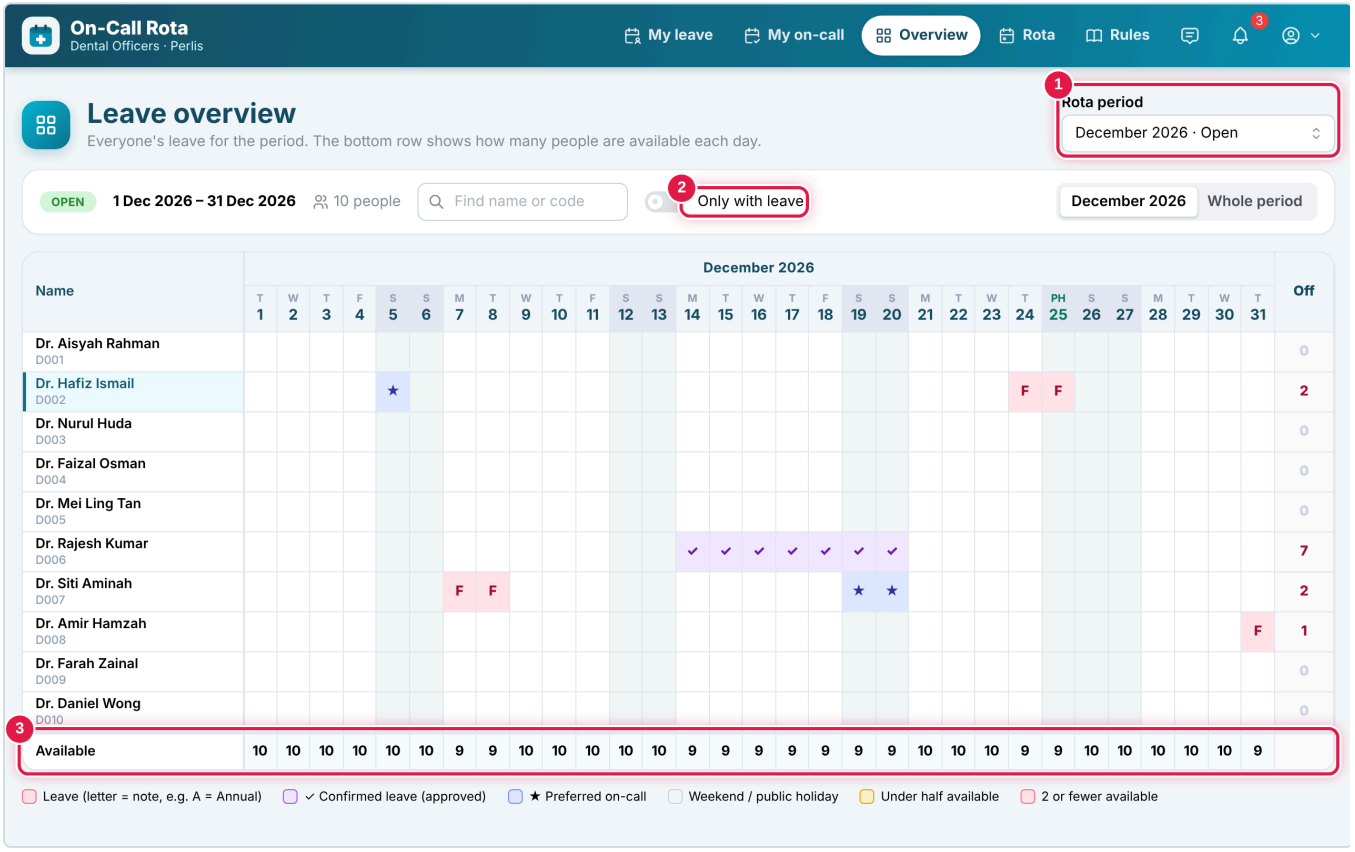
For leave that is **officially approved**, such as an overseas trip, send the approval to an admin. The admin records it as **confirmed leave**.



- A purple **Confirmed leave** panel shows the dates, reason and reference, and the days are striped purple.
- It is never refused, even when you are out of points or the day is full, and you will not be put on call on those days.
- It costs no points itself, but your points and weekday allowance are reduced by the share of the period it covers. In the example, 7 of 31 days reduces the budget by 1 point and the weekdays by 2.
- Only the admin can change it. Other officers see only "confirmed leave".
- You get a notification and an email when it is added or changed.

2.5 Overview: who is available

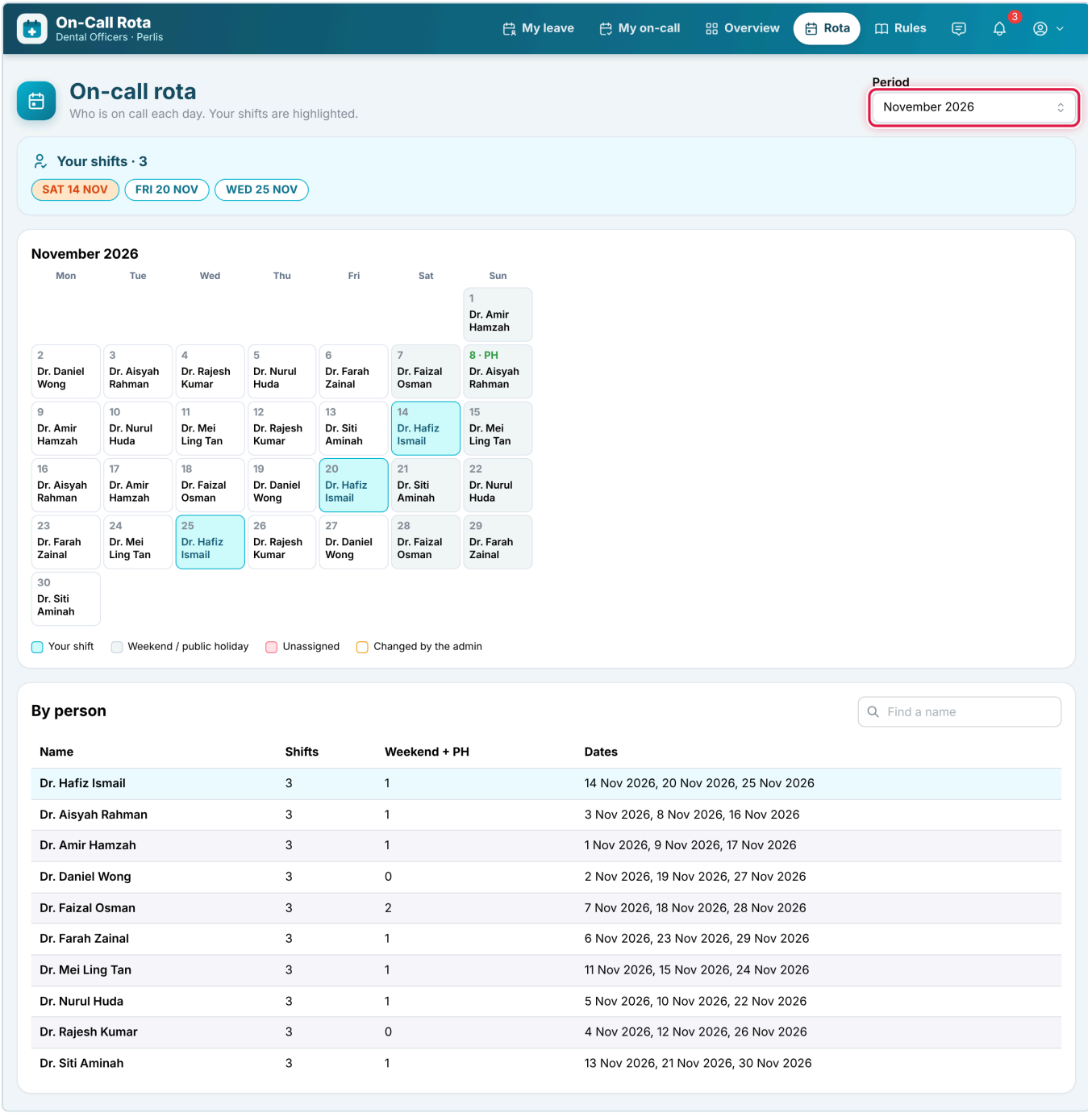
Overview shows everyone's leave for a period, so you can see which days are crowded before you pick yours.



- Choose the **Rota period** at the top right, or switch between a single month and the **Whole period**.
- Search for a name or turn on **Only with leave**.
- A red letter is leave (the letter is the note, for example F for Family), a purple tick is confirmed leave, a star is a preferred on-call day.
- The **Available** row at the bottom counts how many officers are free each day. It turns yellow when under half are available and red when two or fewer are.

2.6 Rota: see who is on call

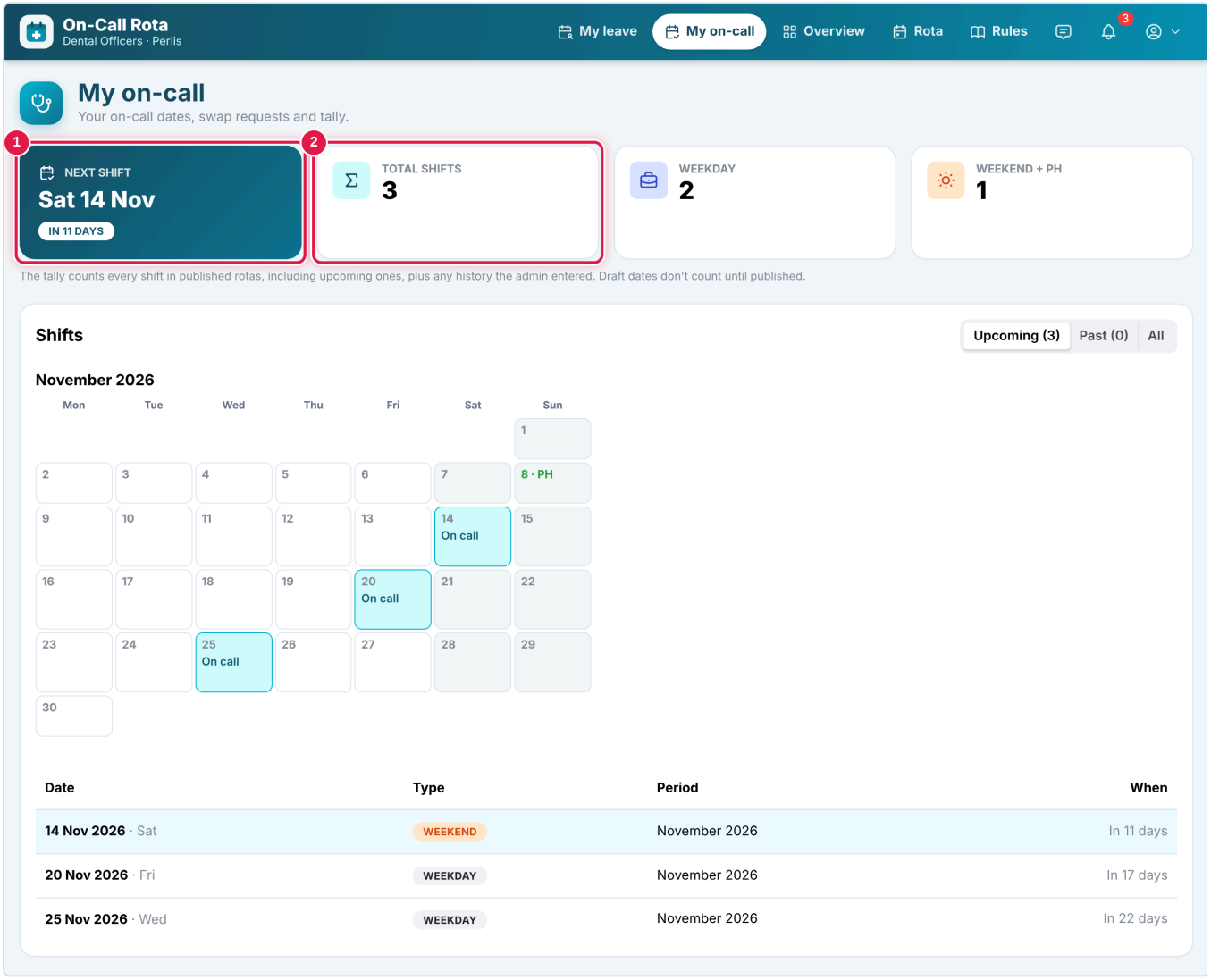
Once the admin shares a draft or publishes the final rota, **Rota** shows who is on call each day. Pick the period at the top right.



Your shifts are highlighted in blue and listed in the **Your shifts** box. Weekends and public holidays are shaded grey; a day with an orange border was changed by the admin. The **By person** table lists everyone's shifts and dates. During review a purple banner says **Draft for review – not final**.

2.7 My on-call: your shifts and swaps

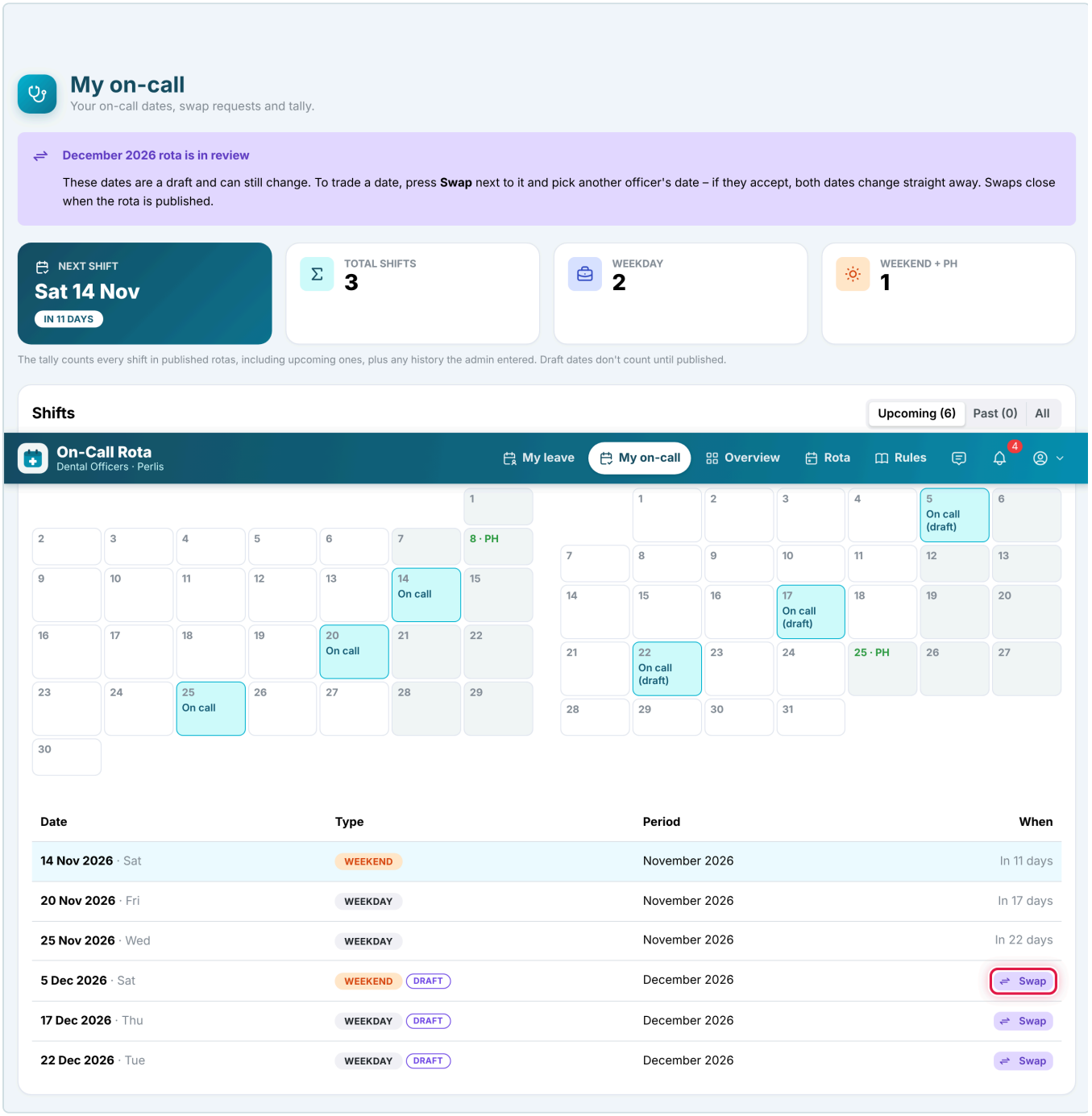
My on-call shows your next shift, your tally (total, weekday, weekend + public holiday) and every shift as a calendar and a list.



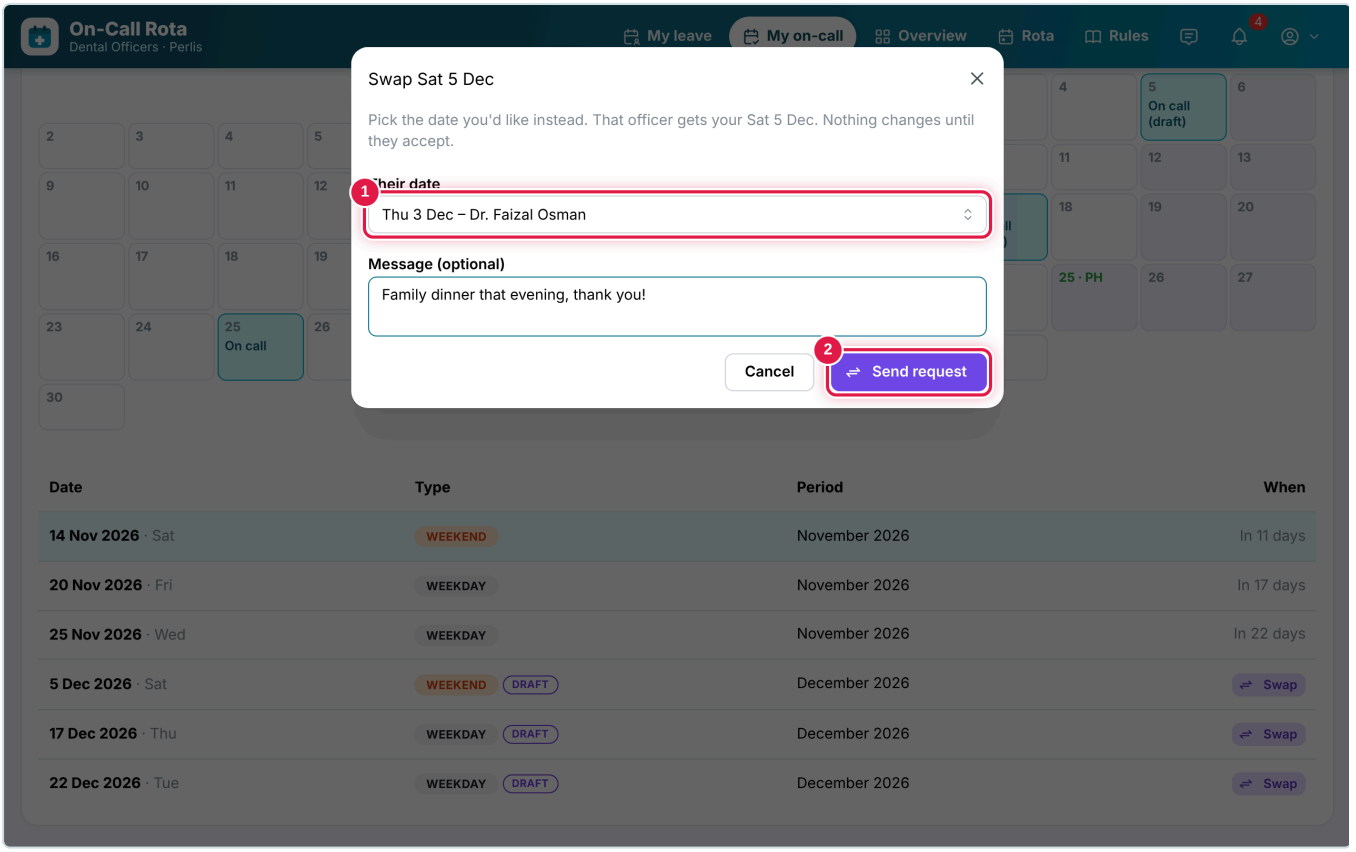
The tally counts all published shifts, including upcoming ones, plus any history the admin entered. Draft dates do not count until the rota is published. Your weekend count decides how weekend shifts are shared out in future periods.

2.8 Swap a date (during review)

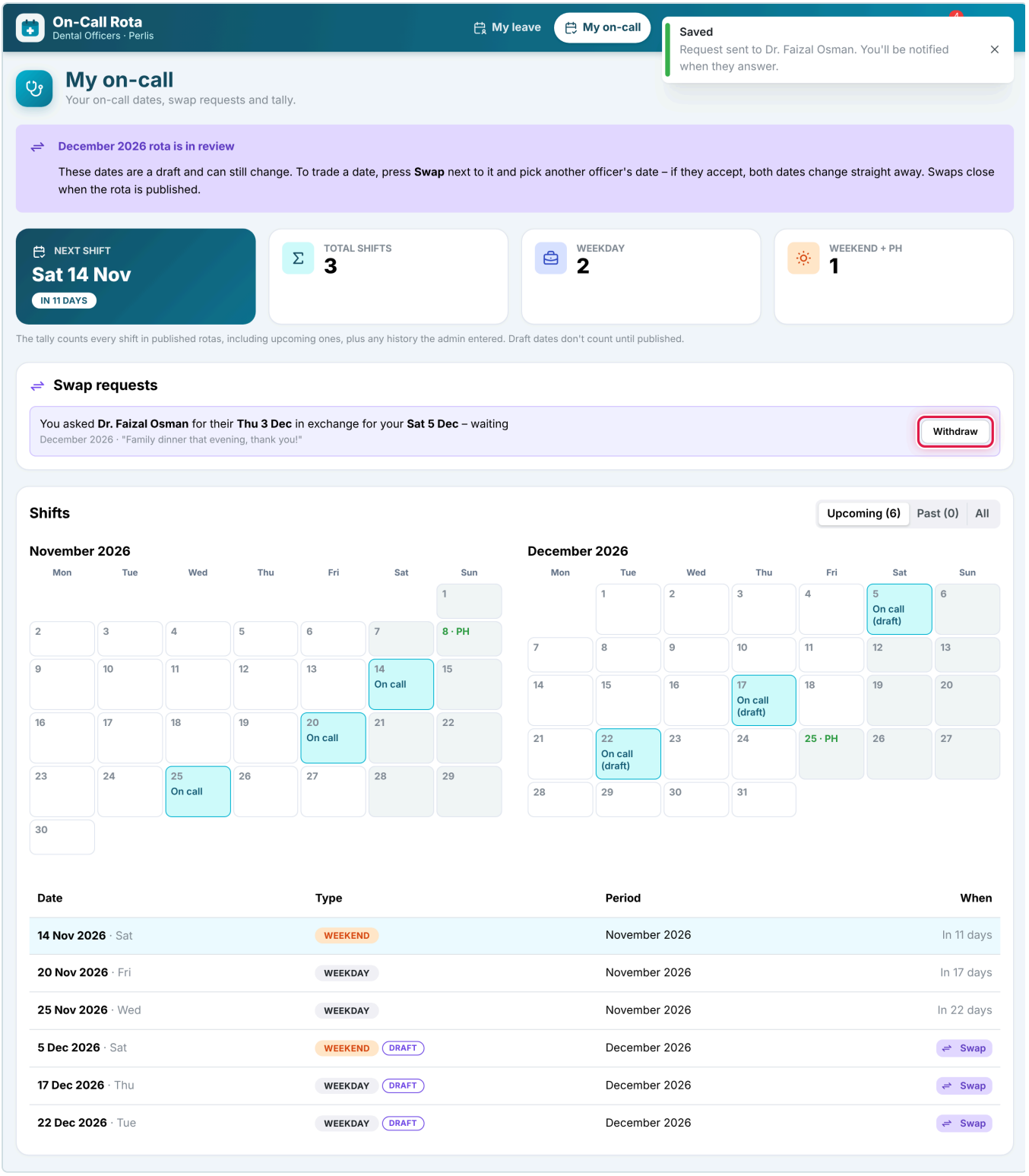
While a rota is **in review**, you can trade a date with another officer.



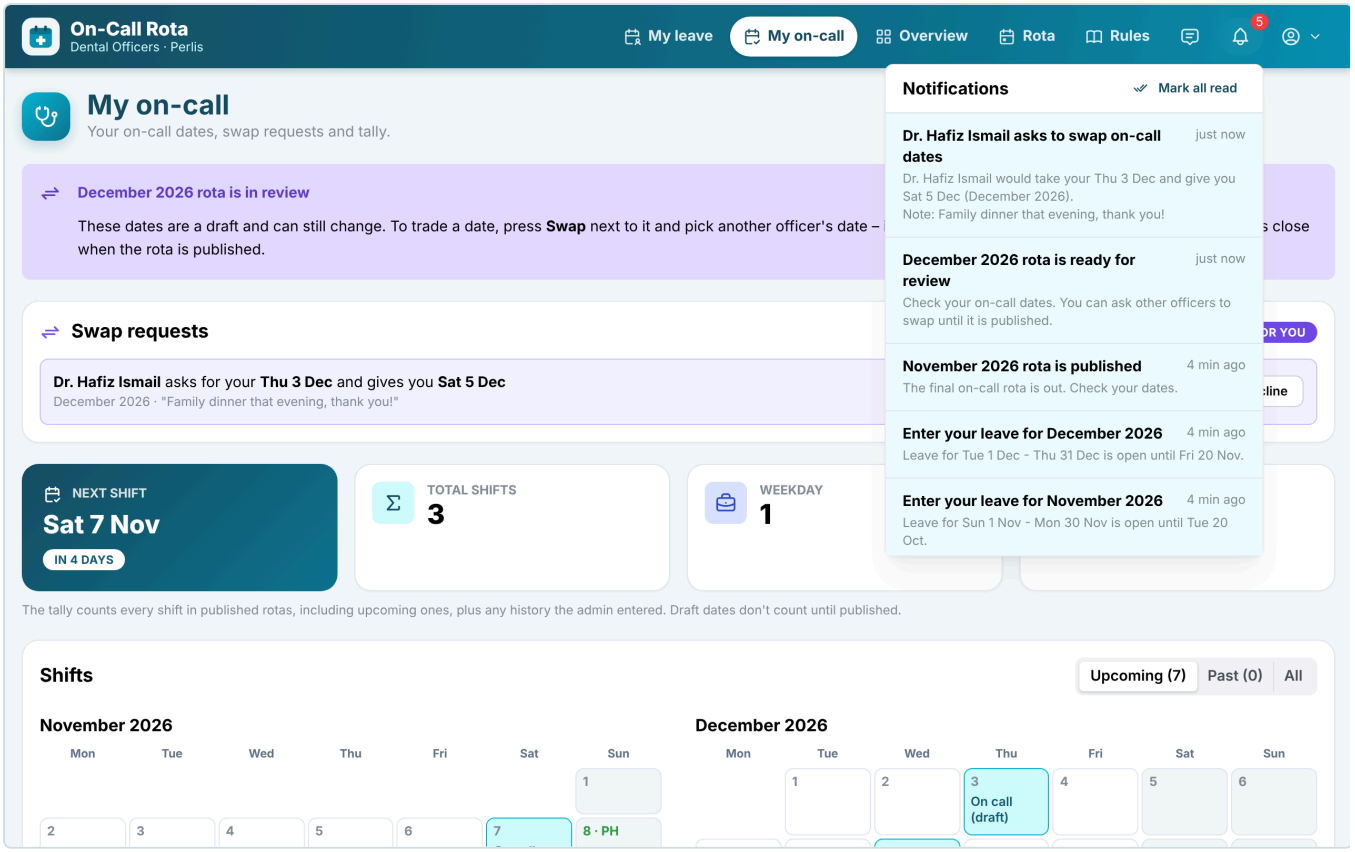
1. Open **My on-call** and press **Swap** next to one of your draft dates.
2. In the **Swap** window, choose **Their date**, which is the date (and officer) you want in return.
3. Add an optional **Message** (for example “family event that weekend”) and press **Send request**.



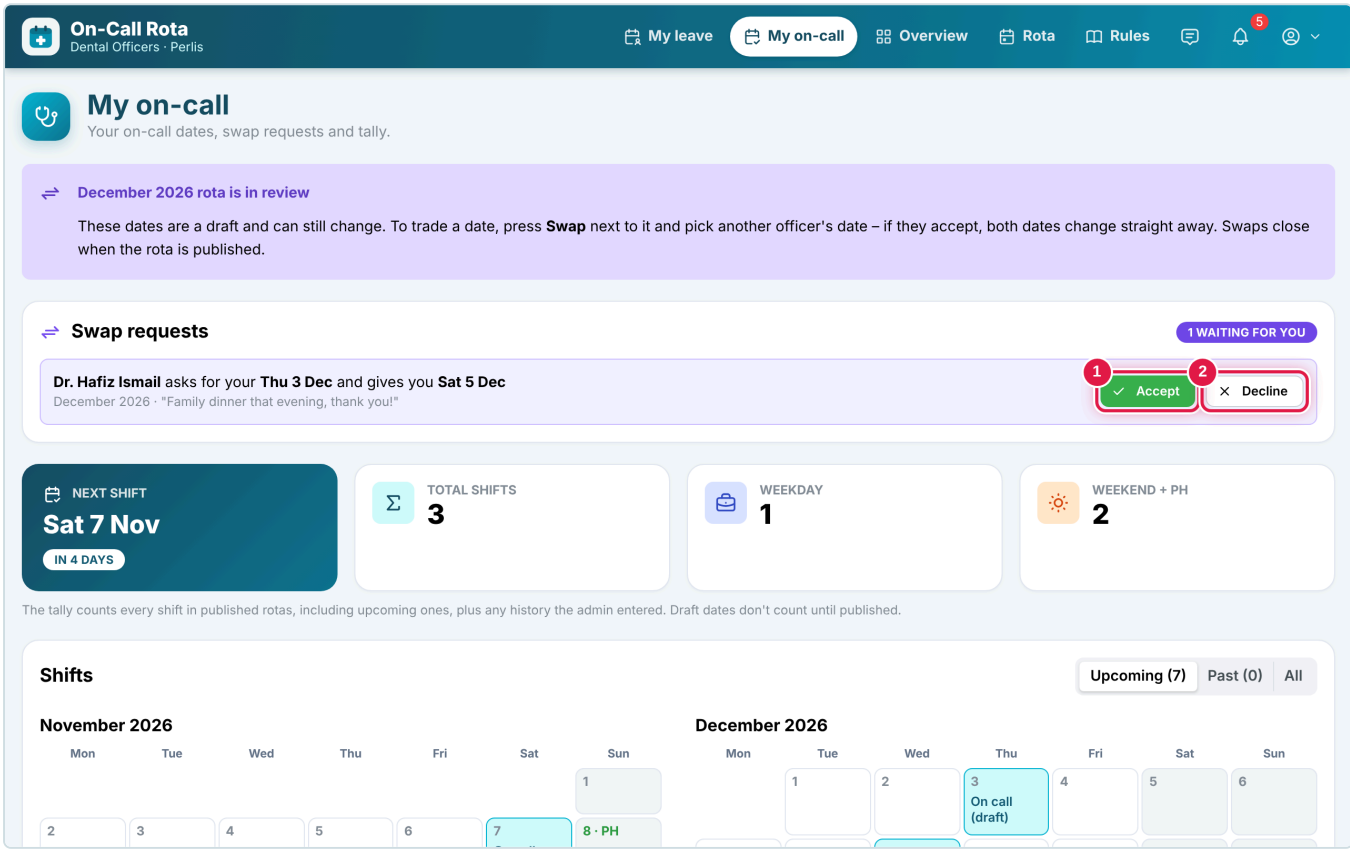
4. Your request shows under **Swap requests** as waiting. You can press **Withdraw** any time before it is answered.

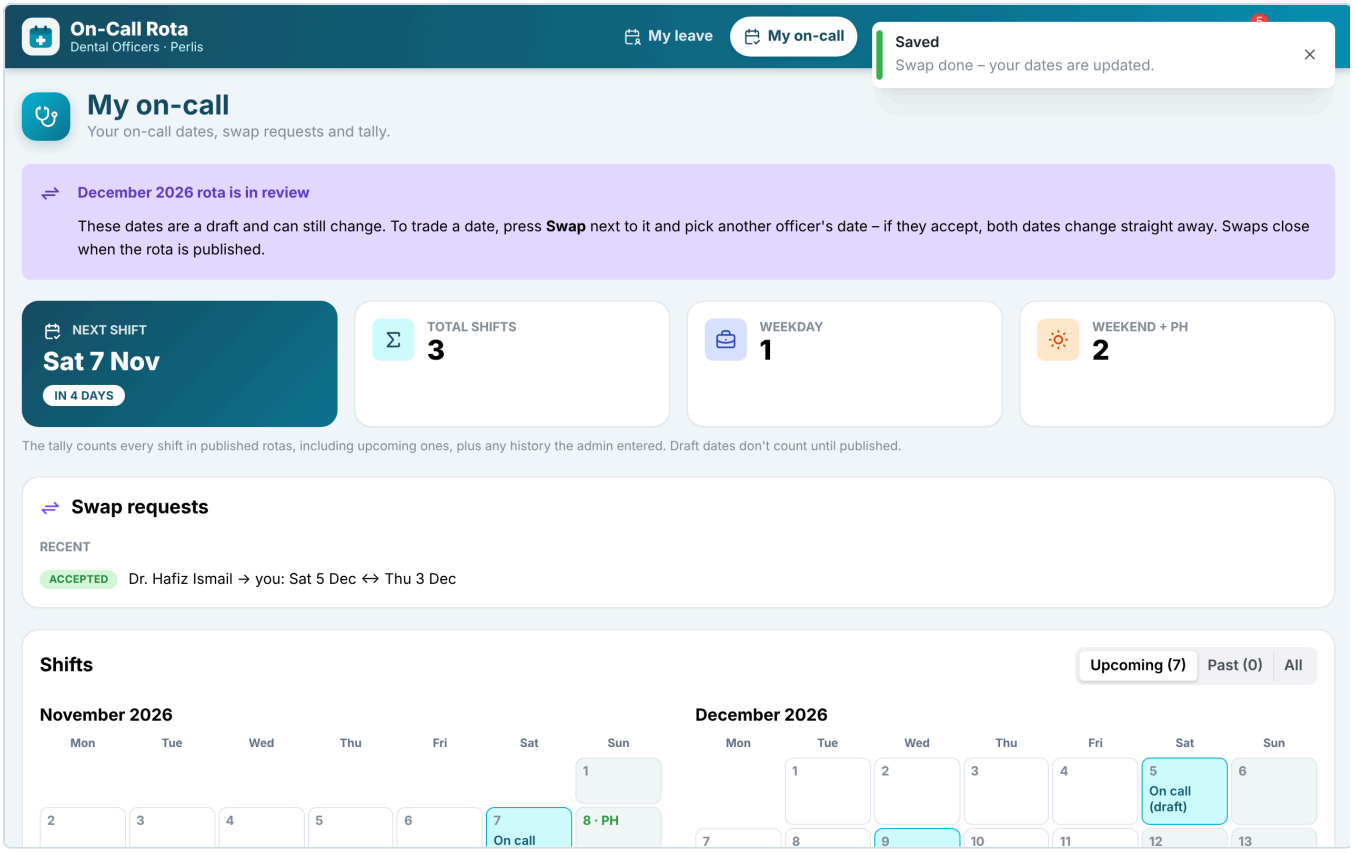


5. The other officer gets a notification and an email.



6. They press **Accept** or **Decline** on their My on-call page. When they accept, both dates change at once and you both keep the same number of shifts.

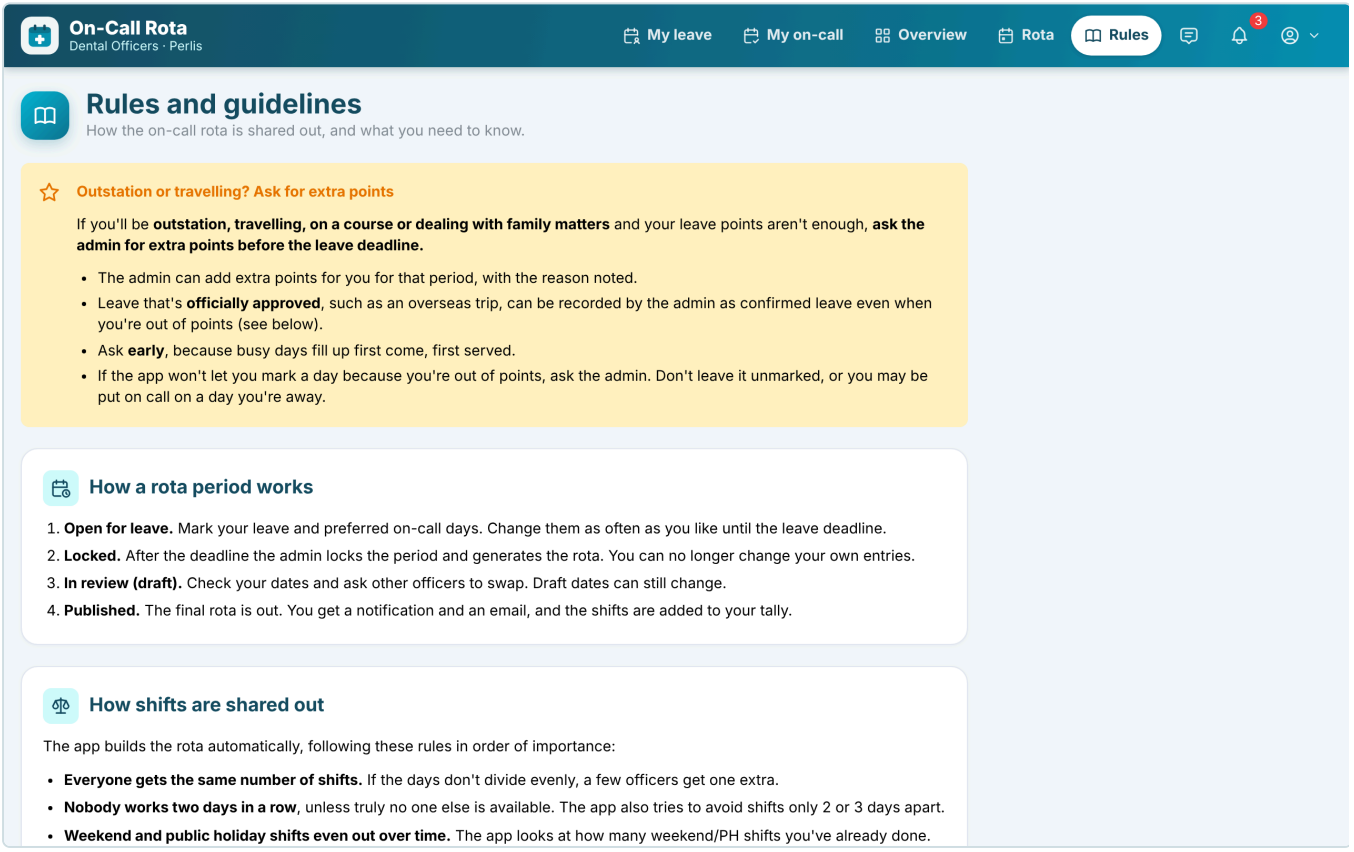




Rules: you cannot swap onto a day you or they are on leave. A swap that creates back-to-back days shows a warning but is still allowed. Swaps close at the **swap deadline** the admin set, or when the rota is published. If the rota changes so a request no longer fits, it is closed automatically and you are both told. After publication, swaps go through the admin.

2.9 Rules

The **Rules** page explains how a period works, how shifts are shared, leave points and limits, preferred days, swaps and your tally. It is the same information summarised in this chapter.



2.10 Tips

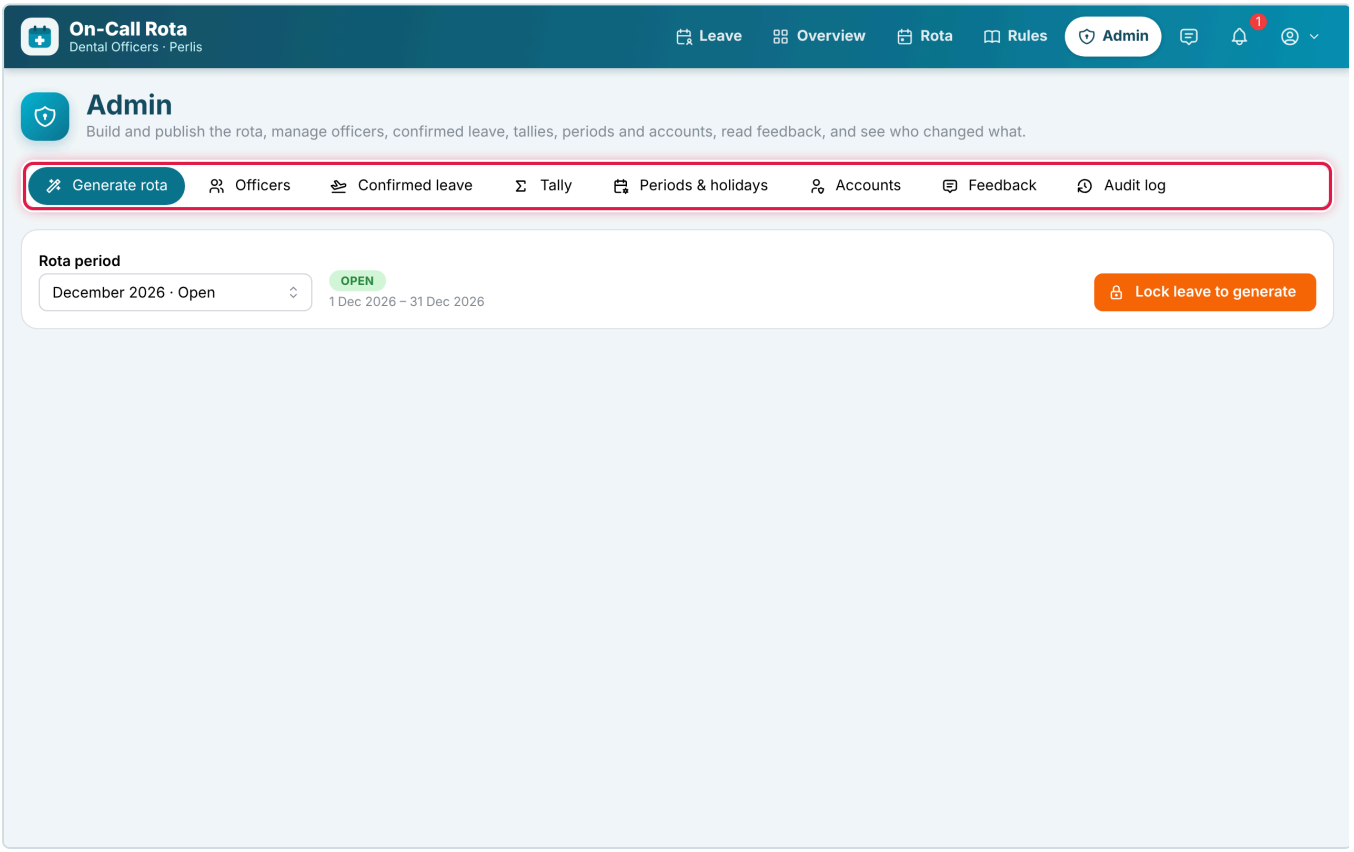
- Mark leave early, especially weekends, public holidays and peak days.
- Check your dates as soon as the draft is in review, so there is time to swap.
- Away with no points left? Ask the admin for extra points early.
- Any question about points, limits or your tally: ask the admin.

CHAPTER 3

Chapter 3: Admin guide

Officers, accounts, periods and holidays, confirmed leave, generating and publishing the rota, tally, feedback and audit log. For admins.

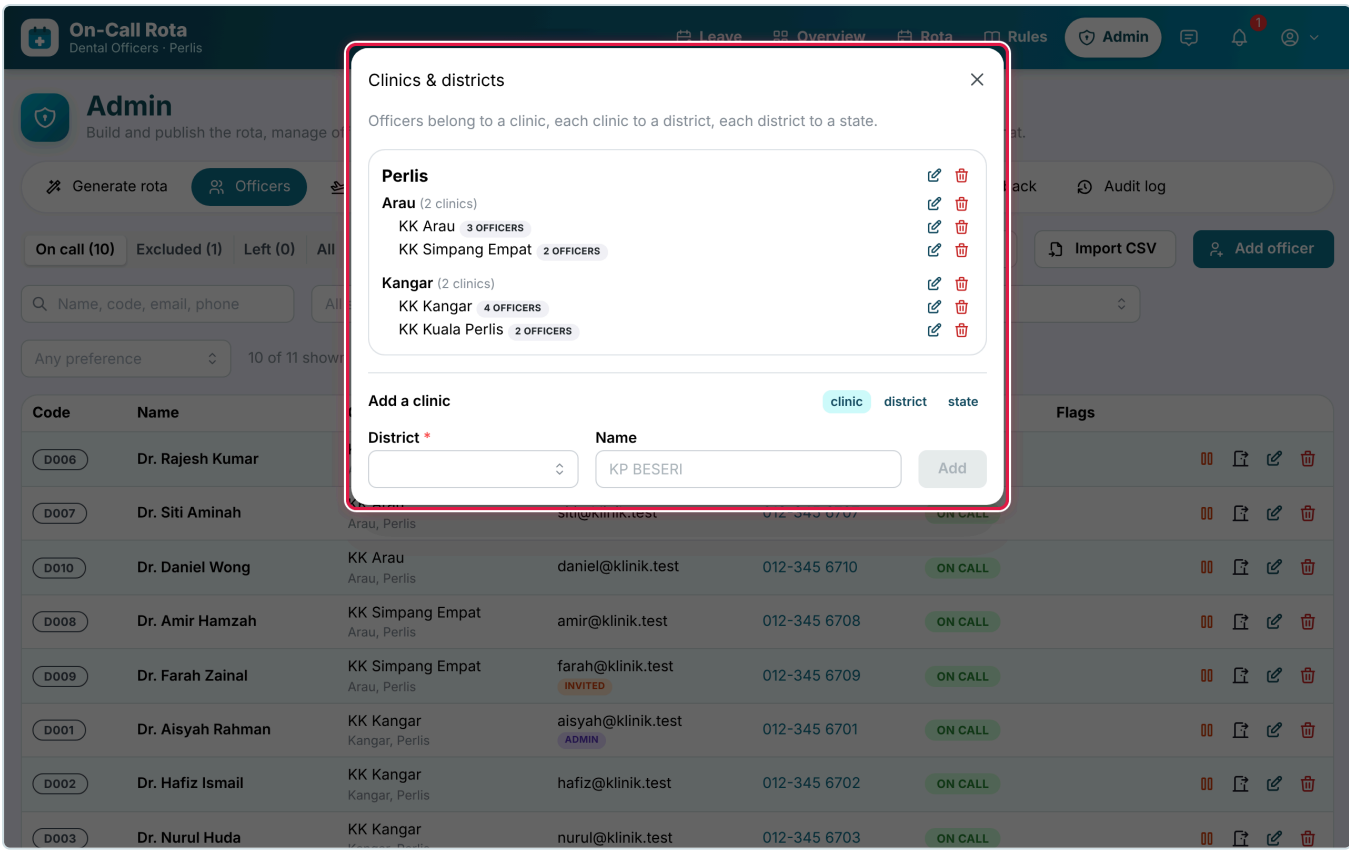
Admins and supervisors see an **Admin** item in the header. Admin has eight tabs: **Generate rota**, **Officers**, **Confirmed leave**, **Tally**, **Periods & holidays**, **Accounts**, **Feedback** and **Audit log**. The usual order of work is: set up officers and clinics once, then for each period: create it, let officers enter leave, lock it, generate and adjust the rota, send it for review, publish.



3.1 Set up clinics and districts (once)

Officers belong to a clinic, which belongs to a district and state (Perlis, with Kangar and Arau to start).

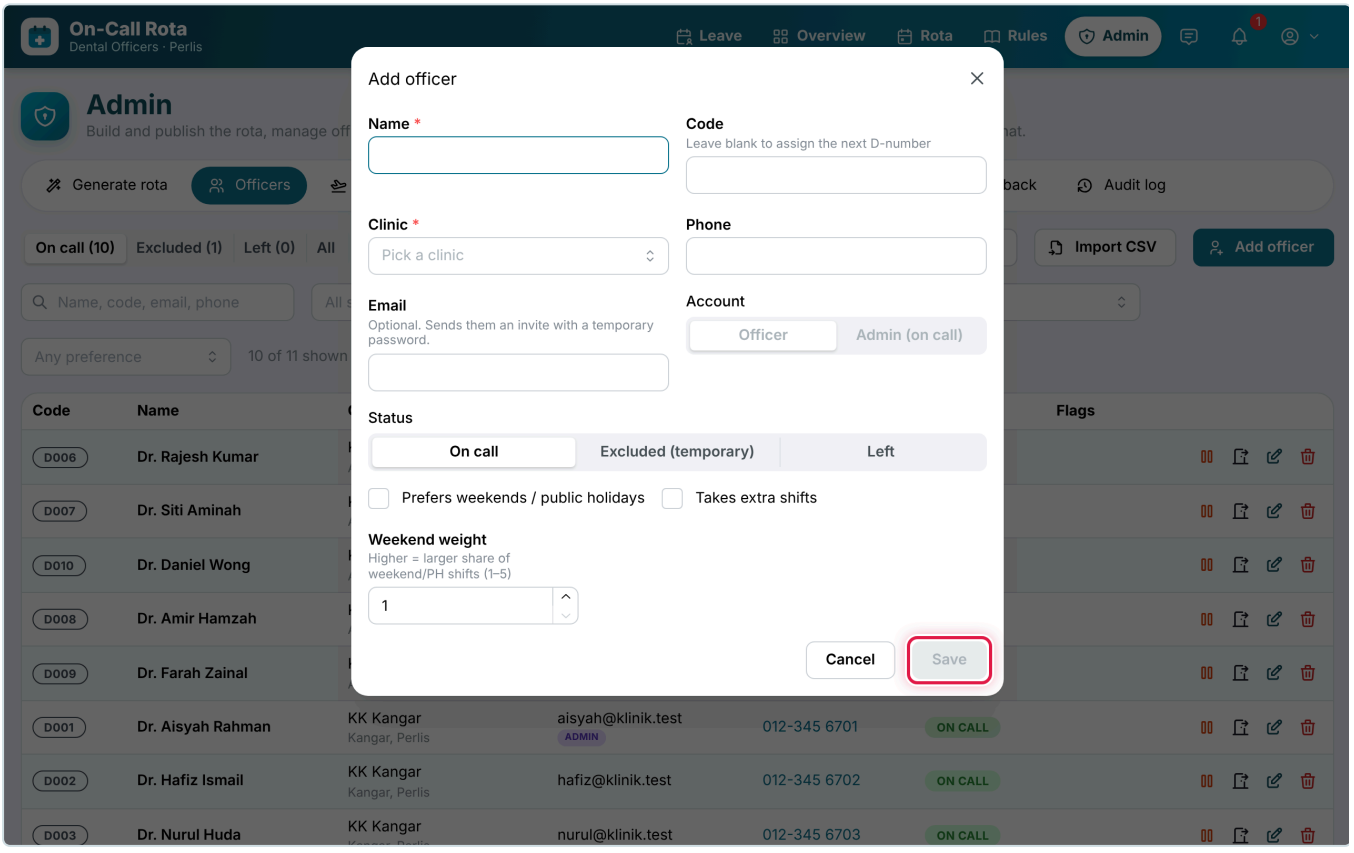
1. Open **Admin > Officers** and press **Clinics & districts**.
2. Add or edit states, districts and clinics. A clinic needs a name and a district.



3.2 Add officers

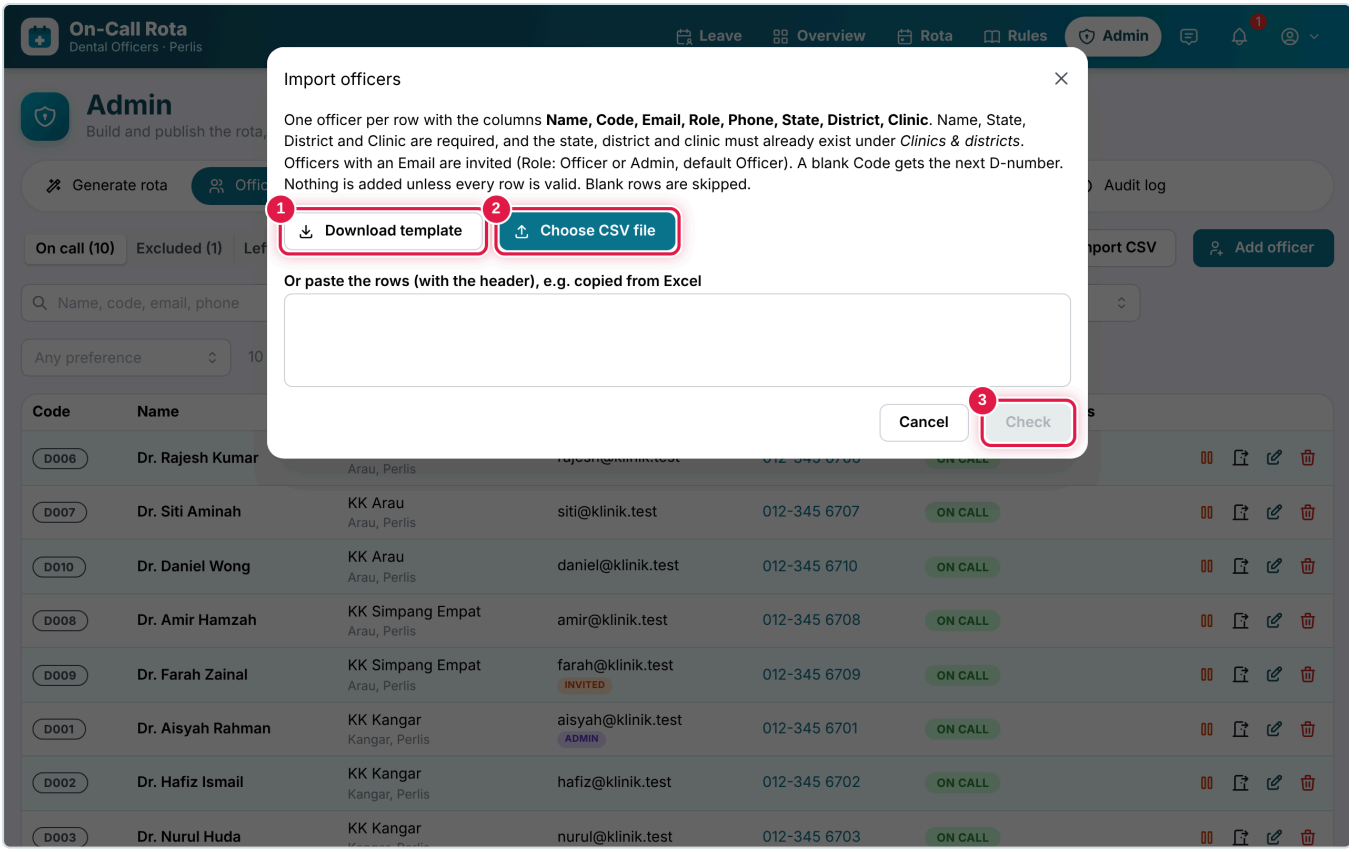
One at a time

1. Admin > **Officers** > **Add officer**.
2. Fill **Name** and **Clinic** (required). **Code** can stay blank: the next D-number is assigned. **Phone** is optional.
3. Enter an **Email** to invite them in the same step, and choose their **Role**: Officer or Admin (on call). They get a temporary password and must change it at first sign-in. Without email set up on the server, the temporary password is shown to you once so you can pass it on.
4. Set **Status** (normally On call). Tick **Prefers weekends / public holidays** or **Takes extra shifts** only when agreed, and **Weekend weight** (1 to 5) sets a bigger share of weekend shifts. Press **Save**.



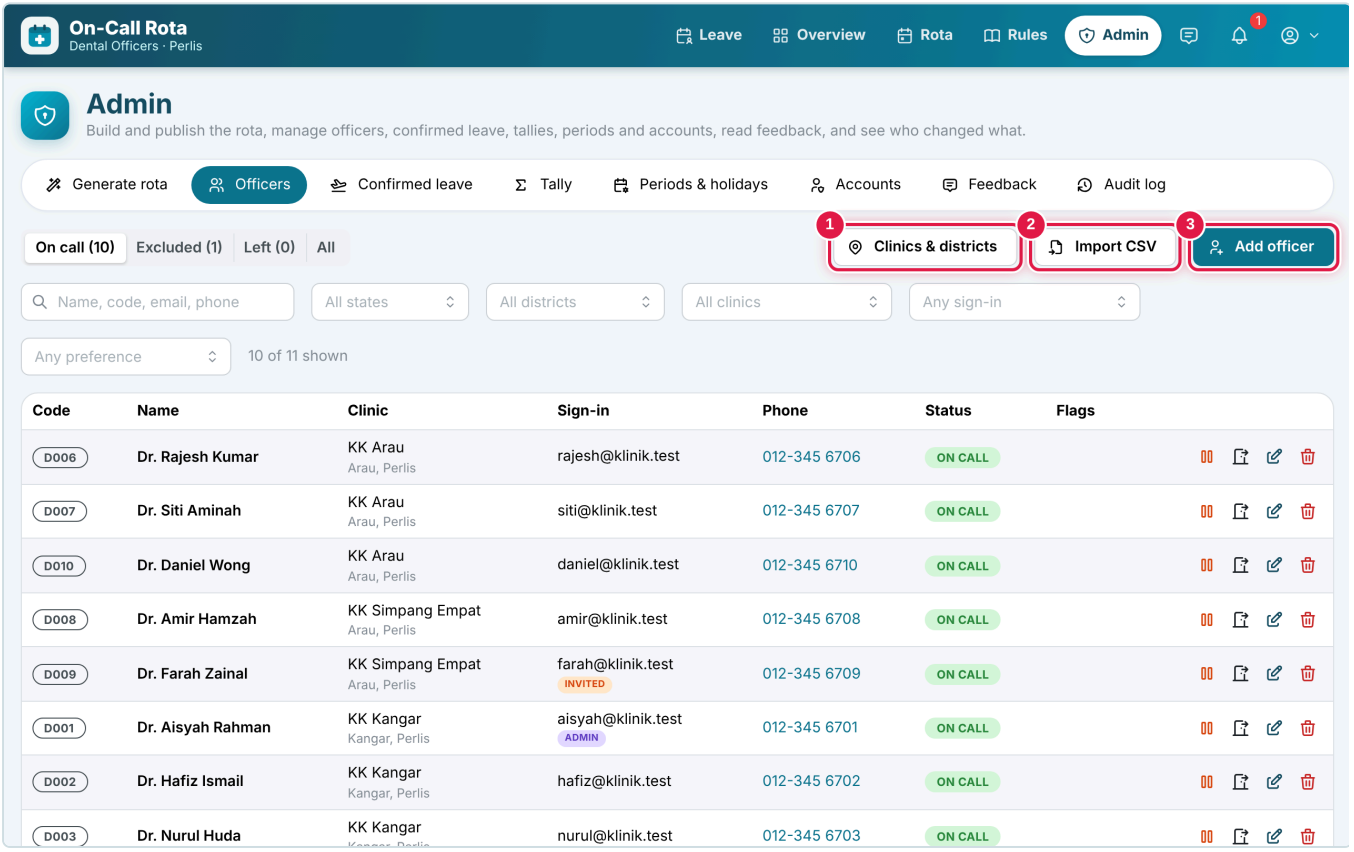
Many at once: Import CSV

1. Press **Import CSV**, then **Download template** to get the columns (Name, Code, Email, Role, Phone, State, District, Clinic).
2. Fill the template, then **Choose CSV file** or paste the rows into the box.
3. Press **Check**. The app lists every problem with its row, column and reason, and adds nothing unless every row is valid. Fix and check again, then confirm the import.

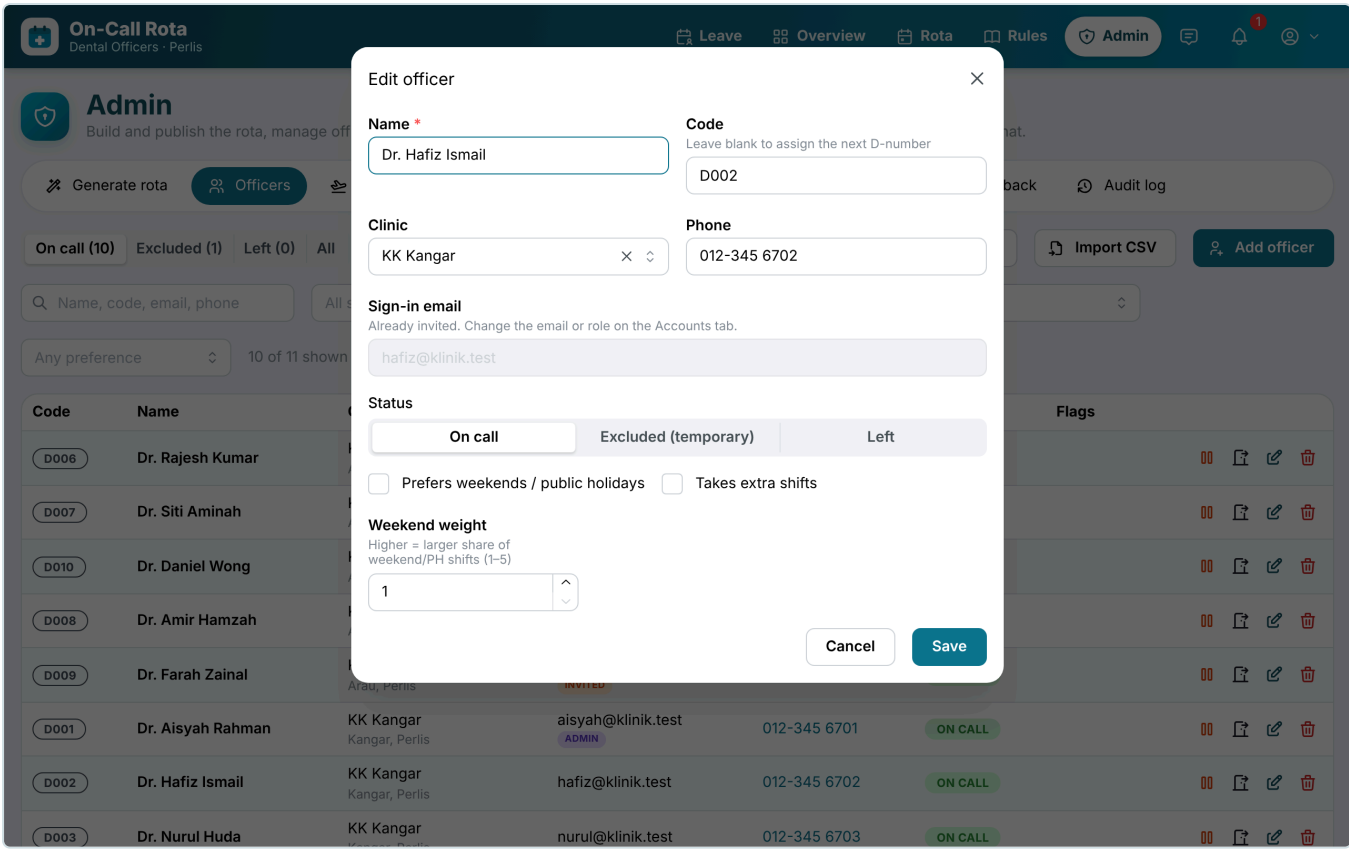

On-Call Rota
Dental Officers · Perlis
Leave
Overview
Rota
Rules
Admin
Admin
Build and publish the rota
Generate rota
Audit log
On call (10)
Excluded (1)
Add officer
Name, code, email, phone
Any preference
Code
Name
Import officers
One officer per row with the columns Name, Code, Email, Role, Phone, State, District, Clinic. Name, State, District and Clinic are required, and the state, district and clinic must already exist under Clinics & districts. Officers with an Email are invited (Role: Officer or Admin, default Officer). A blank Code gets the next D-number. Nothing is added unless every row is valid. Blank rows are skipped.
1
Download template
2
Choose CSV file
Or paste the rows (with the header), e.g. copied from Excel
Cancel
3
Check
D006 Dr. Rajesh Kumar
D007 Dr. Siti Aminah KK Arau Arau, Perlis siti@klinik.test 012-345 6707 ON CALL
D010 Dr. Daniel Wong KK Arau Arau, Perlis daniel@klinik.test 012-345 6710 ON CALL
D008 Dr. Amir Hamzah KK Simpang Empat Arau, Perlis amir@klinik.test 012-345 6708 ON CALL
D009 Dr. Farah Zainal KK Simpang Empat Arau, Perlis farah@klinik.test INVITED 012-345 6709 ON CALL
D001 Dr. Aisyah Rahman KK Kangar Kangar, Perlis aisyah@klinik.test ADMIN 012-345 6701 ON CALL
D002 Dr. Hafiz Ismail KK Kangar Kangar, Perlis hafiz@klinik.test 012-345 6702 ON CALL
D003 Dr. Nurul Huda KK Kangar nurul@klinik.test 012-345 6703 ON CALL

3.3 Manage officers

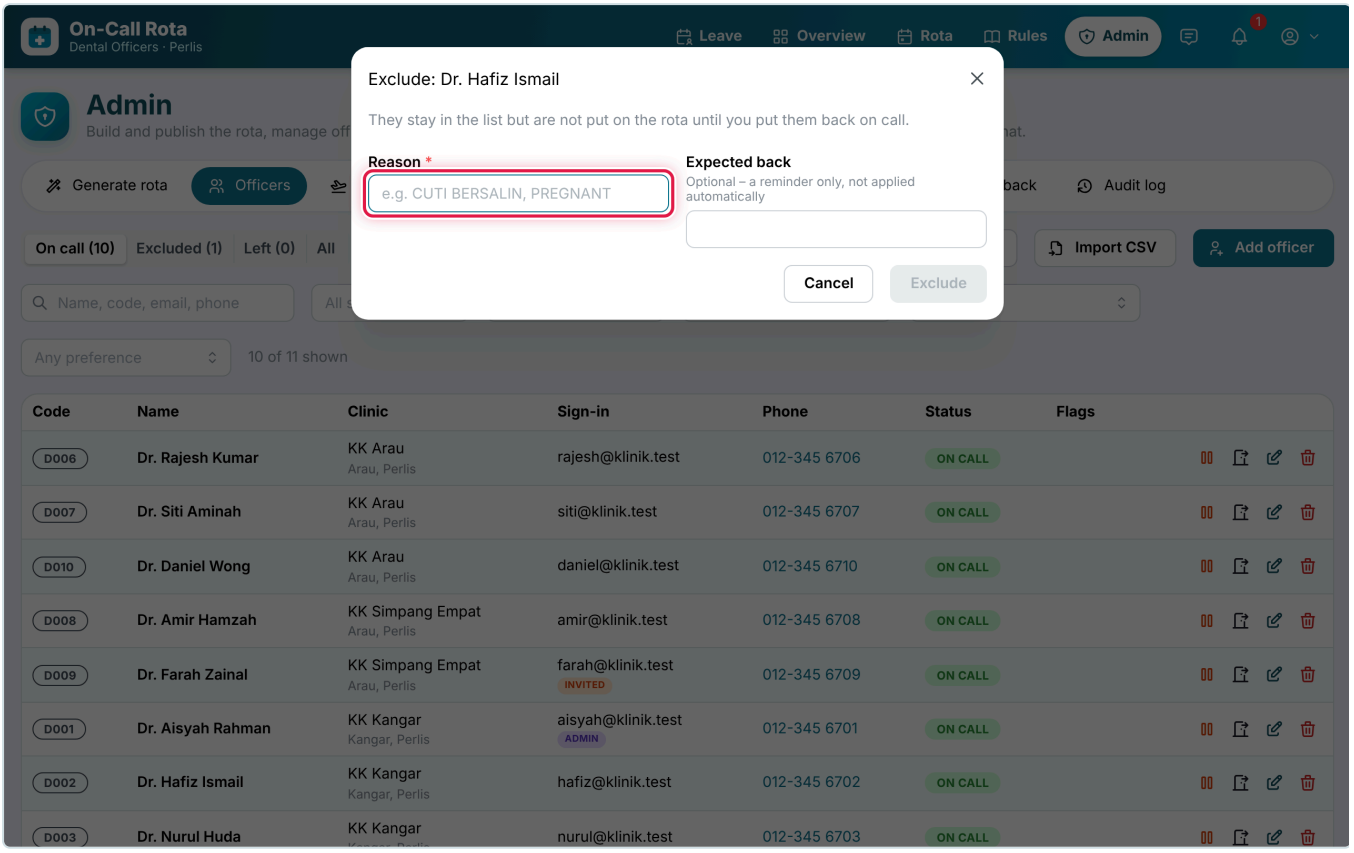
The **Officers** tab lists **On call**, **Excluded**, **Left** and **All**, with filters for name, state, district, clinic, sign-in and preference. Each row has icons for **Exclude**, **Mark as left**, **Edit** and **Delete**.



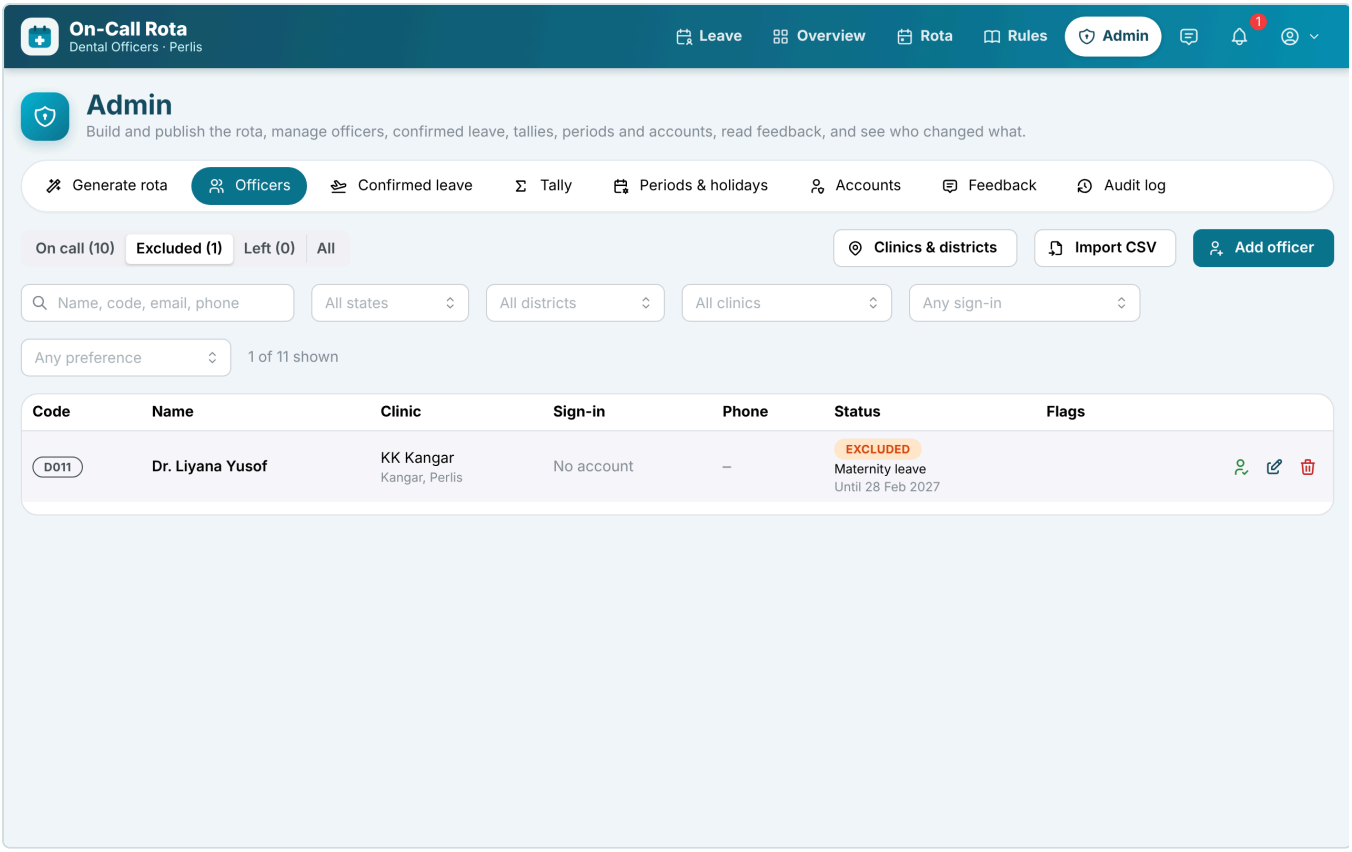
- **Edit** changes name, clinic, phone and the shift settings.



- **Exclude** (for example maternity leave) takes the officer out of the rota without losing history. Enter a **Reason** and an optional **Expected back** date (a reminder only). Use the green **Put back on call** icon when they return.

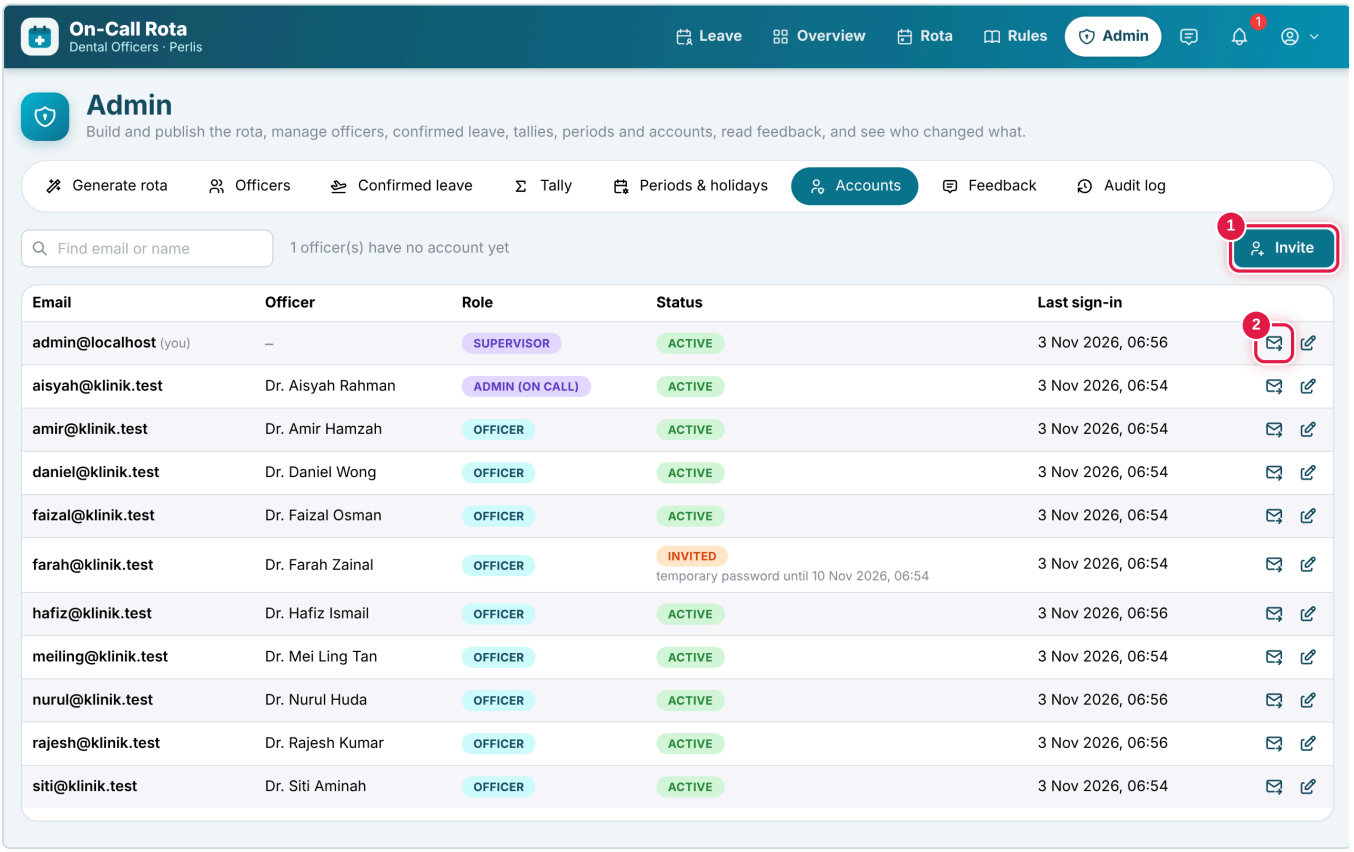


- **Mark as left** is for officers who moved out or resigned: hidden by default, history kept.

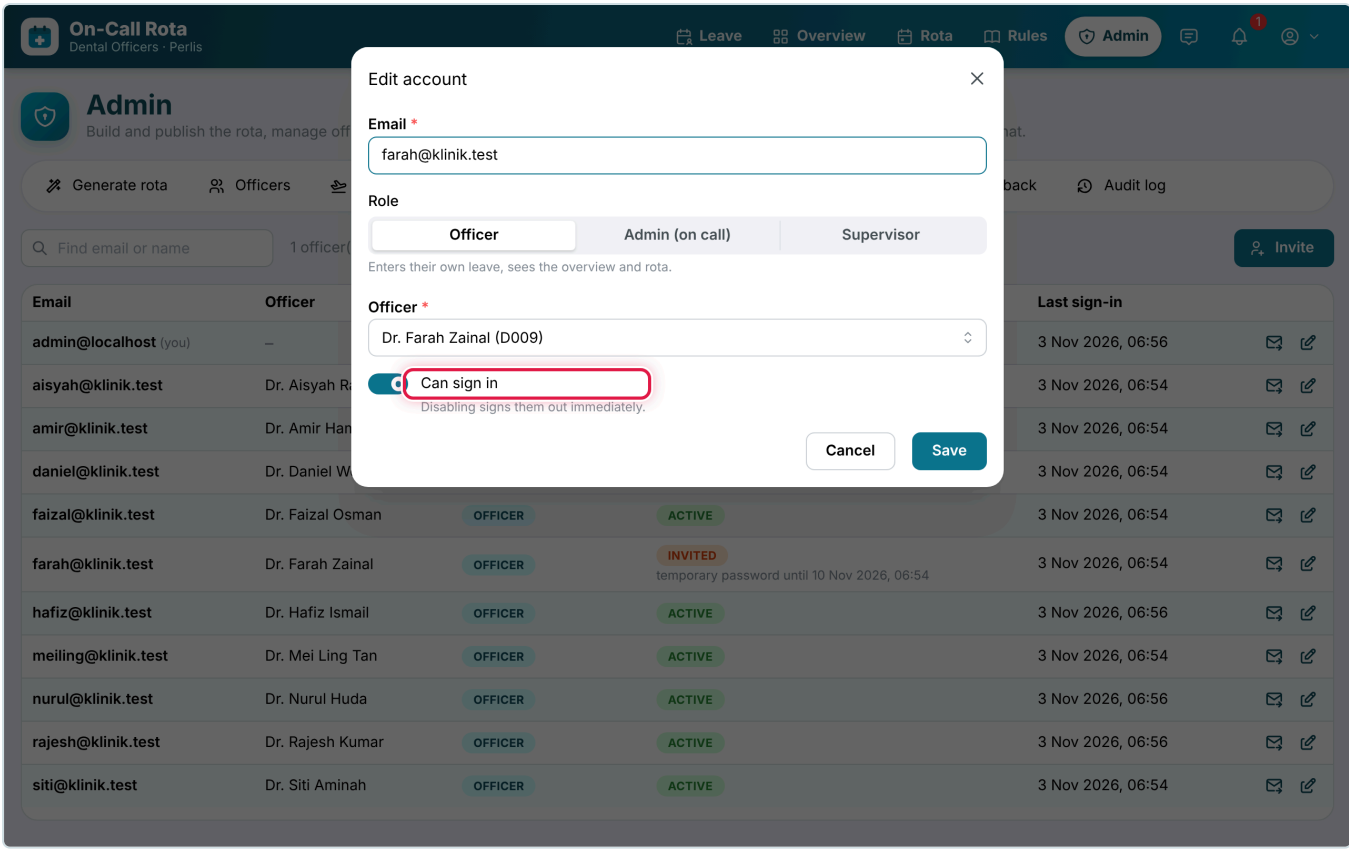

On-Call Rota
Dental Officers · Perlis
Leave
Overview
Rota
Rules
Admin
1
Admin
Build and publish the rota, manage officers, confirmed leave, tallies, periods and accounts, read feedback, and see who changed what.
Generate rota
Officers
Confirmed leave
Tally
Periods & holidays
Accounts
Feedback
Audit log
On call (10)
Excluded (1)
Left (0)
All
Clinics & districts
Import CSV
Add officer
Name, code, email, phone
All states
All districts
All clinics
Any sign-in
Any preference
1 of 11 shown
Code
Name
Clinic
Sign-in
Phone
Status
Flags
D011
Dr. Liyana Yusof
KK Kangar
Kangar, Perlis
No account
–
EXCLUDED
Maternity leave
Until 28 Feb 2027

3.4 Accounts

Accounts lists every sign-in with its role, linked officer, status and last sign-in.

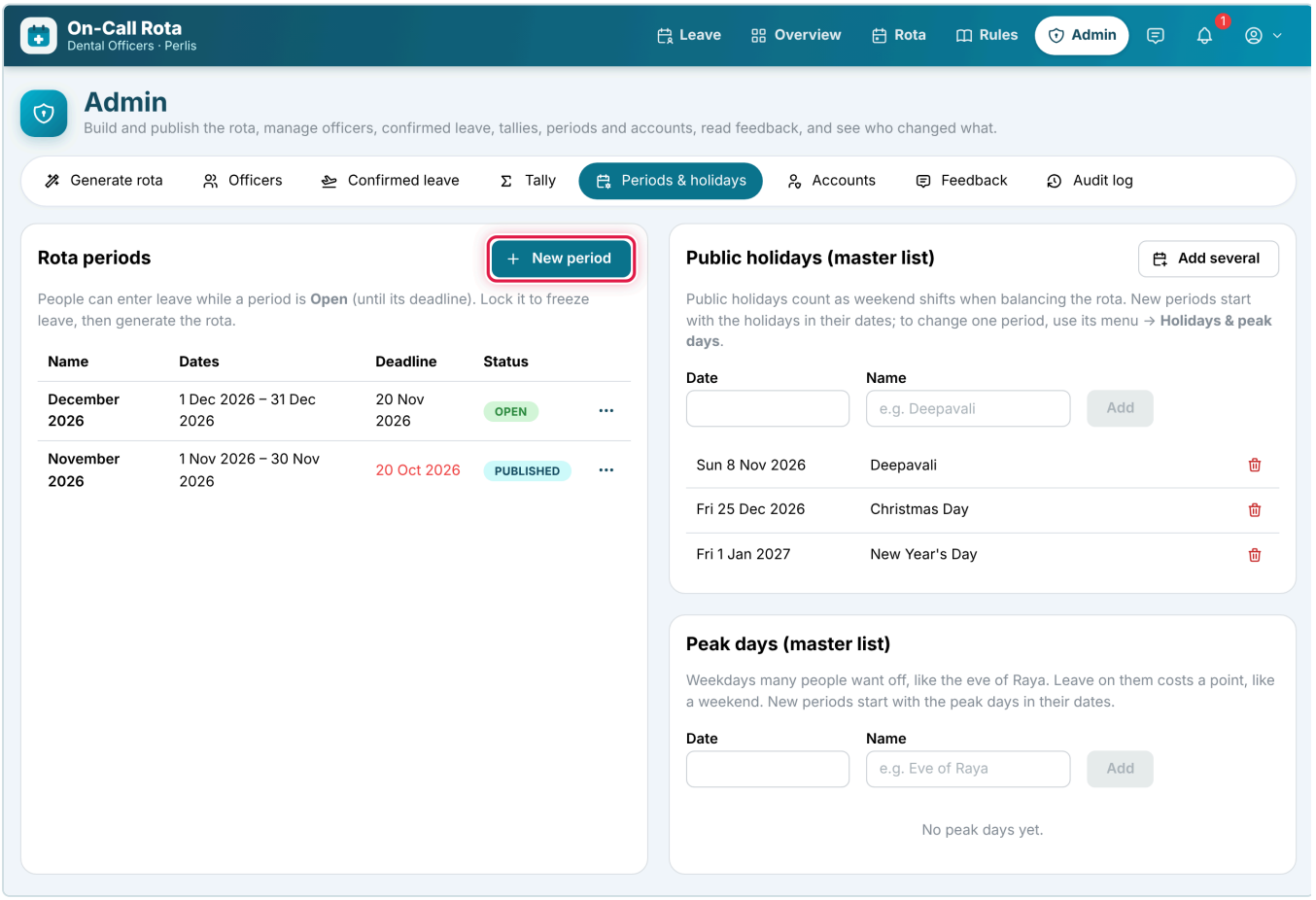


1. **Invite** creates an account for an email, with a role (Officer, Admin or Supervisor) and the officer it belongs to.
2. The envelope icon sends a **new temporary password** (re-invite or password reset).
3. **Edit** changes the email, role or officer, or switches **Can sign in** off to lock someone out immediately.


On-Call Rota
Dental Officers · Perlis
Leave
Overview
Rota
Rules
Admin
Admin
Build and publish the rota, manage off
Generate rota
Officers
back
Audit log
Find email or name
1 officer(
Invite
Email
Officer
Last sign-in
admin@localhost (you)
3 Nov 2026, 06:56
aisyah@klinik.test
Dr. Aisyah R
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
amir@klinik.test
Dr. Amir Han
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
daniel@klinik.test
Dr. Daniel W
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
faizal@klinik.test
Dr. Faizal Osman
OFFICER
ACTIVE
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
farah@klinik.test
Dr. Farah Zainal
OFFICER
INVITED
temporary password until 10 Nov 2026, 06:54
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
hafiz@klinik.test
Dr. Hafiz Ismail
OFFICER
ACTIVE
3 Nov 2026, 06:56
meiling@klinik.test
Dr. Mei Ling Tan
OFFICER
ACTIVE
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
nurul@klinik.test
Dr. Nurul Huda
OFFICER
ACTIVE
3 Nov 2026, 06:56
rajesh@klinik.test
Dr. Rajesh Kumar
OFFICER
ACTIVE
3 Nov 2026, 06:56
siti@klinik.test
Dr. Siti Aminah
OFFICER
ACTIVE
3 Nov 2026, 06:54
Edit account
Email *
farah@klinik.test
Role
Officer
Admin (on call)
Supervisor
Enters their own leave, sees the overview and rota.
Officer *
Dr. Farah Zainal (D009)
Can sign in
Disabling signs them out immediately.
Cancel
Save

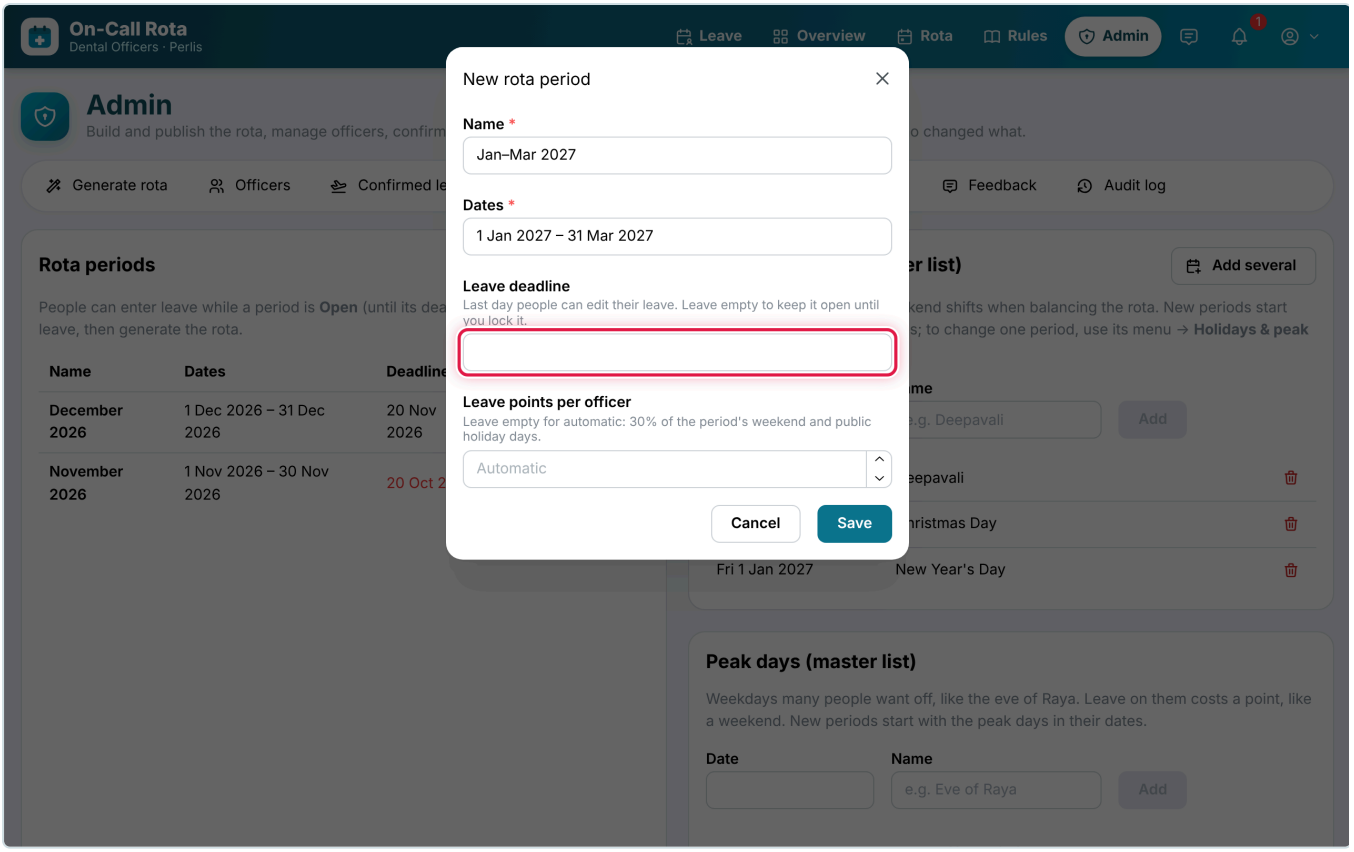
3.5 Periods, public holidays and peak days

Open **Admin > Periods & holidays**.

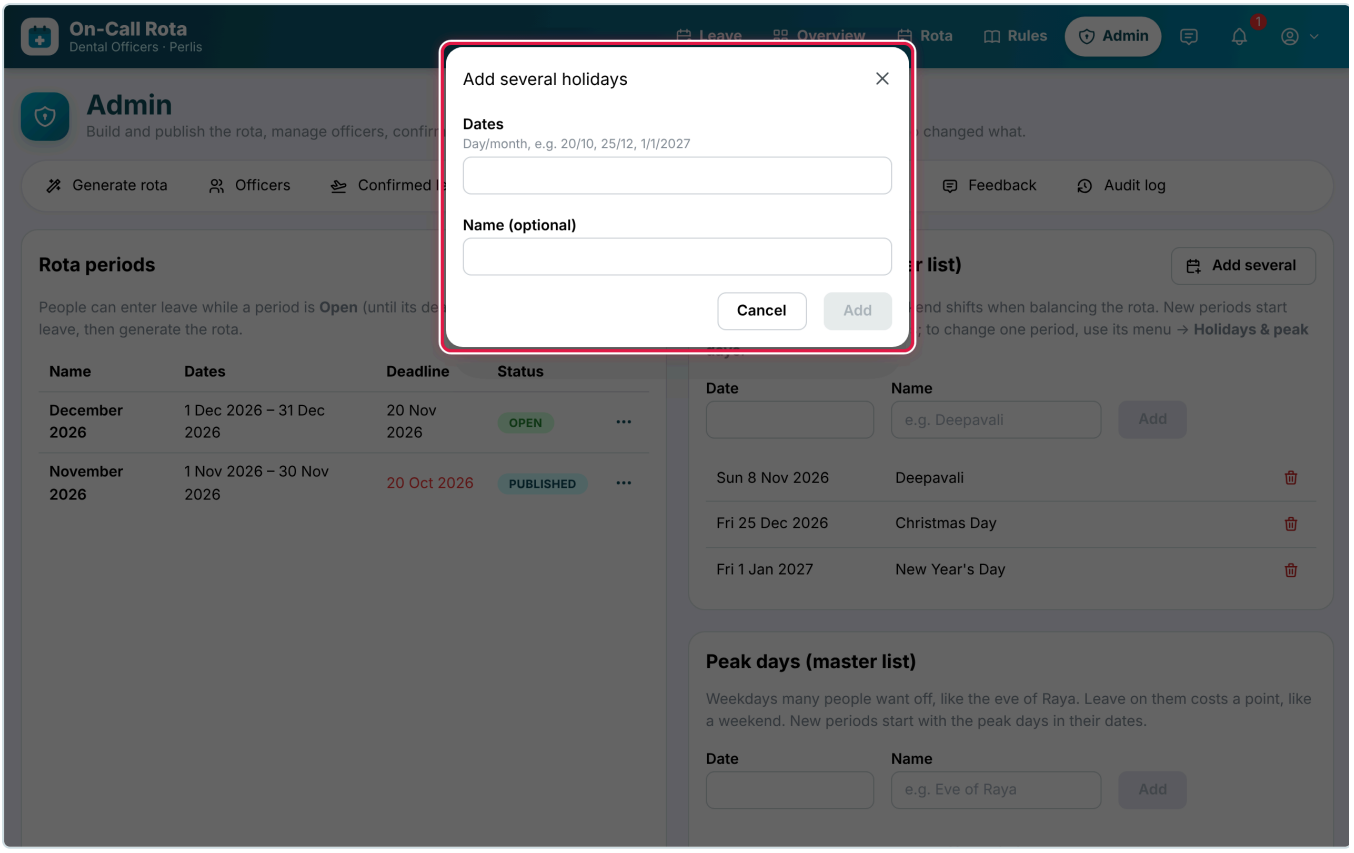


Create a period

1. Press **New period**. Enter a **Name**, the **Dates** (start and end) and the **Leave deadline**. Periods cannot overlap and can be at most a year.
2. Press **Save**. The period is **Open**, officers are told to enter leave, and it starts with a copy of the master public holidays and peak days that fall in its dates.

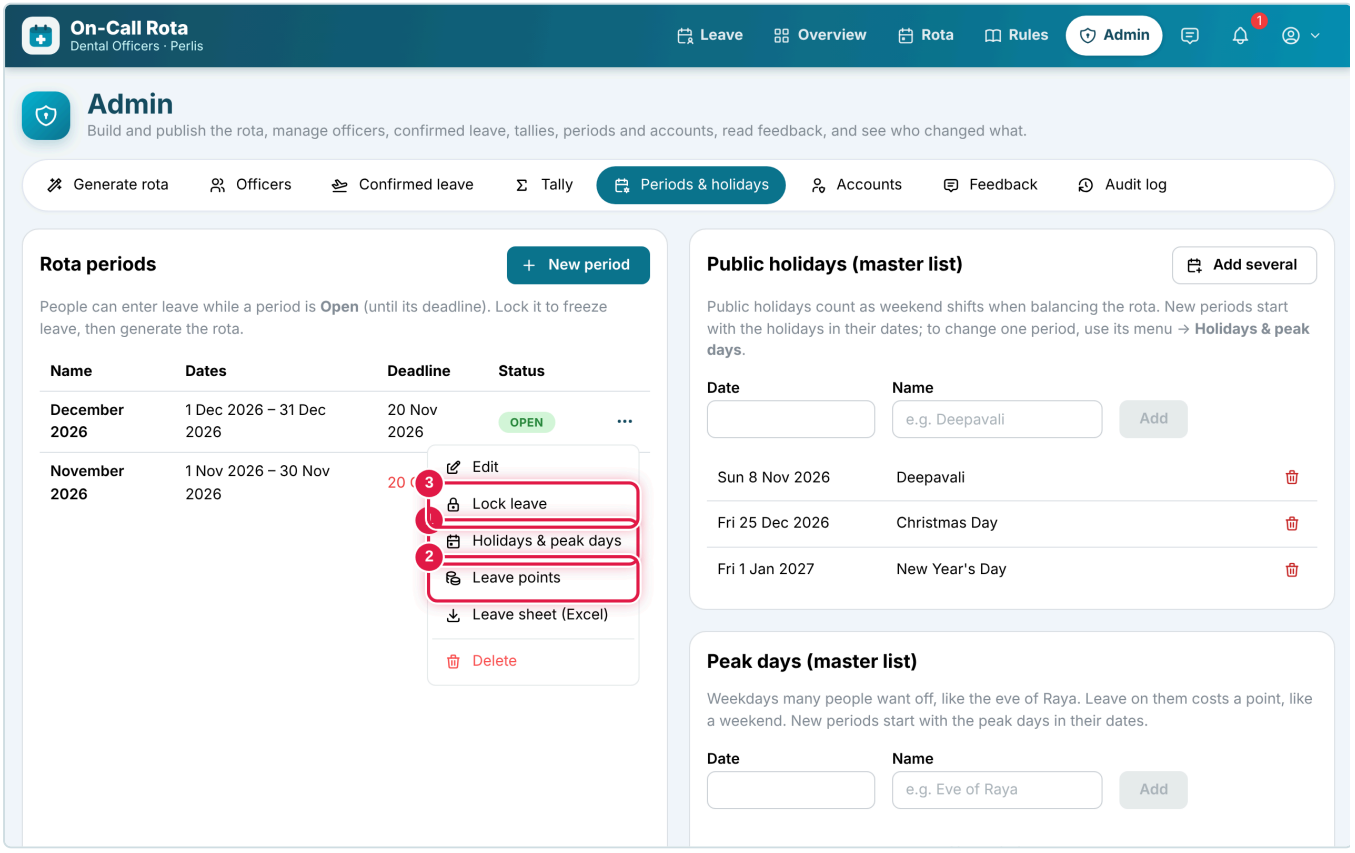


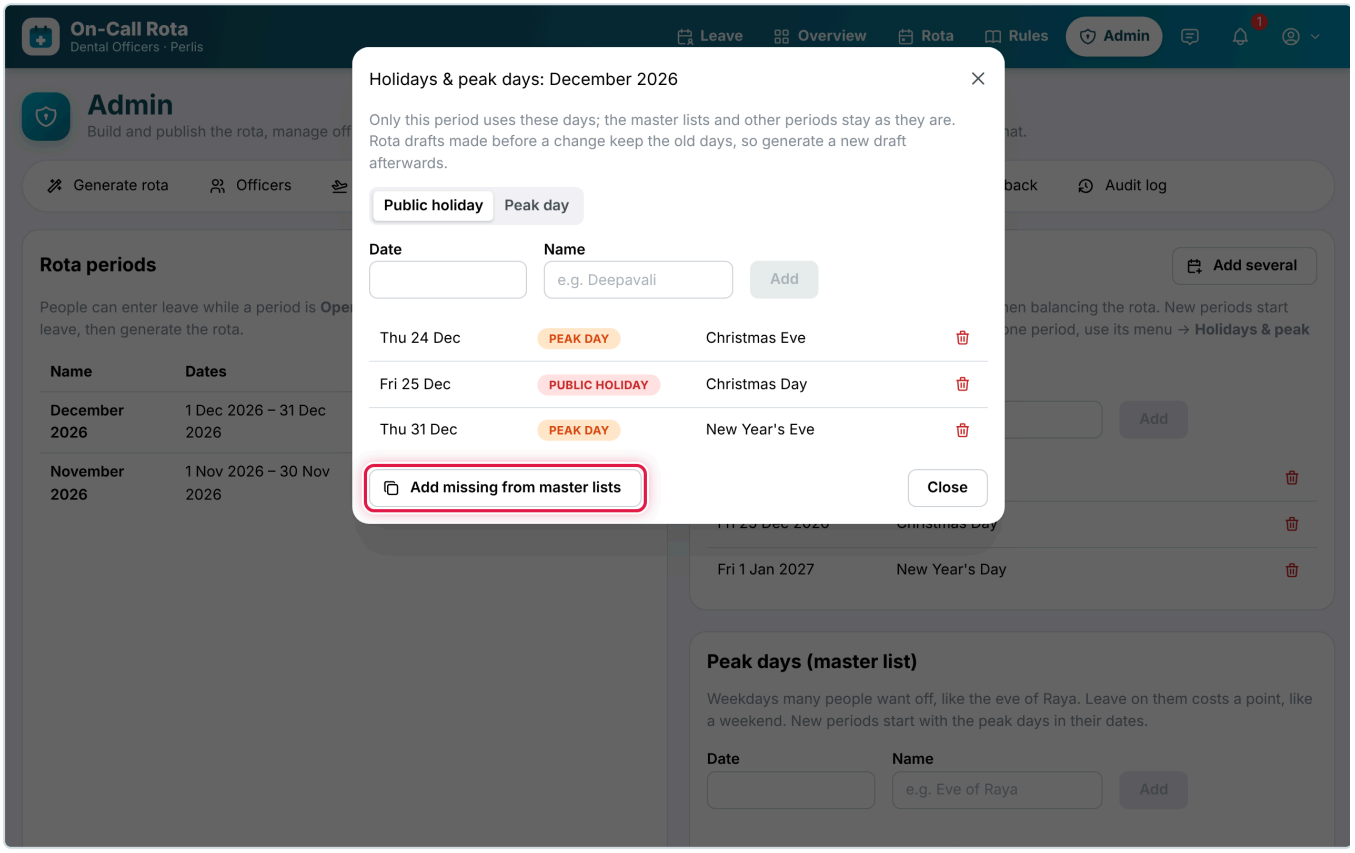
Master lists. The **Public holidays** list on the right is the master list; use **Add several** to paste many dates at once. Public holidays count as weekend shifts and cost 2 leave points. The **Peak days** list works the same way: busy weekdays that cost 1 point.



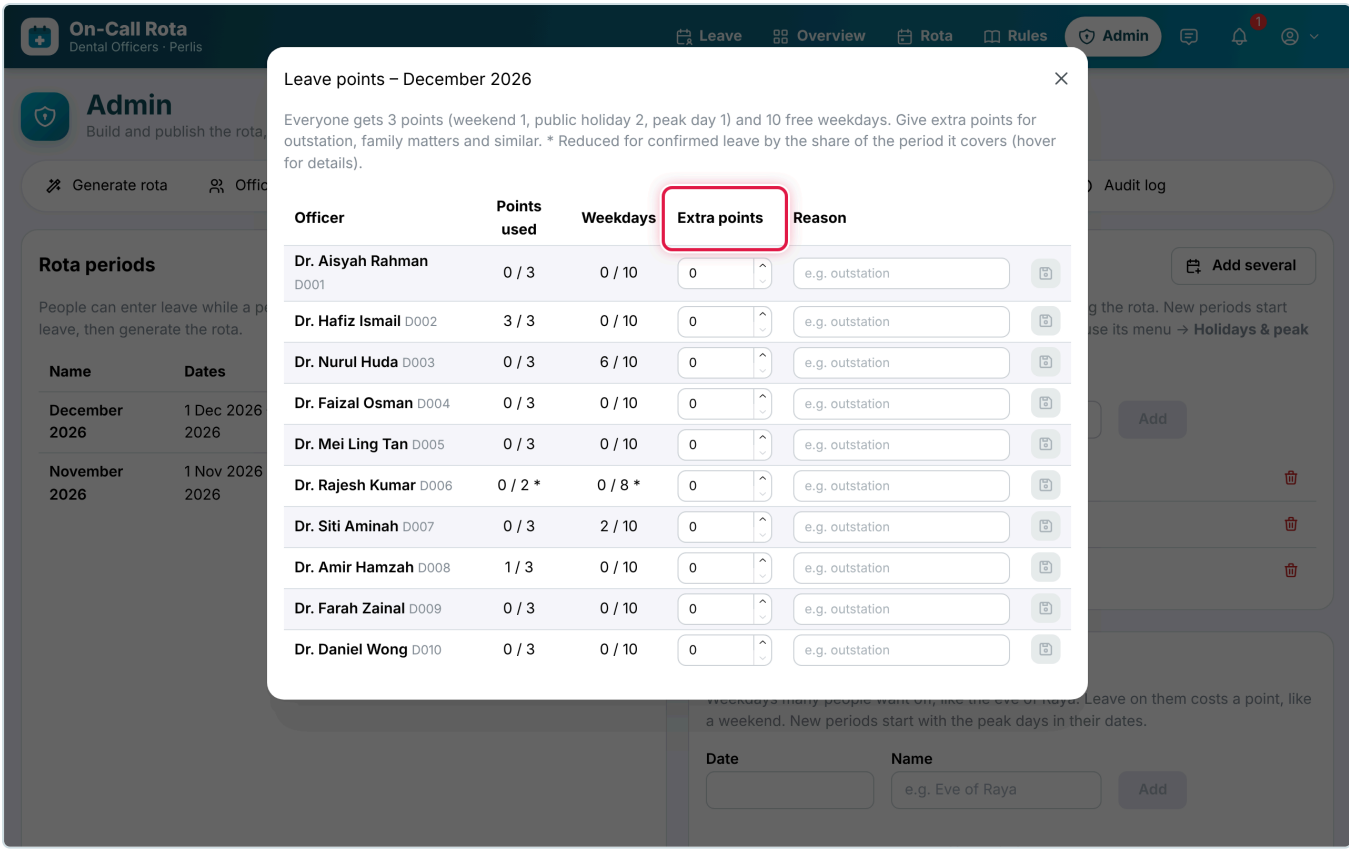
Per-period holidays and peak days. Changing a period's own list does not affect other periods or the master lists. Open the period's **…** menu and choose **Holidays & peak days**, then add or

delete days. If you change them after a rota exists, generate a new draft afterwards. **Add missing from master lists** re-copies any master days it lacks.





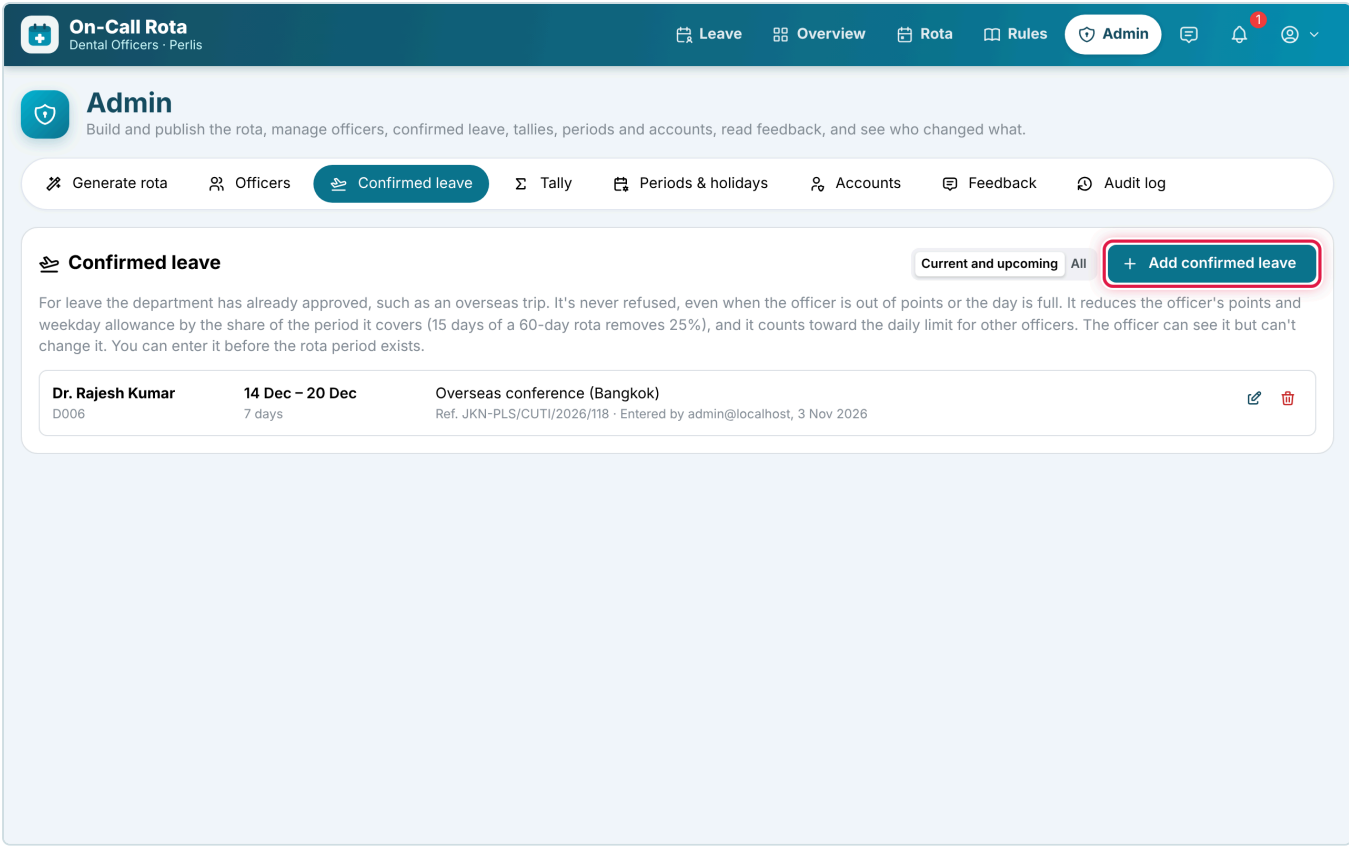
Leave points. From the same menu choose **Leave points** to see each officer's points and weekday use for the period. Type **Extra points** and a **Reason** (for example "outstation") to give an officer more, then press the save icon. An asterisk marks a budget reduced by confirmed leave.



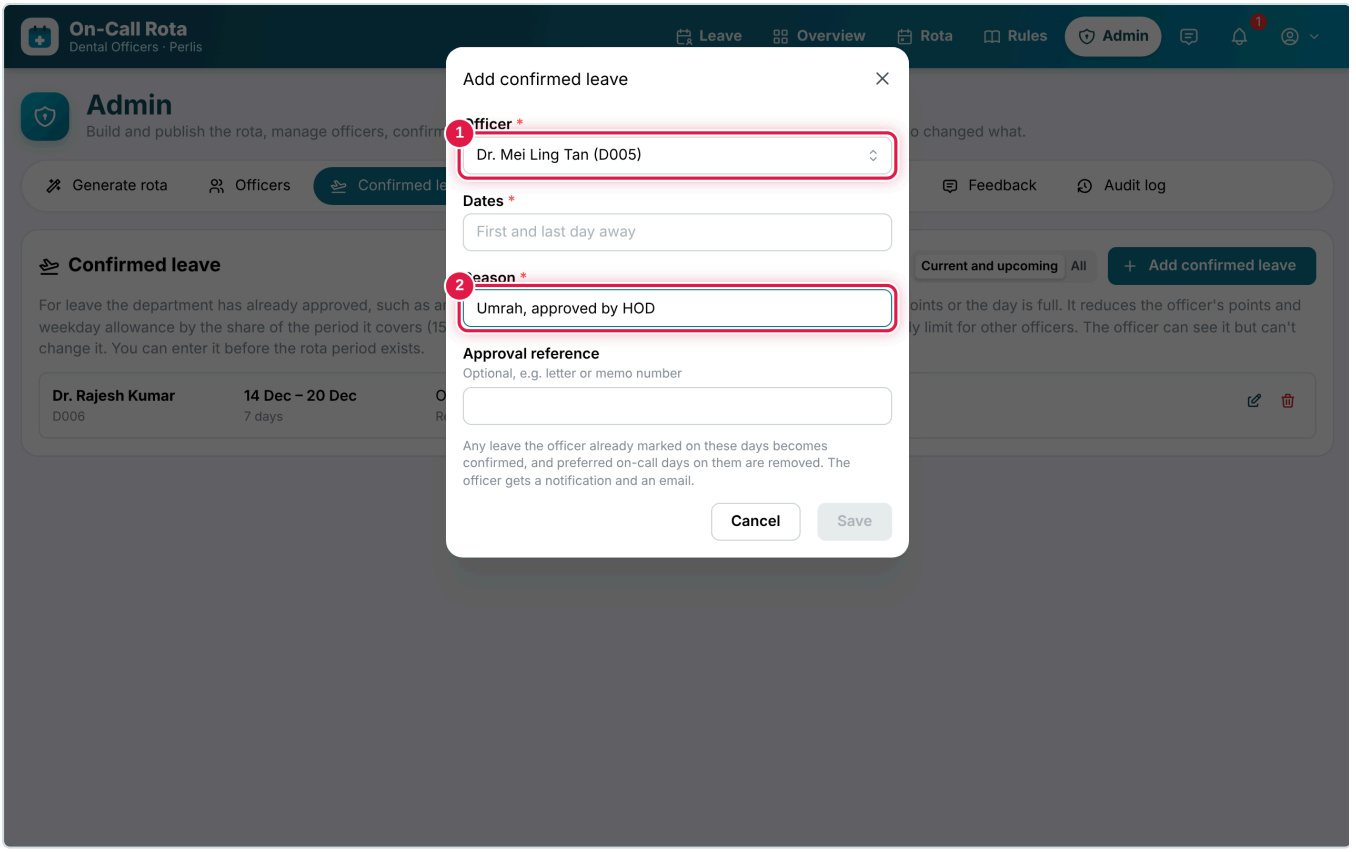
The menu also has **Edit**, **Lock leave**, **Leave sheet (Excel)** and **Delete**.

3.6 Confirmed leave (approved absences)

Use **Admin > Confirmed leave** for leave the department has already approved, such as an overseas trip. It is never refused, even when the officer is out of points or the day is full. It reduces the officer's points and weekday allowance by the share of the period it covers (15 days of a 60-day rota removes 25%), and counts towards the daily limit for other officers. The officer sees it but cannot change it. You can enter it before the period exists.



1. Press **Add confirmed leave**.
2. Pick the **Officer**, the **Dates** (first and last day away) and a **Reason**. Add an **Approval reference** if you have one (a letter or memo number).
3. Press **Save**. The officer gets a notification and an email, and any preferred on-call days inside the dates are removed.

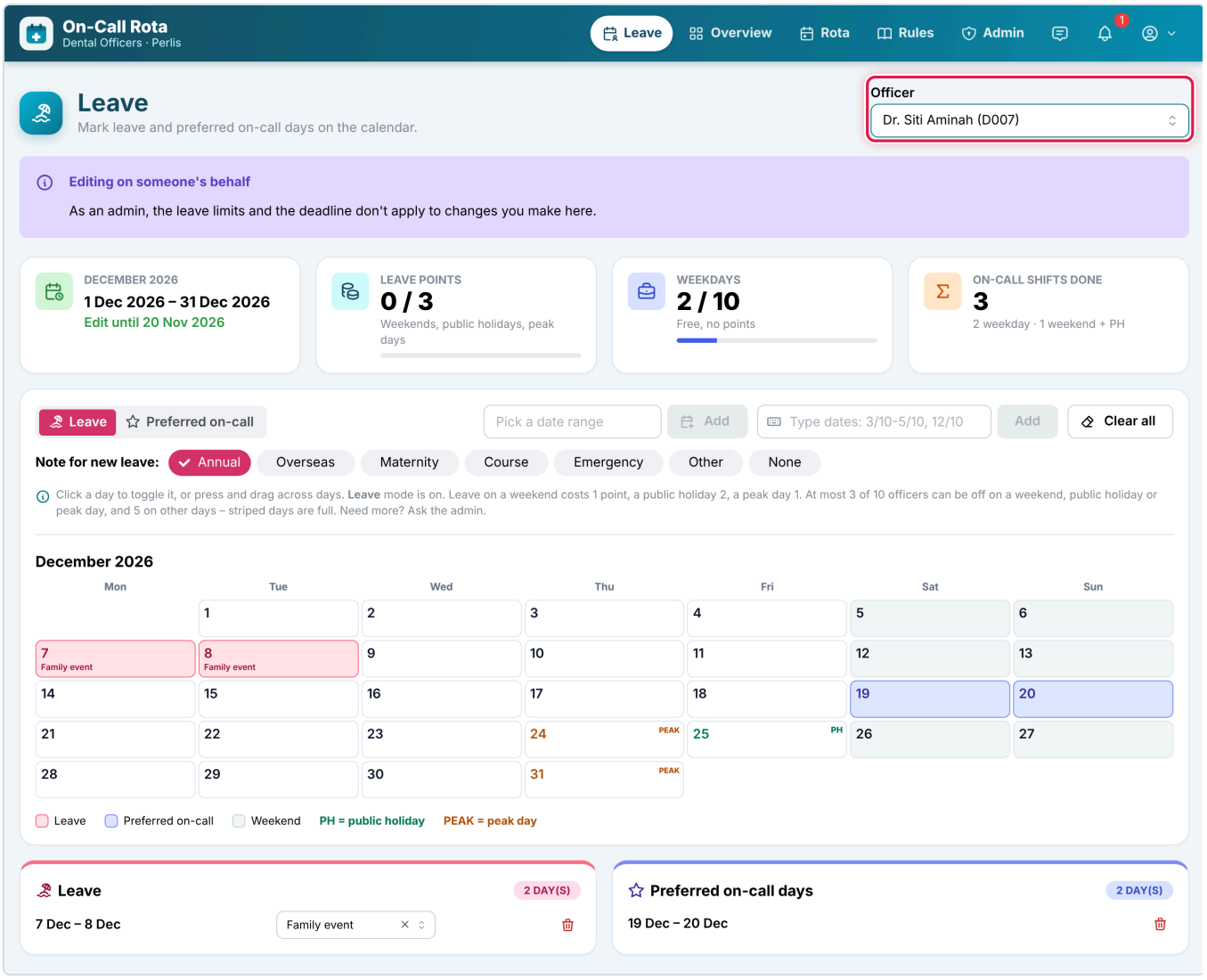


If the officer is already on a draft rota for those days, the page offers to hand each shift to someone else. Use the pencil and bin icons to edit or remove an entry. Switch between **Current and upcoming** and **All** to see past entries.

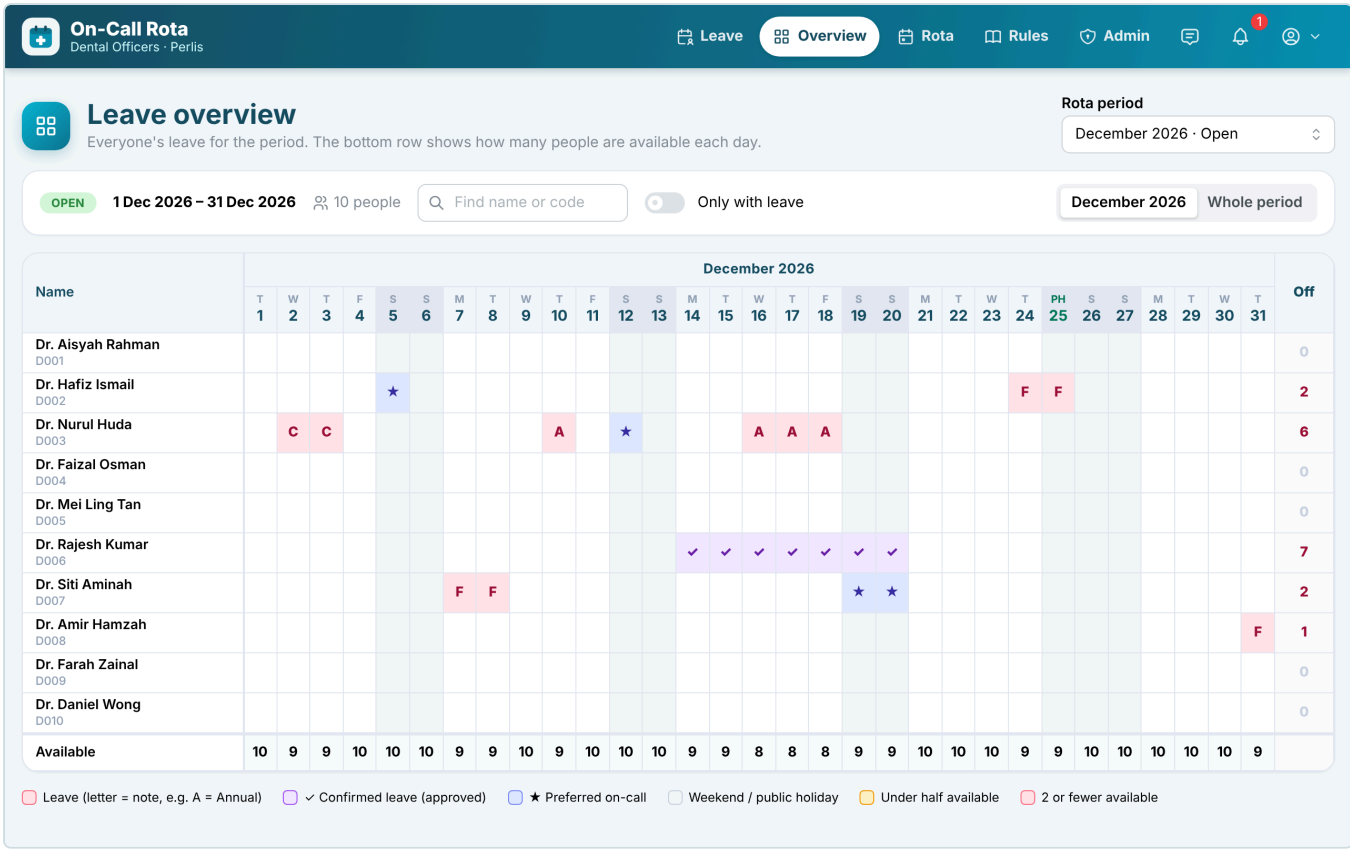
3.7 Enter or fix an officer’s leave

Officers enter their own leave. Admins can edit anyone’s leave at any time: there is no deadline and the leave limits do not apply, as with the old spreadsheet.

1. Open **Leave** in the header and pick the **Officer**.
2. Edit the calendar exactly as in section 2.1 and press **Save**.



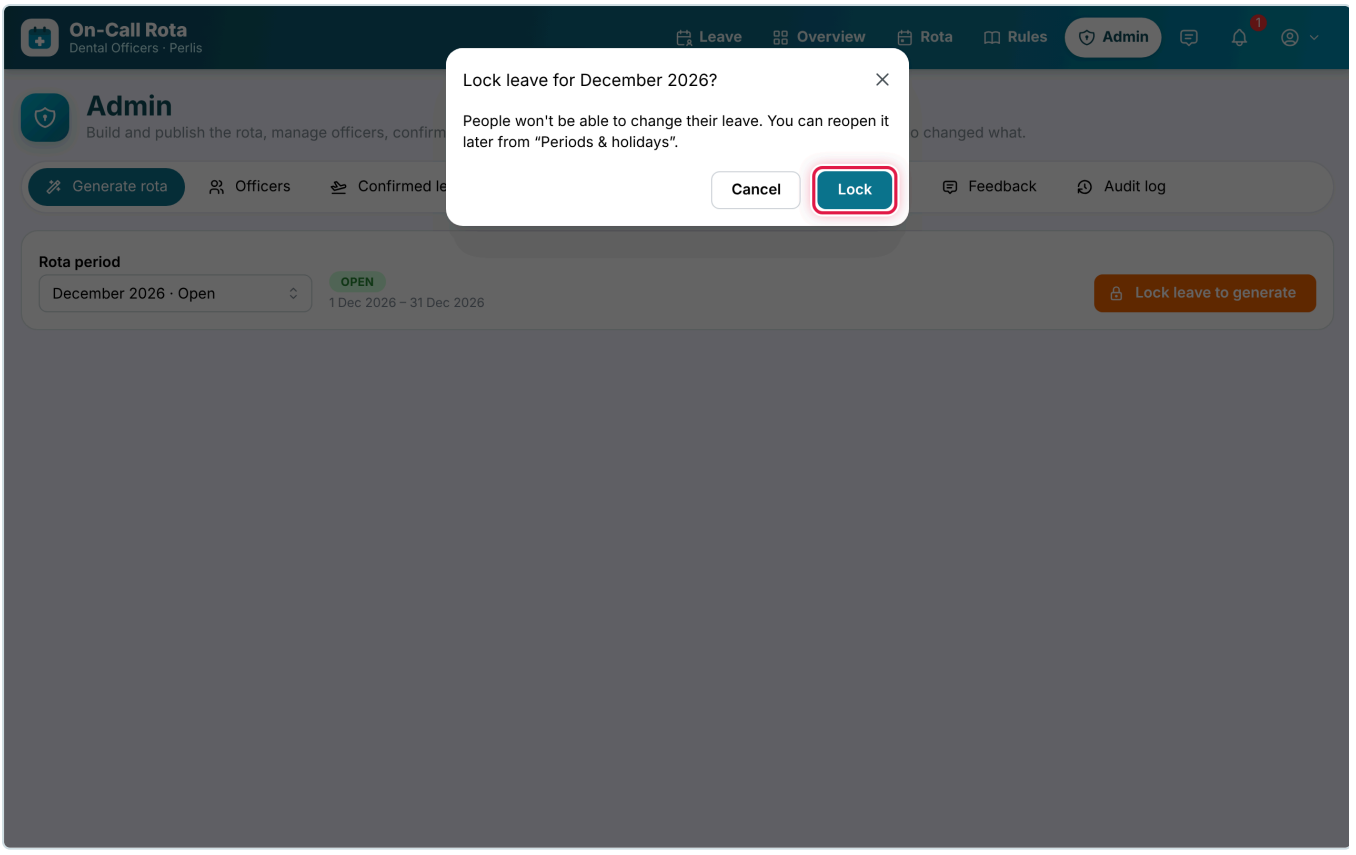
Overview (header) shows everyone’s leave and availability for a period, which helps you spot weak days before generating.

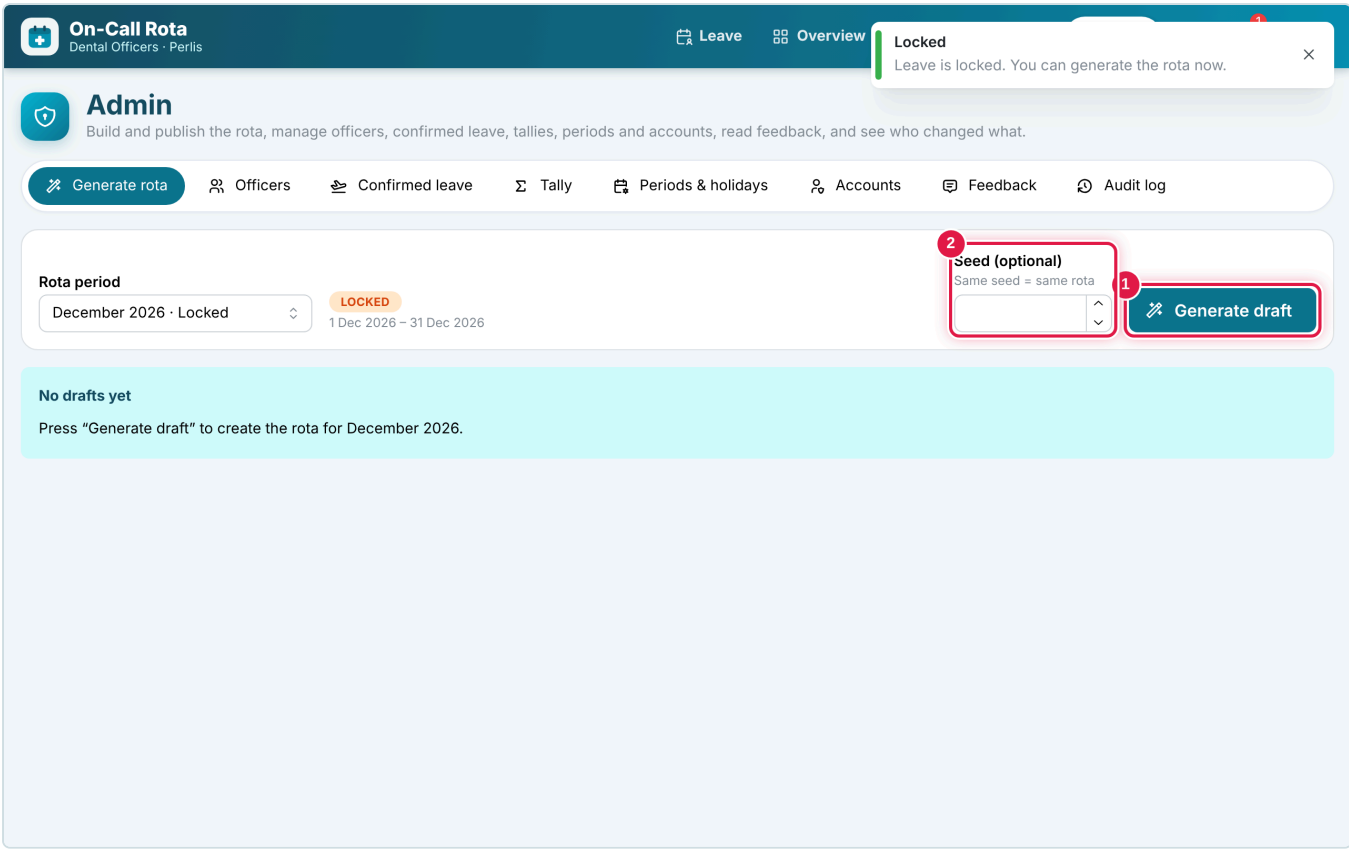

On-Call Rota
Dental Officers · Perlis
Leave
Overview
Rota
Rules
Admin
Leave overview
Everyone's leave for the period. The bottom row shows how many people are available each day.
Rota period
December 2026 · Open
OPEN
1 Dec 2026 – 31 Dec 2026
10 people
Find name or code
Only with leave
December 2026
Whole period
Name
December 2026
Off
Dr. Aisyah Rahman D001
Dr. Hafiz Ismail D002
Dr. Nurul Huda D003
Dr. Faizal Osman D004
Dr. Mei Ling Tan D005
Dr. Rajesh Kumar D006
Dr. Siti Aminah D007
Dr. Amir Hamzah D008
Dr. Farah Zainal D009
Dr. Daniel Wong D010
Available
Leave (letter = note, e.g. A = Annual)
✓ Confirmed leave (approved)
★ Preferred on-call
Weekend / public holiday
Under half available
2 or fewer available

3.8 Lock leave and generate the rota

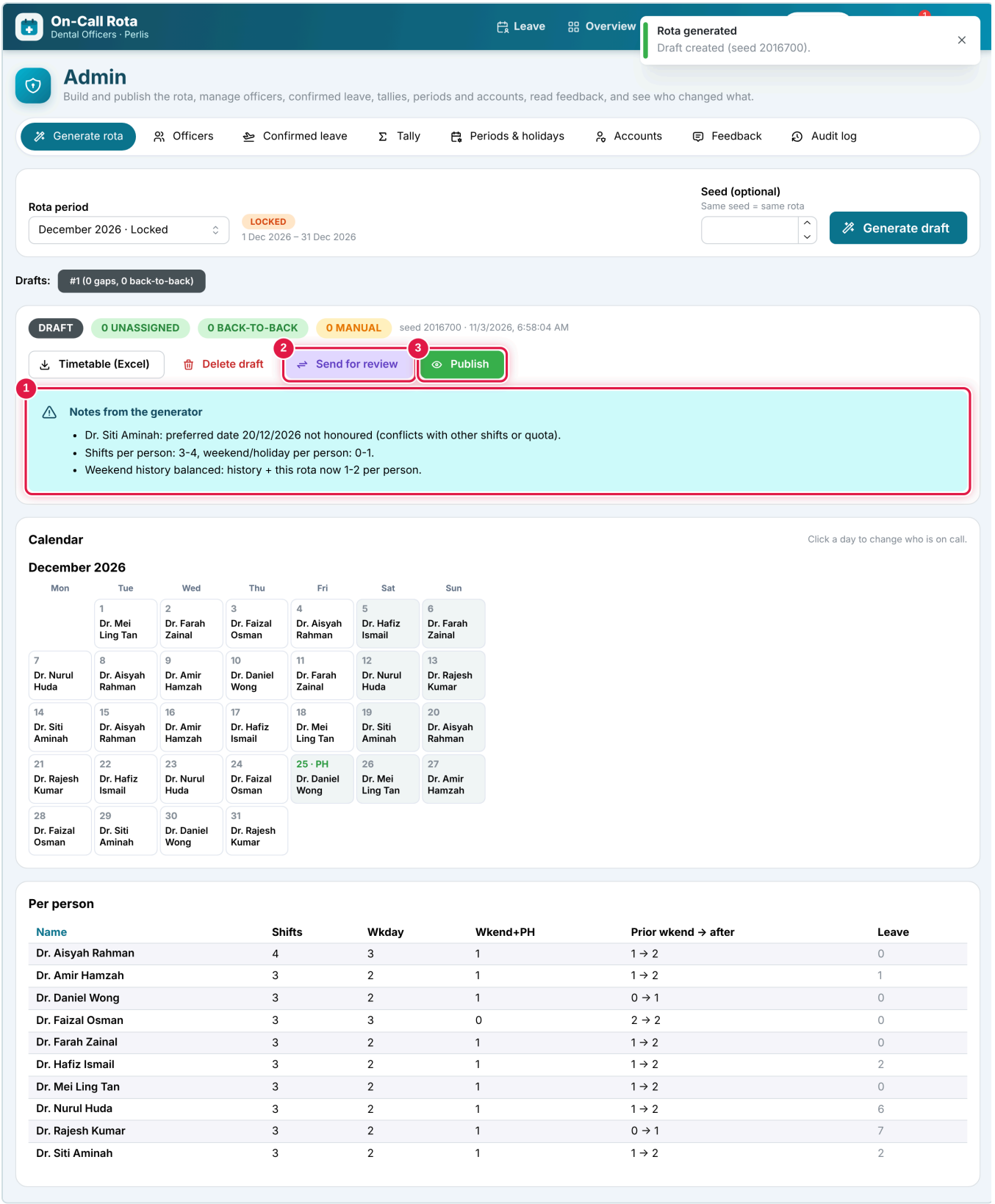
Open **Admin > Generate rota** and pick the **Rota period**.

1. When the deadline has passed, press **Lock leave to generate** and confirm **Lock**. Officers can no longer change their leave. (If you locked too early, **Periods & holidays** lets you reopen it.)

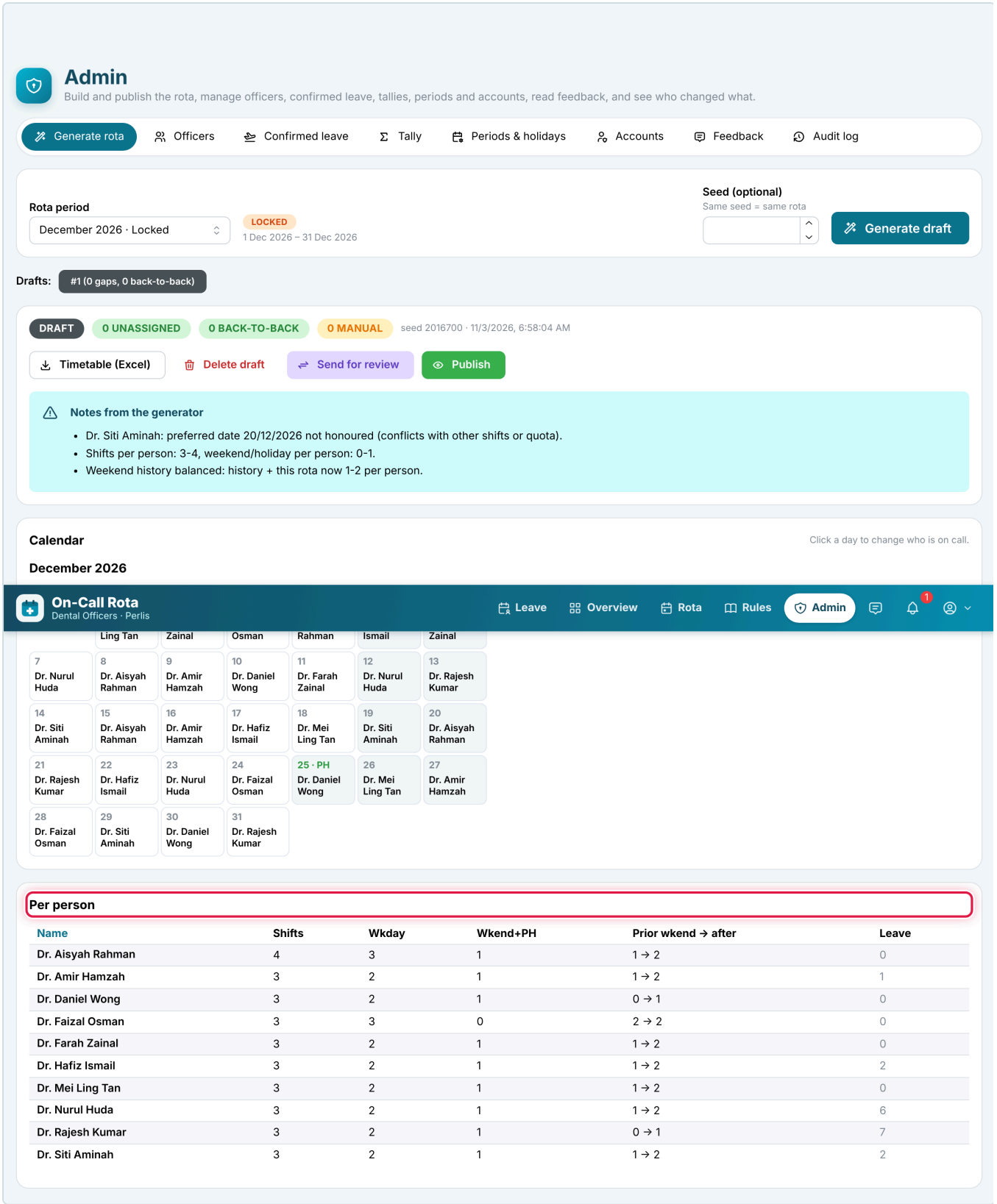




2. Press **Generate draft**. Optionally enter a **Seed** first: the same seed gives the same rota.
3. Read the badges on the draft (**Unassigned**, **Back-to-back**, **Manual**) and the **Notes from the generator**, which explain things such as a preferred date that could not be honoured and how weekend history was balanced.



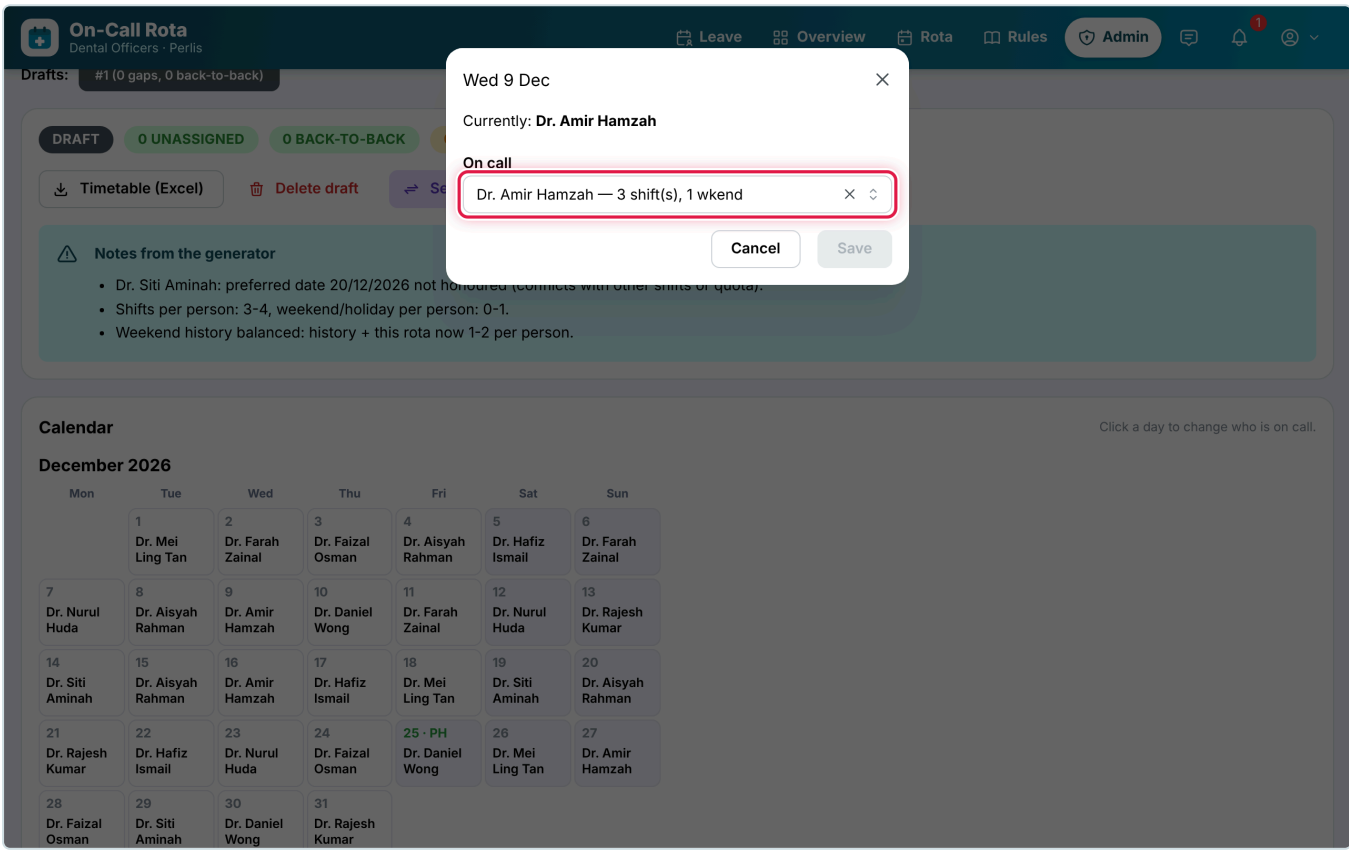
4. Under **Calendar** you see each day's officer; **Per person** lists shifts, weekday and weekend counts, the change in weekend history, and leave.

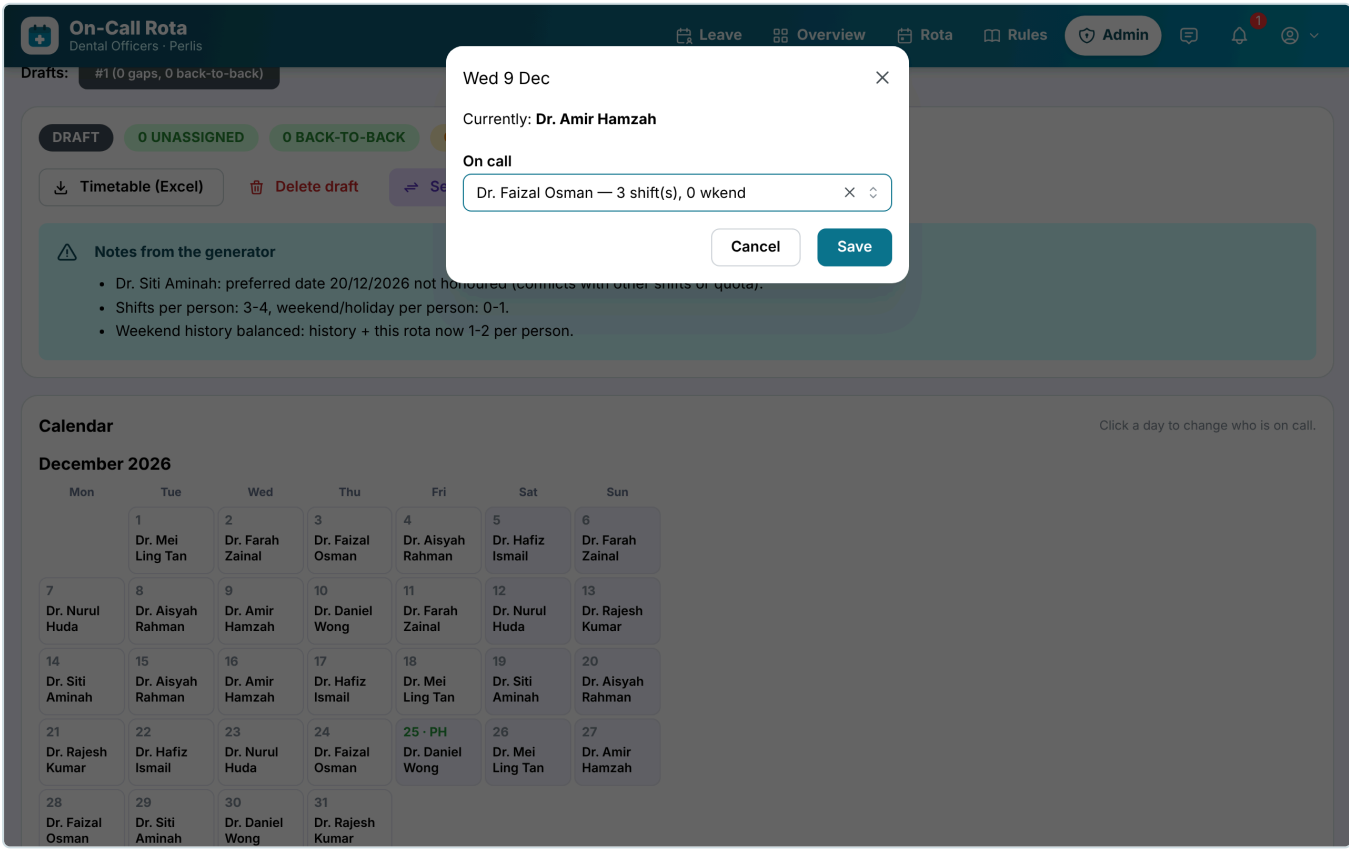


You can generate more than one draft; the draft chips (**Drafts:**) let you switch between them. **Delete draft** removes the current one.

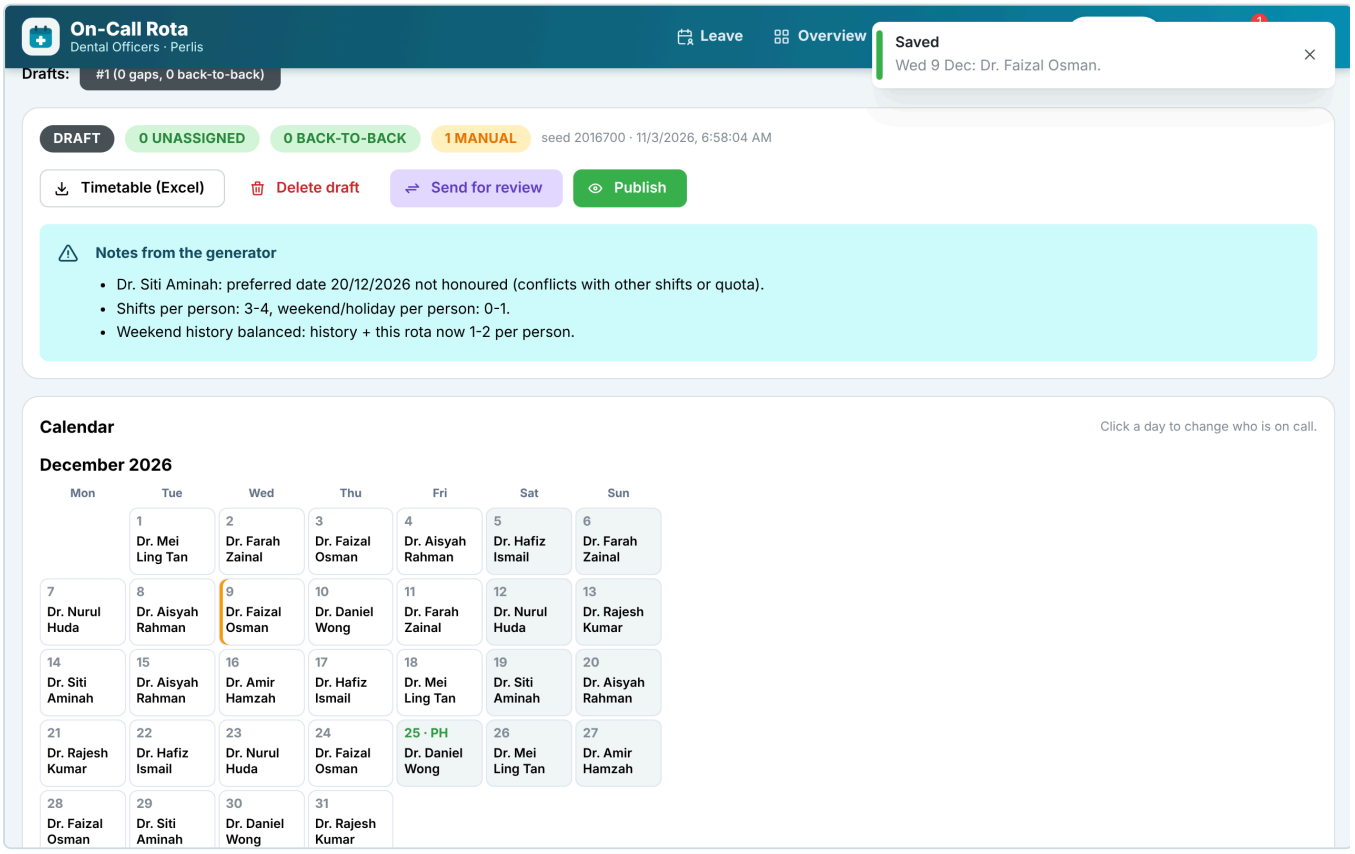
3.9 Adjust days by hand

1. In the draft's calendar, click a day.
2. Choose a different officer under **On call** (or clear it to leave the day unassigned). The list shows each officer's shifts so far.



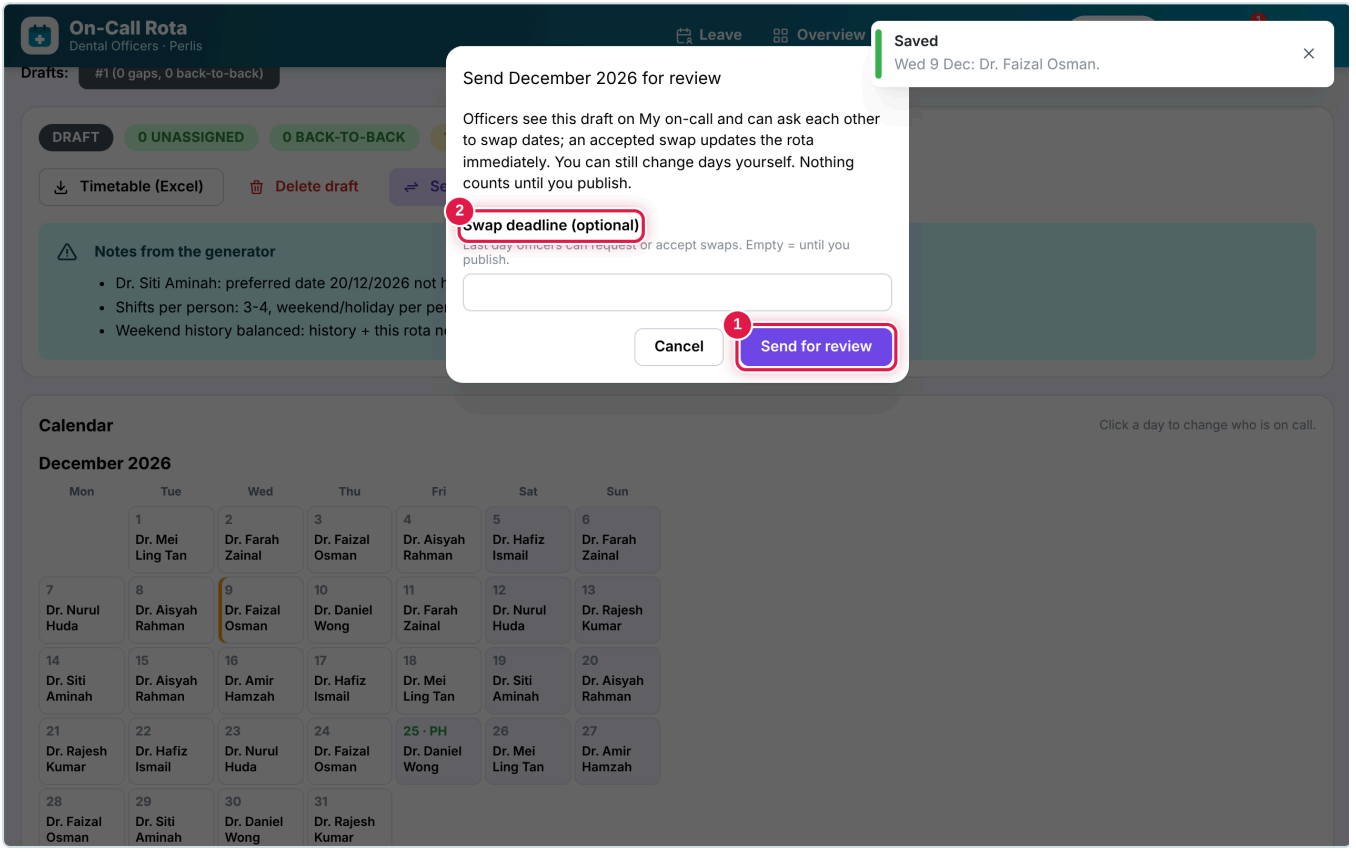


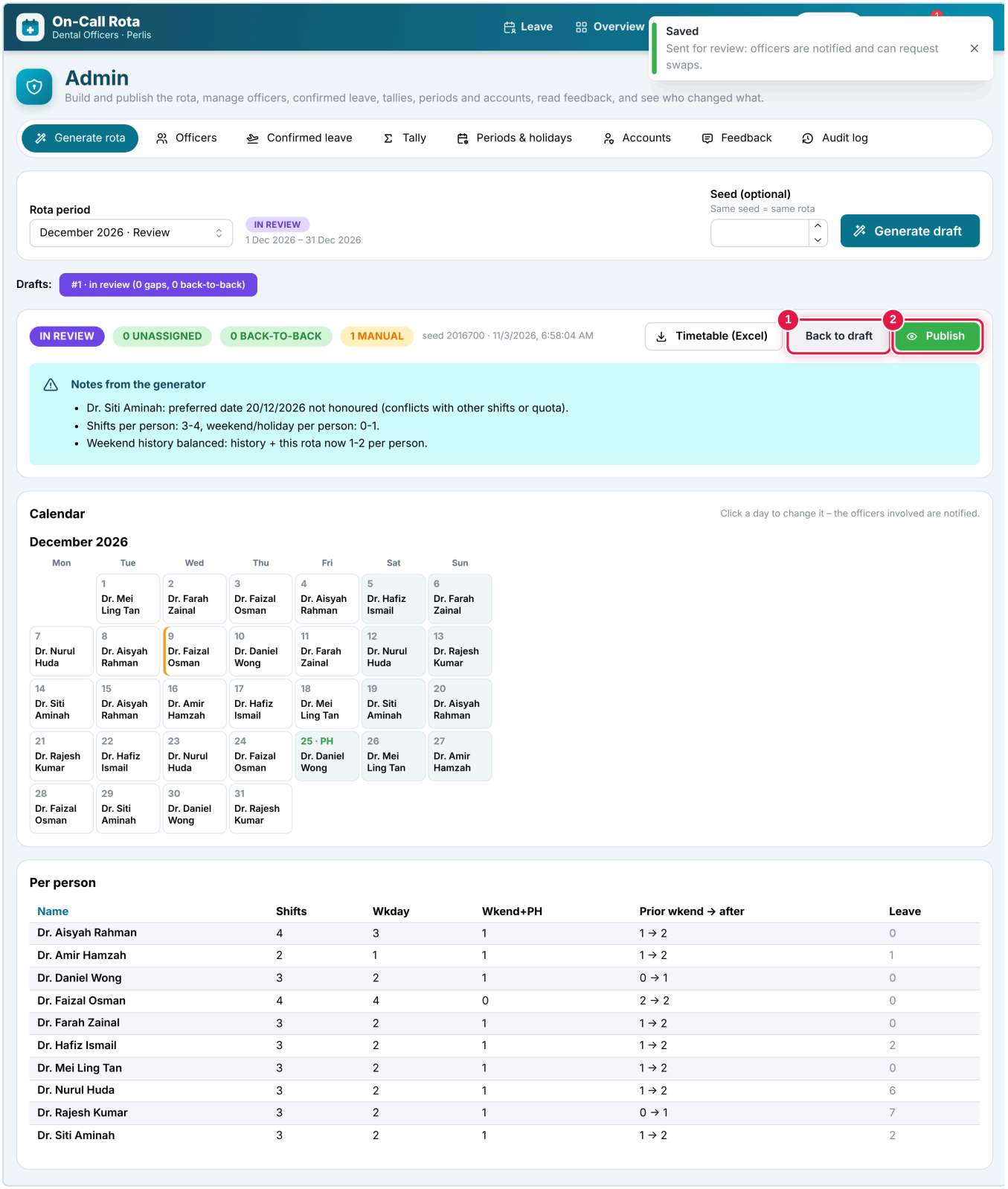
3. Press **Save**. A warning (for example “preferred on a different day” or a leave clash) appears if the change is risky, but the change is still saved. The day gets an orange border and the **Manual** badge counts it.



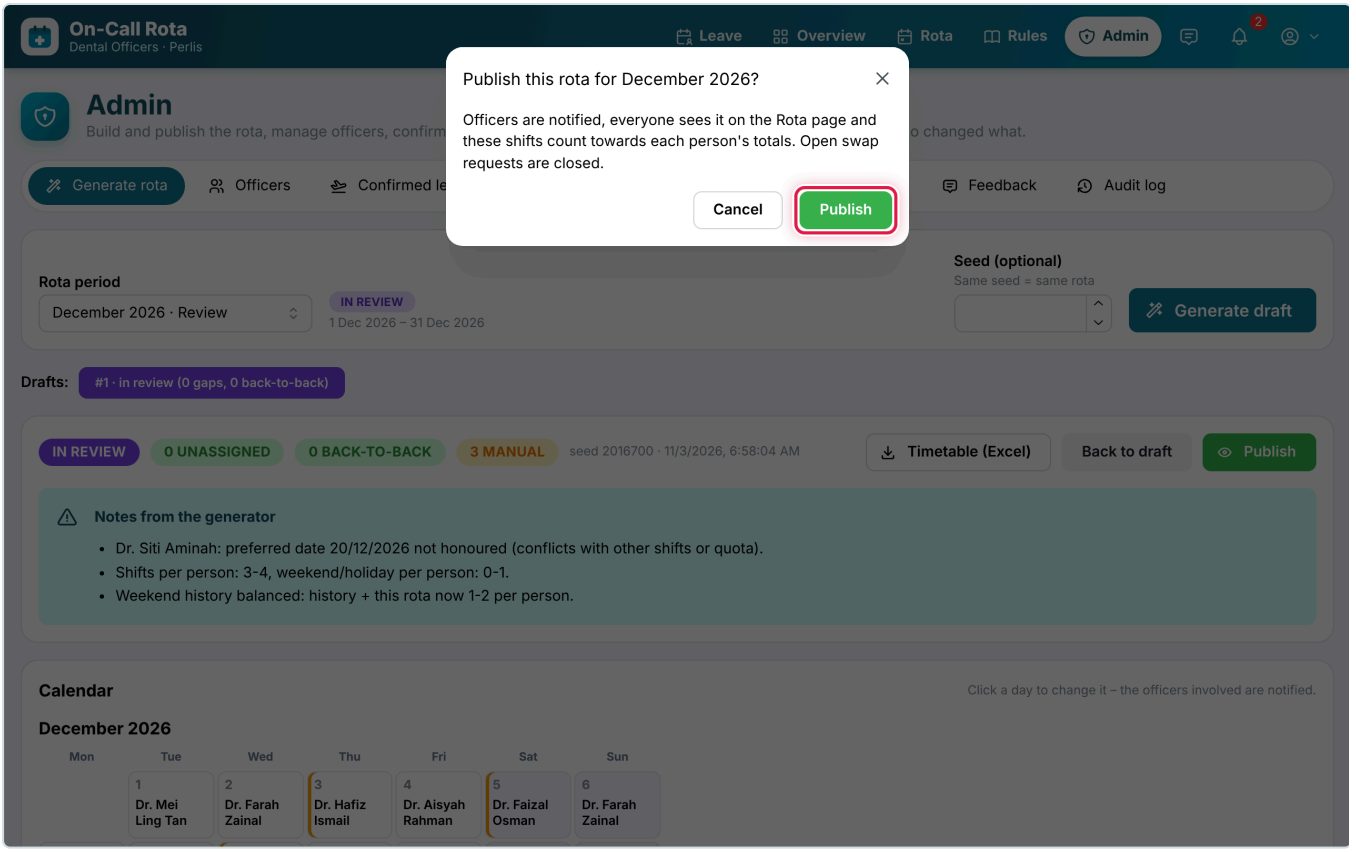
3.10 Send for review, then publish

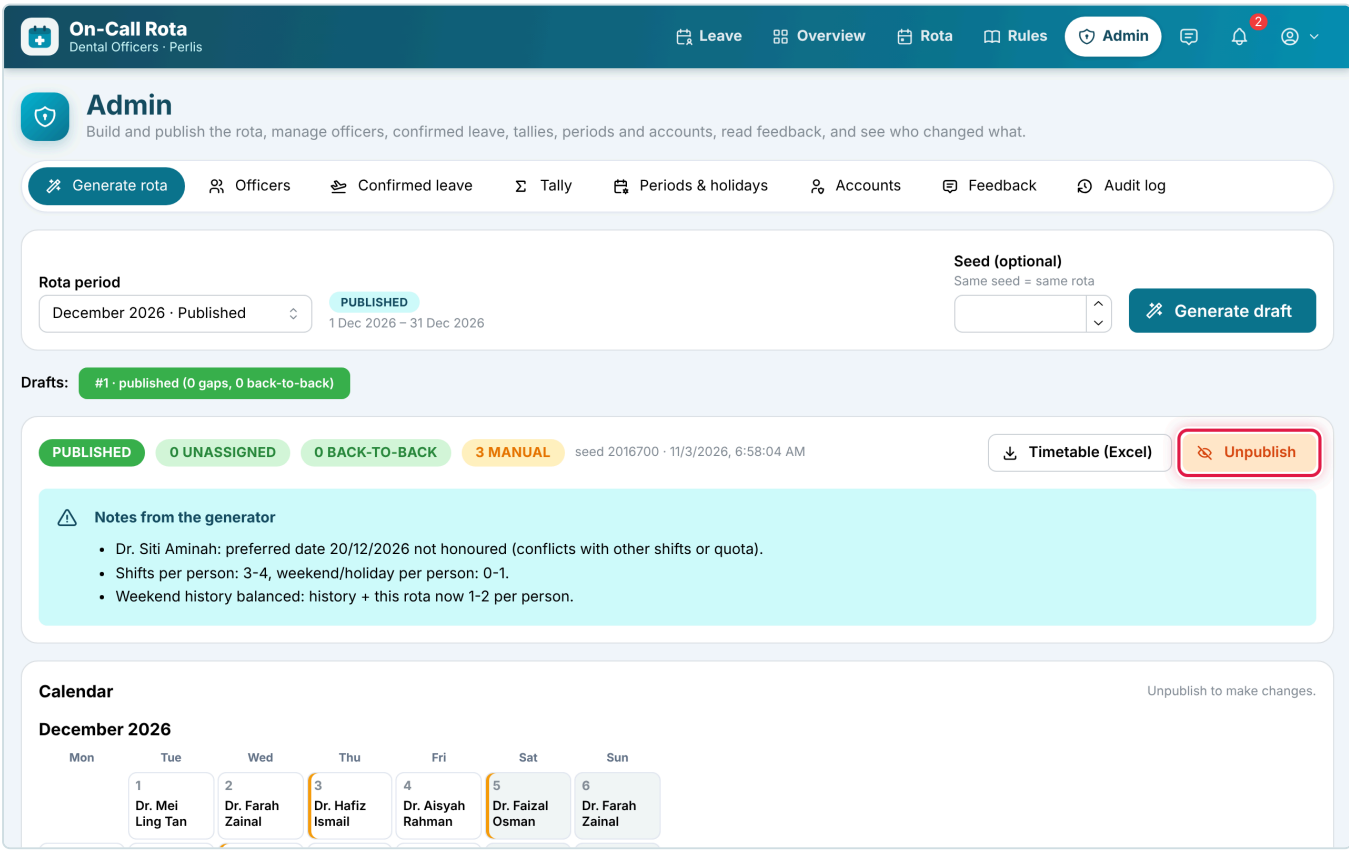
1. Press **Send for review**. Optionally set a **Swap deadline** (the last day officers can request or accept swaps). Officers are notified and see the draft marked “not final”.



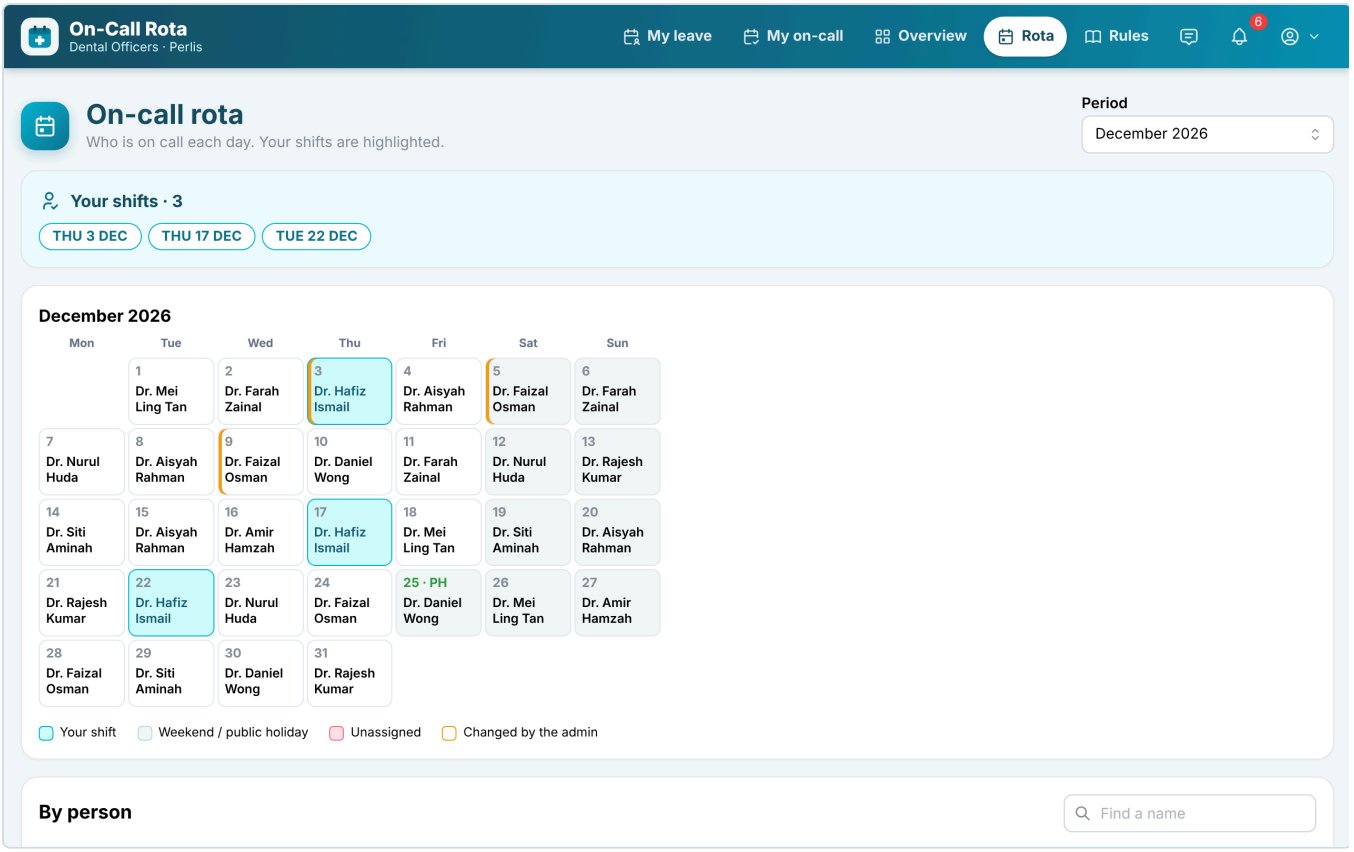


2. While in review, officers swap dates among themselves (section 2.8). **Back to draft** pulls it back for changes.
3. Press **Publish** and confirm. Everyone is notified, open swap requests close, and each officer's shifts are added to their tally.





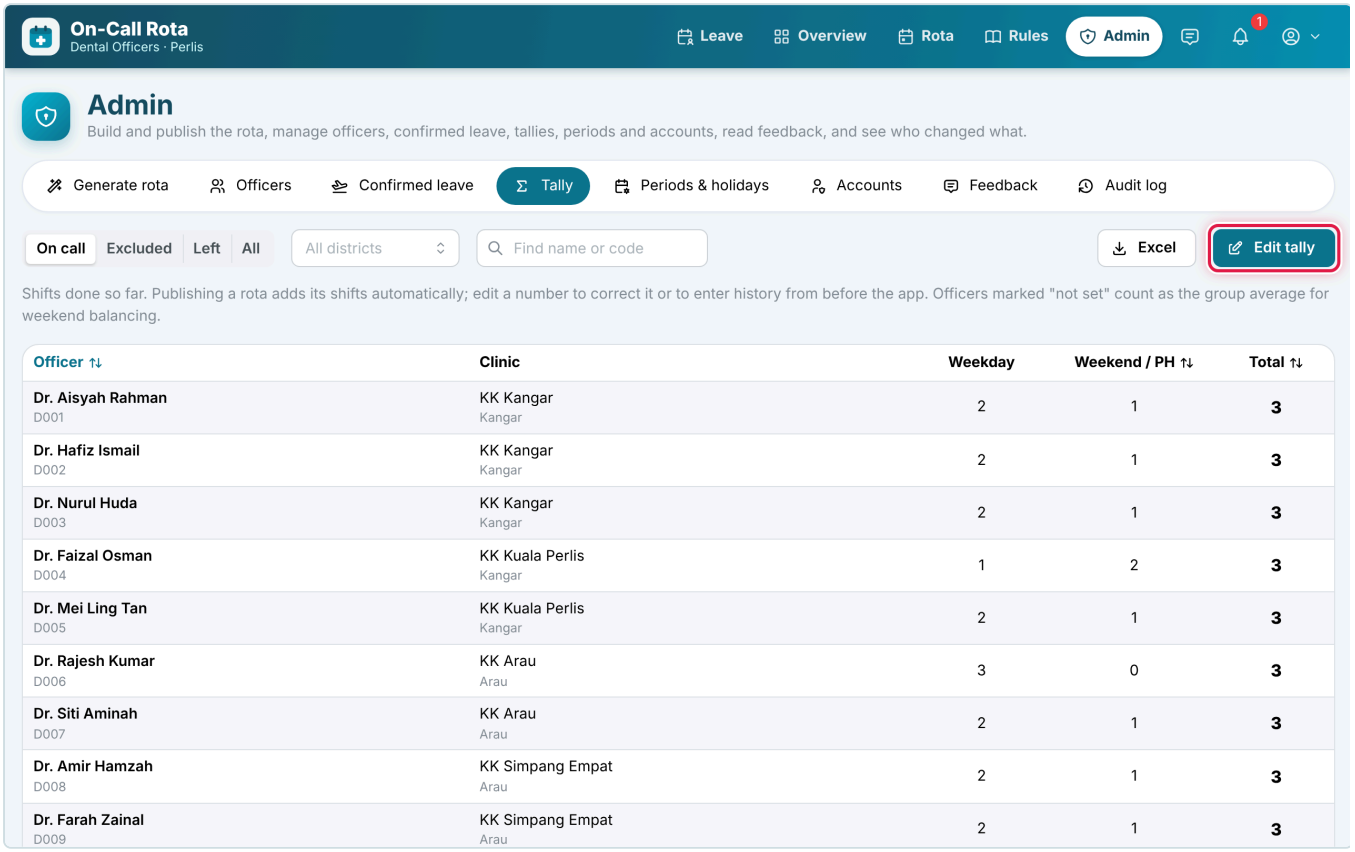
Officers now see the final rota.

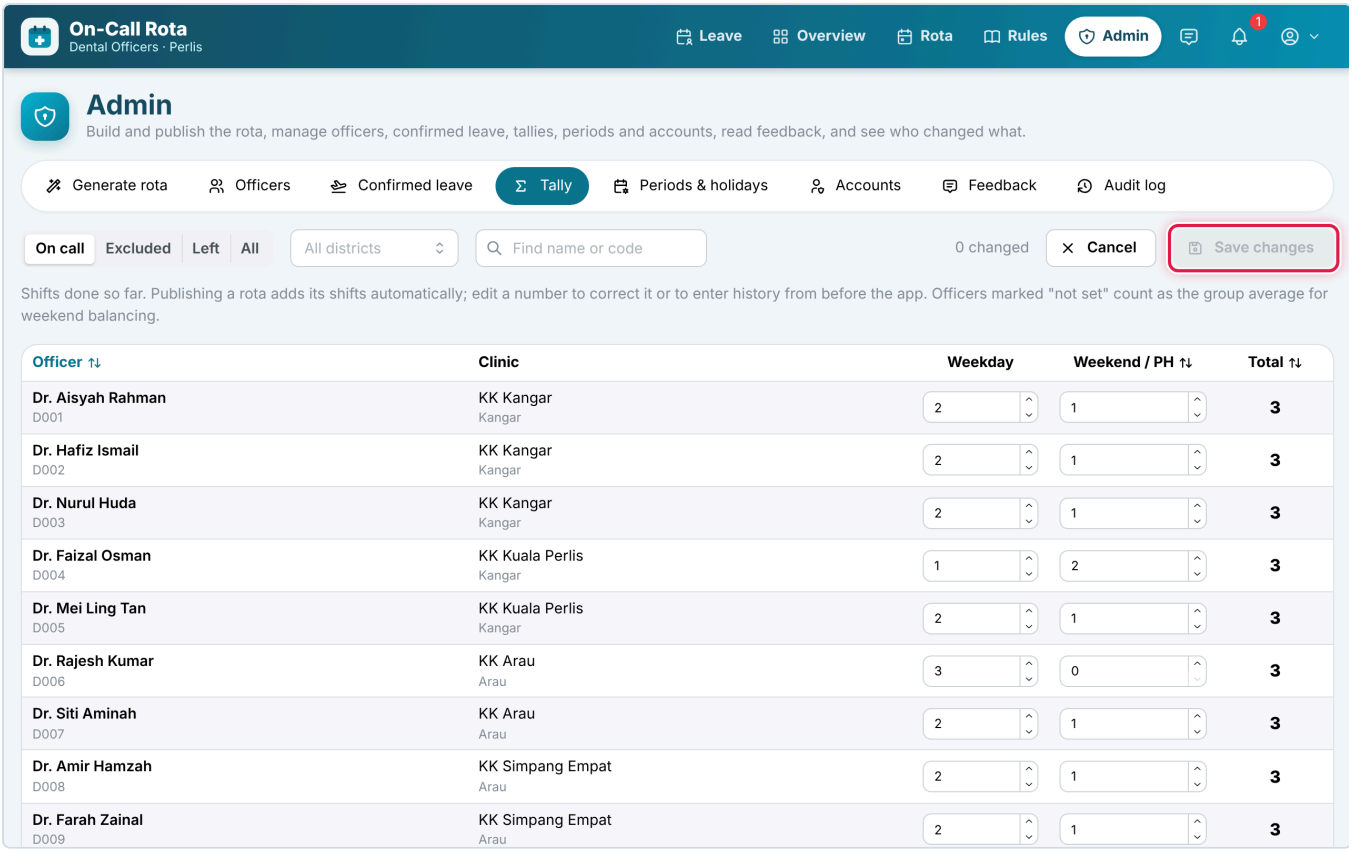


A published rota can be exported with **Timetable (Excel)**. **Unpublish** reverses publishing if you must correct something; after publication, swaps go through you.

3.11 Tally

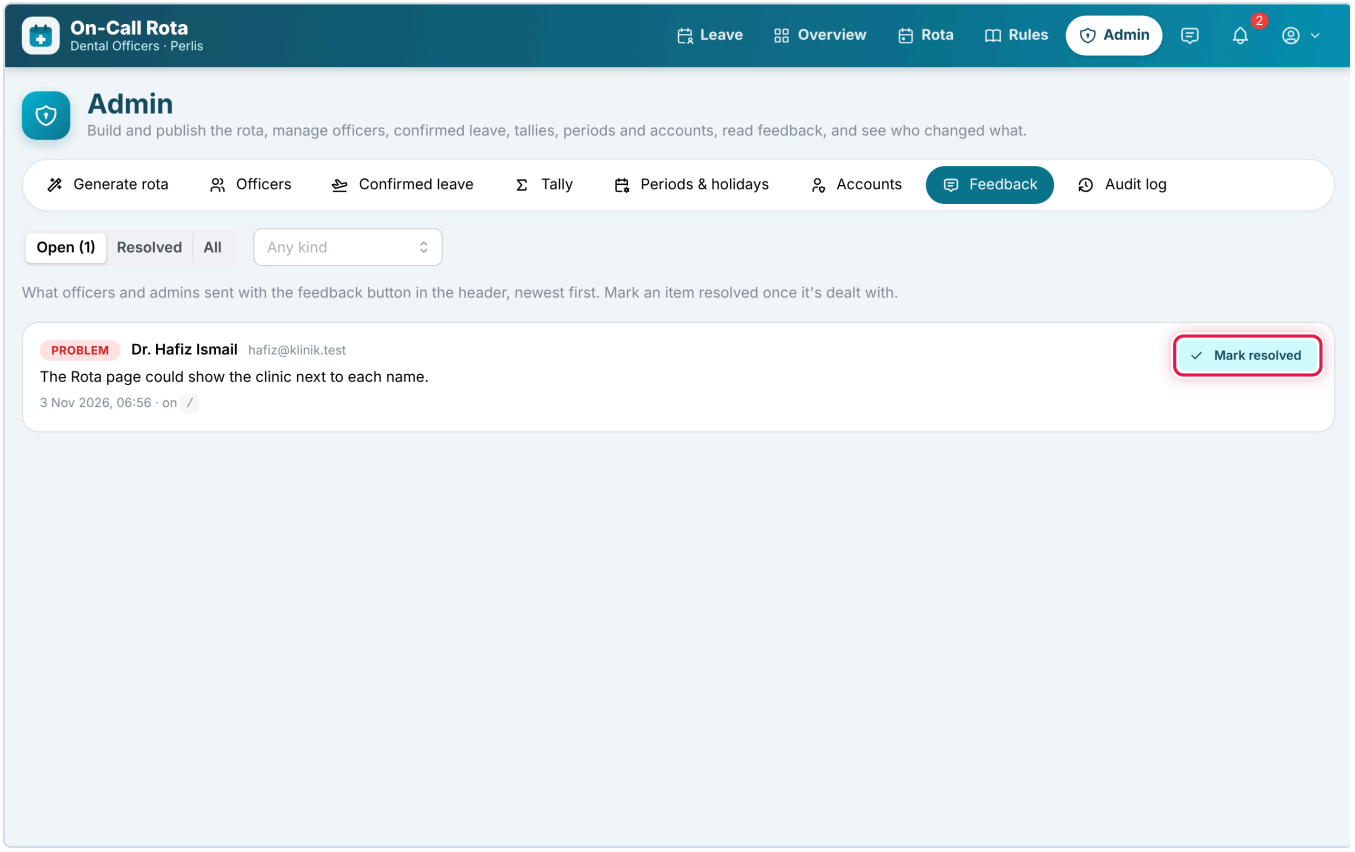
Tally shows each officer's weekday and weekend/public-holiday shifts done so far. Publishing a rota adds its shifts automatically. Use **Edit tally** to correct a number or enter history from before the app (officers shown as not set count as the group average for weekend balancing), then **Save changes**. **Excel** exports it.




On-Call Rota
Dental Officers · Perlis
Leave
Overview
Rota
Rules
Admin
Admin
Build and publish the rota, manage officers, confirmed leave, tallies, periods and accounts, read feedback, and see who changed what.
Generate rota
Officers
Confirmed leave
Tally
Periods & holidays
Accounts
Feedback
Audit log
On call
Excluded
Left
All
All districts
Find name or code
0 changed
Cancel
Save changes
Shifts done so far. Publishing a rota adds its shifts automatically; edit a number to correct it or to enter history from before the app. Officers marked "not set" count as the group average for weekend balancing.
Officer
Clinic
Weekday
Weekend / PH
Total
Dr. Aisyah Rahman D001 KK Kangar Kangar 2 1 3
Dr. Hafiz Ismail D002 KK Kangar Kangar 2 1 3
Dr. Nurul Huda D003 KK Kangar Kangar 2 1 3
Dr. Faizal Osman D004 KK Kuala Perlis Kangar 1 2 3
Dr. Mei Ling Tan D005 KK Kuala Perlis Kangar 2 1 3
Dr. Rajesh Kumar D006 KK Arau Arau 3 0 3
Dr. Siti Aminah D007 KK Arau Arau 2 1 3
Dr. Amir Hamzah D008 KK Simpang Empat Arau 2 1 3
Dr. Farah Zainal D009 KK Simpang Empat Arau 2 1 3

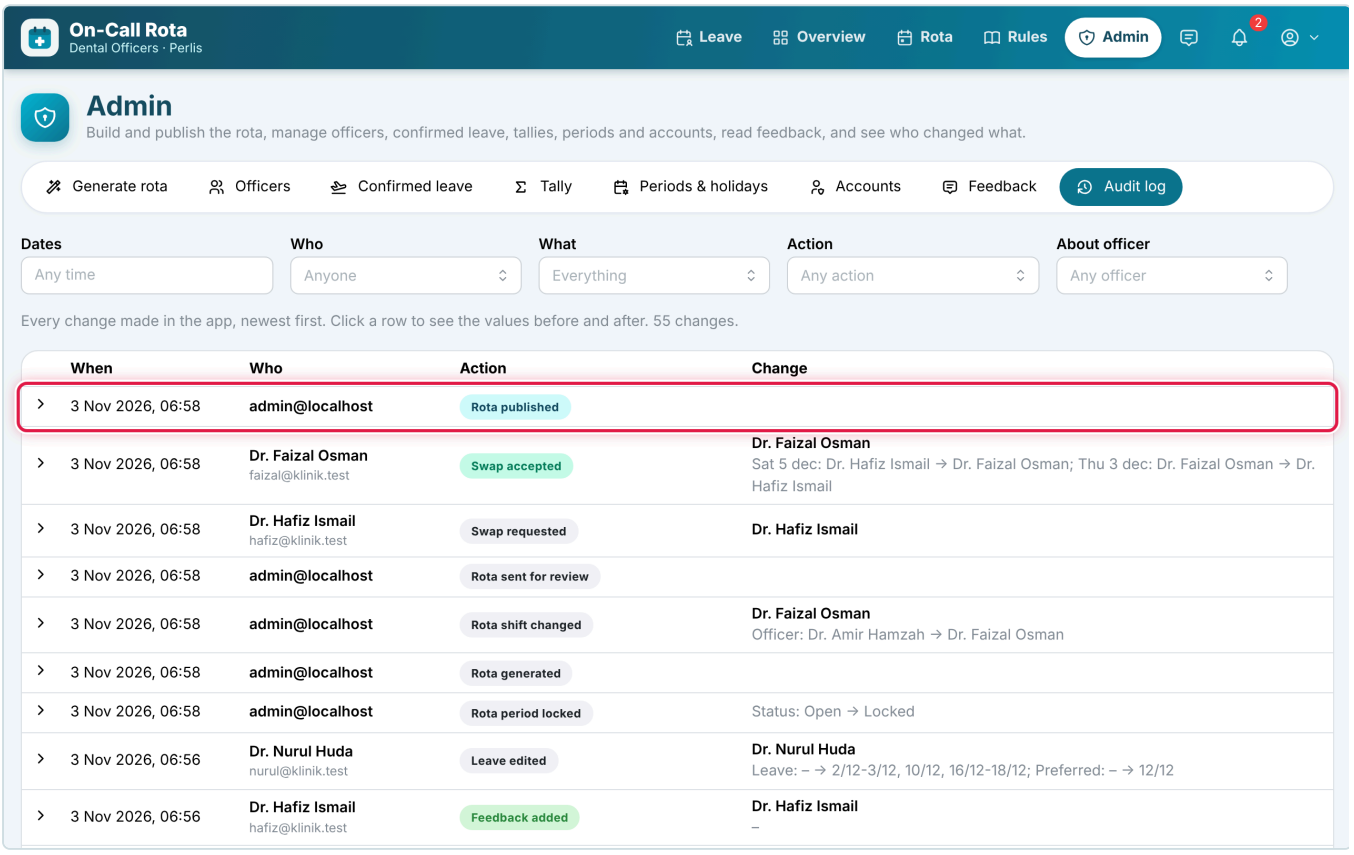
3.12 Feedback

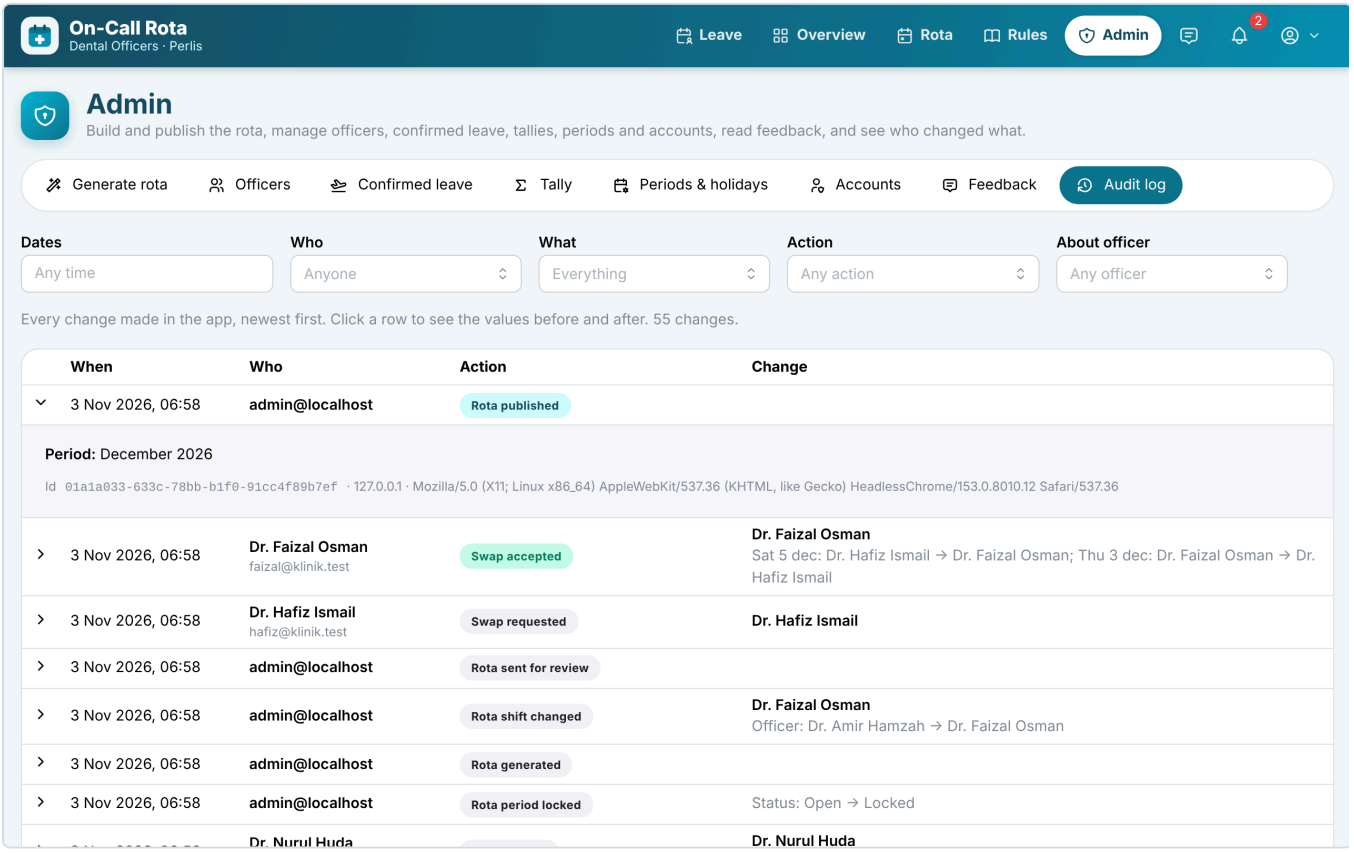
Feedback lists what officers sent, newest first, with the page they were on. Filter by **Open**, **Resolved** or **All**, and by kind. Press **Mark resolved** when dealt with (and **Reopen** to undo).



3.13 Audit log

Every change in the app is recorded: who, when, what and the before and after values (leave edits, rota changes, swaps, publishing, account changes, feedback). Filter by dates, person, kind of change, action or the officer affected. Click a row to see the details.





3.14 Email and temporary passwords

Invites and password resets are sent by email when the server has email set up. When it does not, the app shows each temporary password to the admin so it can be passed on securely. Invitations and temporary passwords expire, so use the envelope icon in **Accounts** to send a new one.

APPENDIX

Appendix: quick answers

Short answers to common questions.

Question	Answer
I cannot click a day on My leave	The day is full (striped), the deadline has passed, or the period is locked. Ask an admin, who can still edit your leave.
The app says I am out of points	Ask an admin for extra points before the deadline (Admin > Periods & holidays > Leave points).
I cannot change some of my leave	Purple striped days are confirmed leave; only an admin can change them.
I was put on call on a day I am away	Tell the admin. During review you can also swap the date yourself.
My tally looks wrong	Tell the admin; they can correct it on the Tally tab.
I forgot my password	Use Forgot password? on the sign-in page, or ask an admin to send a new temporary password.
Who changed this?	Admins can see every change, with before and after values, in Admin > Audit log.
Something is broken	Press the feedback icon in the header and describe what you did and what happened.